Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav

Revised Edition

Resilient Bharat

HISTORY TEXT BOOK

Class 7

ORANGE HOUSE

Resilient Bharat

(History Text Book for Class - 7)

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Chinmaya Mission, Chennai
Vidya Bharati, Tamilnadu

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For the cause of nation building on the occasion of 75th year of Indian independence

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"When the real history of India will be unearthed, it will be proved that, as in matters of religion, so in fine arts, India is the primal Guru of the whole world.

History itself bears testimony to the fact. All the soul-elevating ideas and the different branches of knowledge that exist in the world are found on proper investigation to have their roots in India.

Know your past … out of the past is built the future. Look back, therefore, as far as you can, drink deep of the eternal fountains that are behind and after that, look forward, march forward and make India brighter, greater, much higher than she ever was.

For our national welfare, India must gather up of its scattered spiritual forces. India must be a union of those whose hearts beat to the same spiritual tune. Then only will India awake, when hundreds of large-hearted men and women, giving up all desires of enjoying the luxuries of life, will long and exert themselves to their utmost, for the wellbeing of the millions of their countrymen.

Let New India arise…let her arise-out of the peasant's cottage, grasping the plough; out of the huts of the fisherman, the cobbler and the sweeper. Let her emanate from the factory, from marts and from the markets and from groves and forests, from hills and mountains."

- Swami Vivekananda

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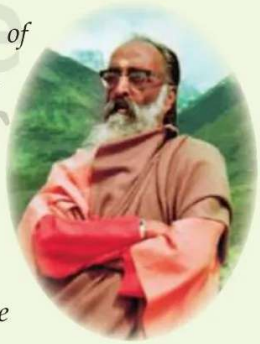


"No Nation can live and draw inspiration and courage to face the challenges of the present and carve out glorious destinies for its future, if it has no connection with its past - to be historically conscious of the glory that was, is the springboard of all true National Self-respect.

You are the citizen of the ancient nation, the Bharat. You have a national heritage equally ancient and valuable. You cannot be living in a country with freedom and enthusiasm without understanding its true genius. Without owning the national heritage, you cannot be an Indian in the Bharat.

The spirit of freedom, the spirit of reverence to your country, the spirit of sacrifice for the sake of the society - these are inspiring ideals and under such ideals, mighty men have done great and ennobling activity in the world and fruits of their actions are enjoyed by the future generations for many, many years. So, higher the ideal that inspires an individual, the nobler is the action that he does in the world outside.

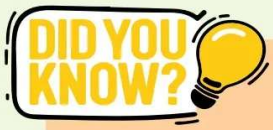
Every Nation has its own special mark of genius. Here, in our history, we find the masses are inspired only by ideals of their immortal culture and their deathless religion."

- Swami Chinmayananda

What's new in the History Text Book?

According to the NEP 2020: The aim of education will not only be cognitive development, but also building character and creating holistic and well-rounded individuals equipped with the key 21st century skills. This revamped history textbook attempts to make history interesting and intriguing for children through some new sections.

- **Did you know?**



Intriguing facts about the subjects that amazes the student and kindles his/her curiosity to explore the topic further

- **Classroom Activity**

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Hands-on activities for the students to understand the concepts better and find out more information beyond what is provided in the book

- **Classroom Discussion**

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Interesting questions to kick-start debates and conversations to bring forth different viewpoints of students, also making the topic more relevant to them

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- **Reflect / Think**

Highlighting certain aspects of the topic with leading questions to make the students analyse the topic deeper and extract take-aways for life

- **Anecdotes**

ANECDOTES

Legends, folklores, real-life incidents that provide students with powerful and personable role models from the past

- **Quotes**

Inspiring words from great kings, queens, leaders, thinkers, poets, travellers, historians, archaeologists and more from the past that could give students an insightful learning experience

- **Glossary**

Difficult words are denoted by * symbol and the meanings are given in footnote

- **Time Scale**

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE Chronologically presenting the flow of events covered in the lesson

Incorporation of NEP and 21st century skills

The overall thrust of pedagogical reforms as per the NEP 2020 is to move the education system towards real understanding and towards learning how to learn - and away from the culture of rote learning as is largely present today. The above sections in this History textbook are aimed at improving the student's critical thinking, analytical and evaluating skills, communicative and linguistic skills and more. A few chapters have incorporated marking on maps and drawing of flags/coins, which cover the art-integrated pedagogical, strengthening the linkages between education and culture.

Competency based evaluation questions (questions testing application of knowledge and skills in real life contexts) is an integral part of the NEP and it has been very well incorporated in the lessons. The anecdotes and interesting facts aim to build a greater awareness about the rich cultural heritage of our country and promote its preservation – a key aspect of the NEP 2020. 'Recap with time scale' given at the end of the lessons makes the entire pedagogy student centric, as envisioned by the NEP 2020.

The vision of the New Education Policy is to instill among the learners a deep-rooted pride in being Indian, not only in thought, but also in spirit, intellect and deeds. The very substratum of this history textbook echoes this noble vision.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Every great project starts by igniting a mighty vision in our minds. Thanks to **Swami Mitrananda** (Spiritual Mentor, Chinmaya Mission Chennai) for envisioning this massive project and driving it to finish, inspiring the team at every stage. Thanks to late **Shri T Chakravarty** (President, Vidya Bharati, Dakshinkshetra) who shared this noble vision and provided supportive resources and timely guidance. Thanks to **Shri L Ramamoorthy** (Vice President, Vidya Bharati, Uttar Tamilnadu) for coordinating the project in keeping with the vision.

Gratitude to the Correspondents, Educational Officers and Principals of Chinmaya Vidyalayas Chennai and Vidya Bharati for their effective leadership in coordinating with teachers and syncing with the vision. Gratitude to the Teachers of Chinmaya Vidyalaya and Vidya Bharati schools, who are the pillars of this project. Thanks for investing time in research, writing drafts, reviewing and offering inputs.

Sincere thanks to the volunteers of Chinmaya Mission and Vidya Bharati for passionately contributing time and effort to research, edit and present the content in a child-friendly way. Thanks to all the patrons and supporters of this cause, who strongly believe that children should consume this perspective of history.

Heart felt gratitude to Shri **Sanjeev Sanyal** (Member of the Economic Advisory Council of the PM), Shri Dr. **Vikram Sampath**, (Historian & Author of books on Indian history), Prof. Shri **Dinesh Prasad Saklani** (Director, NCERT and Chairperson, NCTE) and Prof. Shri **Y. Sreekanth** (Principal, Regional Institute of Education, Mysuru) for the support and valuable feedback. Special thanks to the panel of experts - Shri DK Hari, Smt Hema Hari, Shri Ram Mohan, Dr. S Kalyanaraman.

Gratitude to the designers, Shri Bhuvanesh Prakasan and Shri K.K. Ravikumar, for kindling the curiosity in children for history through the vibrant and colourful presentation.

Thanks to the editorial team - Shri Sriram Vijayaraghavan, Shri Ananthakrishnan Seshadri and Smt Radha Narayanan - for authoring and bringing the book to its current form. Thanks to Shri Raghav Kannan, who coordinated the project end to end.

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FOREWORD

Swami Swaroopananda - Global Head, Chinmaya Mission

Knowledge shapes our beliefs. Beliefs shape our actions. Actions determine our destiny. Thus, education in the right knowledge holds the key to a bright future.

India has a glorious past. Her advancements in arts, science, polity, economics, technology and spirituality were unparalleled. Recent researches are throwing up hitherto unknown facts about India's vast heritage. The reading of Indian History in its true light will arouse pride in every Indian's heart. It will awaken in us the sense of patriotism and inspire us to contribute all their might to build a glorious future for our nation. It will kindle our enthusiasm to explore into the Indian Knowledge systems and promulgate its insights for the benefit of the entire world.

I am delighted that Chinmaya Mission and Vidya Bharati have undertaken this imperative task of rewriting the History books for Classes 6, 7 and 8. I am sure that this pioneering work will actuate a transformation in the reading and writing of Indian History for schools and colleges in India.

My heartiest congratulations to the team of researchers, authors, editors and designers who have put in their best efforts towards this noble venture.

****

Avaneesh Bhatnagar - General Secretary, Vidya Bharati

Dr D.S. Kothari wrote in the Education Commission's report "The destiny of India is being shaped in her classrooms". It is necessary for the progress of any country that its subject is dedicated for the Nation. They must feel proud of their legacy, their ancestors and knowledge traditions and have a strong feeling of utmost devotion and sacrifice for the cause of their country.

Our generations were deprived to know their real history. They were taught that their forefathers were aboriginals, heathen and knew nothing about the world. But, the truth is that the time when 'their' forefathers did not even know to wear clothes, a grand knowledge lineage like the Vedas were developed by the Rishis of this country. This propaganda was done with a vicious purpose by the invaders who ruled over our motherland for centuries.

Vidya Bharati and Chinmaya Mission did not remain silent spectators. A very significant, long awaited, imperative task of rewriting the History books for classes 6,7 and 8 has jointly been undertaken under the noble guidance of Poojya Swami Mitrananda. Moreover, it is not simply rewriting of some books. It is an effort to expose the truth and facts for the next generation. Collection of real information, fact checking, verifying them from original sources, then compiling and editing them into a presentable manner, that too suitable to the age group of target readers - the teenagers - must have needed much of labour, time and energy. My humble pranams to those who are involved in this noble cause.

WORDS OF APPRECIATION

I extend my hearty congratulations to the team of Vidya Bharati and Chinmaya Mission Chennai for bringing out a set of text books with an Indic perspective to Indian history. It was interesting to go through these textbooks meant for Classes 6, 7 and 8 and I would like to appreciate the efforts put in by the entire team in research and presentation of the content.

The textbooks start right from the glorious Saraswati - Sindhu Civilization. Care has been taken to ensure the history of the large geography of Bharat has been covered. The books highlight many episodes of valour of Bharatiya kings, queens and unsung warriors, instead of focusing on just the invaders. The grand vision and immense patriotism of true Bharatiya heroes like Chanakya, Chatrapati Shivaji, Maharana Pratap, Suheldev, Subhas Chandra Bose, Sardar Patel, and many others are brought out, that too in a child-friendly design. It is interesting to see the way critical milestones in historical battles are brought out. The impact and consequence of the wars fought are discussed, so that students can understand and appreciate their impact on the history of Bharat. I see that the textbooks include recent discoveries using an evidence-based approach. History has been made relatable and relevant to today's generation so that children can understand history with their head and heart.

According to the National Education Policy, the aim of education is not only cognitive development, but also creating holistic and well-rounded individuals, equipped with the key 21st century skills. This revamped history textbook series has attempted to make history interesting and intriguing for children through some new sections of debates, discussions, activities, reflections and more. It will kindle the curiosity in the child to learn more about his/her past and instill a sense of pride about their country and their culture. Vidya Bharati has always been supporting NCERT during the drafting of NEP and currently in implementing it in their schools.

This textbook is another beautiful creation by the entire team to mould young minds into positive and proud citizens of tomorrow. My best wishes and congratulations to the entire team. I assure my best support towards your cause.

Namaste

Prof. Shri Dinesh Prasad Saklani

Director, NCERT and Chairperson, National Council for Teacher Education

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PREFACE

Values expressed through art, literature, religion, beliefs, and individual and collective action all make up the culture of a land. A significant characteristic of culture is continuity. While we investigate and unfold the events of historical Bharat, the continuity of culture and the collective will of the people stands out. The culture and tradition of the land of Bharat have shone through from ancient times.

A thriving civilization is bound to attract hostile forces. Although there were some early attempts of invasion in the 8th century, it was towards the end of the 10th century that it became a consistent feature. The brave rulers of Bharat, starting at the frontiers acted as effective firewalls and protected the people and their way of life. There were however rude shocks experienced by the people of Bharat. The invaders did not follow the rules of Dharma in war and peace time that Bharat's rulers were used to. This led to turmoil in the society. Bharat is the inexhaustible spiritual fountain for the world. Even under the darkest of times, its spiritual tradition has helped its people to be very resilient. The bhakti tradition acted as a beacon of light to the ordinary people during the tough times of invasions.

There were many empires that flourished during this time. Not only did these empires flourish inside Bharat but were able to expand beyond the seas. Art, architecture, science, and philosophy made great advancements.

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Bharat's resistance to invaders didn't waver or tire. Whenever the going was tough, great rulers emerged who re-established Dharma and were able to have a grand vision for a united Bharat. The thirst for swarajya was rekindled in people that was to continue for hundreds of years to come. This book attempts to also shine the light on some less-covered regions of Bharat who have contributed to the resilient spirit of the nation. Bharat resisted and triumphed and we hope that the young readers uncover their resilient spirit.

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Chapter 1

GLORIOUS BHARAT

"India has withstood the shocks of centuries, of hundreds of foreign invasions. It is the same land that stands firmer than any rock in the world, with its undying vigour, indestructible life. It's life is immortal and we are the children of such a country".

- Swami Vivekananda

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Identify major empires of Bharat and their rulers between 700 CE and 1000 CE
- Assess the economic and cultural prosperity of Bharat
- Discuss the major contributors of each dynasty during this period
- Assess the nature of the state and highlight cultural and social changes

INTRODUCTION

700 CE to 1000 CE witnessed dramatic developments in the social and political spheres that significantly changed Bharat. This was a period of great strength and achievement for Bharat.

Kanyakubja or Kannauj in the heartland of Bharat was a flourishing metropolis* of that time. A bustling economic and cultural centre, it caught the attention of many rulers from various parts of Bharat. Between 1 CE and 1000 CE, Bharat was a leading economic superpower with almost 32% of the world's GDP*.

Three major empires experienced their rise and fall during this time period. They were the Rashtrakutas (from the south), Palas (from the east) and the Pratiharas (from the west and north).

Bharat saw a vast cultural and religious resurgence during this time. Puranas became very popular. Dharmashastras were held as the source of fundamental law. Literature and architecture attained great heights. Dharma was protected by rulers and unquestioningly adhered to by common citizens. Bharatiyas crossed frontiers and traversed the seas to far-off lands including Java, Sumatra, Malay, Kambuja and Champa.

POLITICAL LANDSCAPE OF BHARAT BETWEEN 700 CE AND 1000 CE

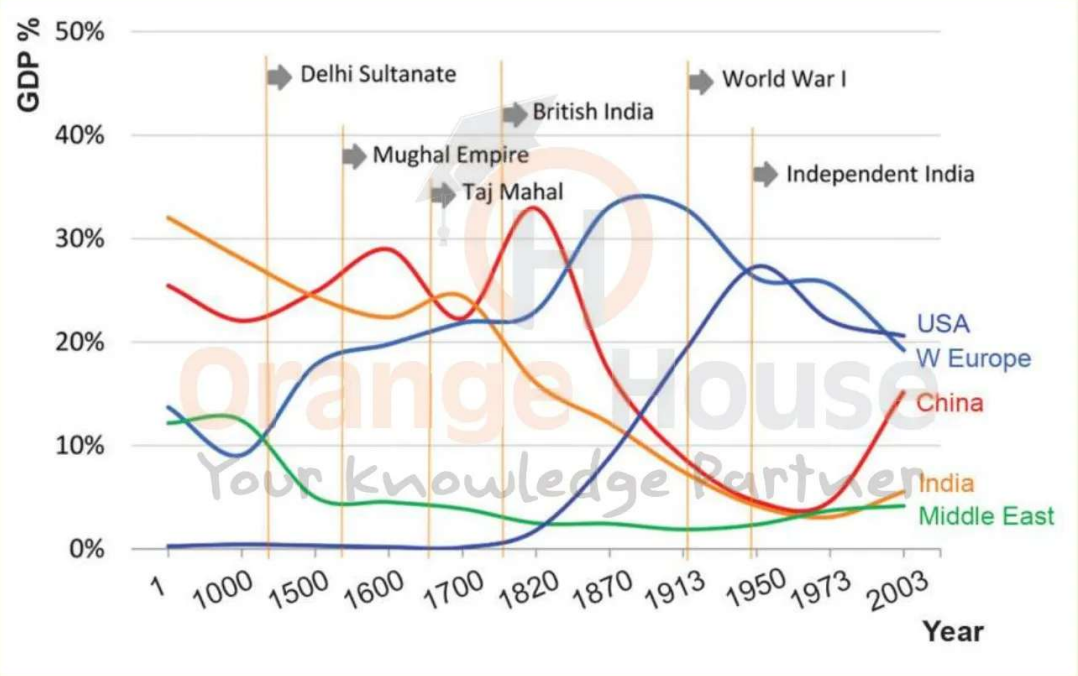
The geographical landscape of Bharat extended from the Himalayas in the north to the Indian Ocean in the south and Hindukush Sulaiman Range in the northwest to Arunachal which was part of greater Assam of that time in the east. The Sulaiman and Kirthar Ranges stood strong and daunting* in the northwest. These

Metropolis : Chief city of a kingdom or country
GDP : Gross Domestic Product – Measure of health of a country's economy.
Daunting : Difficult to deal with

seemingly impassable ranges had a few narrow passes that connected Bharat to Central Asia and West Asia. The long coastline of southern Bharat enabled the Cholas to establish a strong naval force and thereby develop trade relations with other southeastern countries.

The unparalleled textile products of Bengal were in great demand across Arabia, Persia and China. Metal implements, particularly iron, were used for manufacturing agricultural tools. The large number of bronze idols, especially from southern Bharat, bear testimony to the proficiency* of artisans in metal craftsmanship. According to Chinese traveller and historian Hiuen Tsang's testimony brass, silver and gold were produced in plenty. Improved agricultural techniques and expansion of settlements resulted in cultivation of cash crops*. This led to development of several agro-based industries. There was also a rapid increase in sugar production.

All these developments culminated into Bharat becoming the wealthiest nation in the world. Bharat's GDP was more than a quarter of that of the entire world. Owing to her unthinkable wealth reserves, Bharat was famed as the golden bird (Sone ki Chidiya). In fact, most of the Arabic and Turkic invaders who ravaged Bharat after 1000 CE for establishing Islamic rule also ended up plundering enormous wealth. Diamonds were primarily found only in ancient Bharat until they were later discovered during the 18th century in Brazil. This caught the attention of merchants and governments from all over the world.



Before we endeavour to study all of Bharat, let us look closely at one region in Bharat - Kanyakubja or Kannauj. From the 8th to 12th century CE, Kannauj (in present day Uttar Pradesh, 80 kms from Kanpur) was one of the most significant, sought after and fought over regions. The Rashtrakutas, Palas and Pratiharas had a keen interest to take control of Kannauj at that time. Control of the central and northern portions of Bharat usually rested with those empires that ruled Kannauj. The control for Kannauj by the three kingdoms was referred to as the **Tripartite Struggle**.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

We can see in the above graph that Bharat contributed to 32% of the total wealth created in the world in 1 CE but it reduced dramatically from 1820 CE. What do you think could have been the reasons?

Proficiency : Skilled in doing something **Cash crops :** Plants grown to source raw material, not food

IMPORTANCE OF KANNAUJ

- Kannauj was located in the fertile plains of the Ganga-Yamuna doab*. Owing to the fertility of the land and abundant natural resources, agriculture flourished and Kannauj developed as a center for trade and commerce.
- Geographically Kannauj was situated at an elevated height and easy to fortify and to protect it from invasions.
- Kannauj was an important center for trade because of its connectivity to the ancient silk route.
- The wealth of Kannauj attracted the best of learned people of those times. The presence of numerous universities and literary works in the area stand testimony* to this fact.
- Control of Kannauj implied control of the large expanse of the Gangetic plains and was a symbolic power center.

Doab : Is a tract of land located at the meeting point of two large rivers
Testimony : Proof of something

THE THREE MAJOR POWER CENTERS OF BHARAT

THE RASHTRAKUTAS

By the middle of the 8th century, the Rashtrakutas of Manyakheta rose to power. Previously, the Rashtrakutas were chieftains under the Badami Chaulukyas. However, the Rashtrakuta ruler Dantidurga through his successful military expeditions started becoming independent of the Badami Chaulukyas. He won over the last Badami Chaulukya ruler Kirtivarman II and established the Rashtrakuta empire in 753 CE.

KRISHNA I – THE VISIONARY WHO BUILT THE KAILASA TEMPLE

As Dantidurga did not have any children to succeed him, his uncle Krishna I took over in 758 CE. The Chaulukyans regrouped, attacked and Krishna I convincingly defeated them.

Krishna I was a great visionary and built the spectacular rock-cut temple of Kailasa in Ellora.

ROCK-CUT TEMPLE OF KAILASA, ELLORA, AURANGABAD

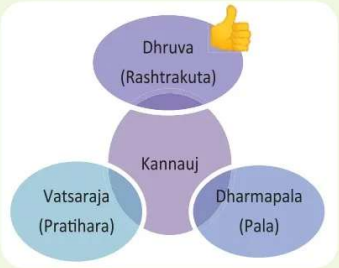
Krishna I commissioned the unique Kailasa temple in Ellora. Legend goes that his queen had taken up a *vrata* to not have a morsel of food until she saw the shikhara (tower above the sanctum sanctorum) of the majestic temple that the royal couple were building. Architects from all over the country were invited to give their ideas. An architect from Paithan gave a unique solution - to carve out a temple top-down from the massive rocky mountains. This way, the shikara would be revealed first and the queen could end her *vrata*. Hence, the Kailasa temple is the biggest monolithic structure (made of single rock) in the world that was constructed by vertical excavation - that is, removing debris from the top towards the bottom of the temple..

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Do you think it would have been an easy task to carve a temple out of the mountain from the top? What could have been the challenges faced by the architects? How do you think they solved it? How long do you think it would have taken for them to build the temple?

DHRUVA & THE TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE

Dhruva, a son of Krishna I, was a dynamic ruler who defeated his brother to rule over the Rashtrakuta kingdom. He set his eyes on Kannauj and had to face-off with Dharmapala (Pala) from the east and Vatsaraja (Pratihara) from the west. He handed a crushing defeat to both their armies and planted the Rashtrakuta flag in Kannauj.



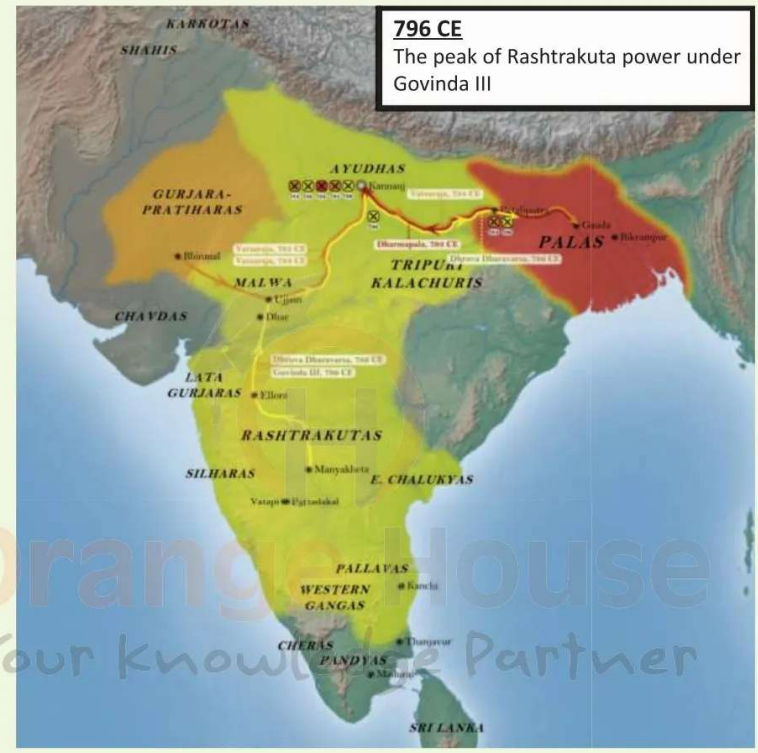
GOVINDA III - THE PEAK OF RASHTRAKUTA POWER

After the death of Dhruva, the young Govinda III stepped up in 793 CE. He had to face the wrath of his brothers who didn't get the throne. Kambha was the eldest and most powerful. Govinda III proved his

worthiness as king by defeating a confederation of 12 rulers single-handedly. He didn't go on a revenge spree* though. Convinced of their loyalty, he appointed his brothers as viceroys – **Kambha** for Gangavaadi, **Indra** for Laata.

After settling disputes at home, Govinda III captured Kannauj.

Taking advantage of Govinda's focus in the north, the Pallava, Pandya, Chera and Ganga rulers joined hands to attack his southern territories. Govinda raced down south and by 802 CE defeated all of them. Most rulers from Kashmir to Kanchi submitted to him. Even the embassy of Ceylon (Sri Lanka) surrendered to him. Govinda III was the crown jewel of the Rashtrakutas.



AMOGHAVARSHA - THE LONGEST PEACEFUL REIGN

Govinda III was succeeded by his young son **Amoghavarsha** in 814 CE. The Eastern Chaulukyas and Gangas created widespread chaos and rebellion in the empire after the death of Govinda III. King Amoghavarsha's reign continued for the longest period of 64 years, despite constant troubles thrusted by the enemies. Every time there was a conflict, he had to defend and reclaim his territories and return peace to the state.

Amoghavarsha was known for his religious pursuits. He spent a lot of time with Jaina monks. He lived his life as a synthesis of the choiciest principles of Jainism and Hinduism. He was an author himself and a patron of authors. He wrote the Kavirajamarga, the earliest work on Kannada poetry. The fine workmanship in his palace reflects his aesthetic sense. He is celebrated as the builder of the city of Manyakheta (Malkhed).

DECLINE OF THE RASHTRAKUTAS

After Amoghavarsha's death in 878 CE, a series of wars ensued. **Krishna II**, the new king, strengthened his military support through matrimonial alliances.

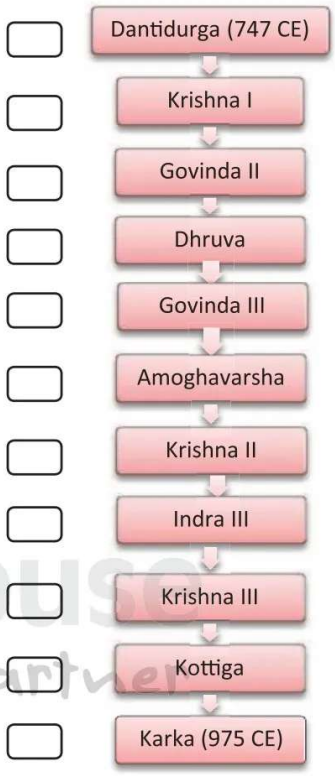
Spree : Outburst of extreme activity

Indra III defeated Mahipala and planted the flag of Rashtrakutas again in Kannauj. **Krishna III** again expanded the kingdom over the entire Deccan region. He established Rashtrakutas as the lords of the Deccan again, penetrating until Rameshwaram in 965 CE.

The later rulers **Khottiga** and **Karka** lacked military capacity and hence the Rashtrakutas were defeated and plundered. Tailapa II, a descendant of the Badami Chaulukyas and a feudatory of the Rashtrakutas, grabbed the opportunity to openly revolt against the Rashtrakutas. By 975 CE, he established his rule and became the overlord of the Deccan. Thus began the rule of **Western Chaulukyas,** with Kalyani as their capital (also called Kalyani Chaulukyas).

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Can you find the number of years these kings ruled?



GLORIOUS RULE OF THE RASHTRAKUTAS

Despite repeated wars, the Rashtrakuta empire was effectively administered. Let us look at some of the important facets of their administration:

- The kingdom was divided into rashtras (provinces) governed by Rashtrapatis. These were further divided into Vaishyas, under Vaishyapatis. Next sub-division was the Bhukti comprising 50-70 villages, under supervision of Bhupatis. Each village was under a Gramapati. It is interesting that many of these terms are used even today. The central authority was the king and his immediate circle of ministers.
- The kings took up to Vaishnavism or Shaivism, but they supported Buddhists and Jains equally. There was religious harmony.
- Education was given prime importance – Bijapur had its own university at Salatogi.
- Kannada literature blossomed under the Rashtrakutas. Famous Kannada poets Pampa and Ponna lived during this period.
- Copper mines in the region became a major contributor to the state's revenue. The capital Manyakheta and Devagiri were diamond trading centres. The port of Bharoch (Gujarat) was ever-buzzling with export activities. Trade between Deccan Bharat and Arabs flourished. Horse trading was an important and profitable business.

THE GURJARA-PRATIHARAS

The Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty (800 CE - 1100 CE) was brought back into prominence by Nagabhata I who was instrumental in preventing Arab armies from moving towards the east of the Indus River. According to Arab accounts, they were successful in stopping Muslim conquests of Bharat for nearly 400 years. Nagabhata I brought many regions that were being overrun by the Arabs under his kingdom. Nandipuri, Malwa, part of Rajputana and Gujarat came under his rule that is estimated to have been till 756 CE. Kannauj was their capital. Amongst the famous rulers of this dynasty, the name of Raja Mihira Bhoja (Bhoja I) especially stands out for his successful efforts in driving out invaders, as well as his contribution in the fields of science and art. Under Bhoja I, the territory of the Gurjara-Pratiharas spread from the foothills of the Himalayas in

the north to the Narmada river in central Bharat and from the lower Ganga valley in the East to Sindh in the west.

The next prominent ruler of the Pratiharas was **Vatsaraja** who ascended the throne in 778 CE. Vatsaraja enlarged the kingdom and defeated Dharmapala (Pala king of Bengal). While Vatsaraja was fighting with Dharmapala and also expanding his kingdom, the Rashtrakuta king Dhruva saw an opportunity and attacked Vatsaraja. Dhruva won and captured Kannauj.

FURTHER EXPANSION OF THE GURJARA-PRATIHARAS

Vatsaraja was succeeded by his son **Nagabhata II**. Nagabhata II was known to be an effective warrior from a very young age and captured forts like Anartta and Malava. He expanded the kingdom towards northern Gujarat and was successful in winning over Saindhava territory in western Kathiawar. Andhra, Kalinga and Vidarbha paid tribute to Nagabhata II. He is credited with winning back Kannauj after a fierce battle with the Pala ruler Dharmapala.

Nagabhata II was trying to consolidate his power but was defeated by the Rashtrakuta king Govinda III around 810 CE. However, Nagabhata II was able to establish the Gurjara-Pratiharas firmly in northern Bharat even after this defeat. The greater part of Rajputana, Kathiawar peninsula and lands stretching in the east to include Gwalior, Kannauj and Kalanjara. From a small, local power centre, the Gurjara-Pratiharas had grown into a major military and political power.

MIHIRA BHOJA AND OTHER PRATIHARA RULERS

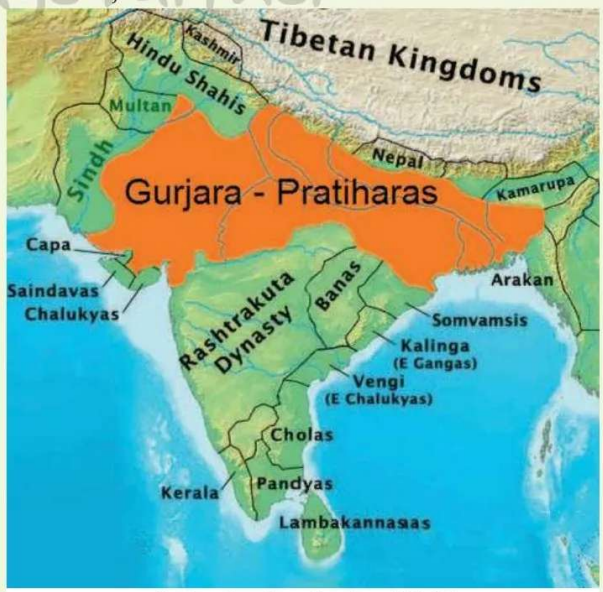
Nagabhata II's grandson, son of Ramabhadra, **Mihira Bhoja** (Bhoja I) ascended the throne in 836 CE and operated with Kannauj as his capital. Mihira Bhoja was one of the greatest rulers of the Gurjara-Pratiharas but this didn't come easy.

Raja Mihira Bhoja (836 - 885 CE)

By 843 CE, Bhoja brought some of the key regions his father had lost back into their kingdom. But soon he faced off in a battle with the Pala king Devapala where Mihira Bhoja lost. To change his fortunes, Bhoja moved south to invade Rashtrakuta territories. Here he faced defeat at the hands of Dhruva (around 860 CE). The Kalachuri king Kokalla also served a loss to Mihira Bhoja.

However, Mihira Bhoja didn't lose hope and waited for an opportune moment. With the passing away of Devapala, the Palas faced constant raids by the Rashtrakutas. Using this opportunity, Mihira Bhoja attacked Bengal and defeated Pala king Narayanapala and conquered his territories. Bhoja then trained his sights on the Rashtrakuta regions in Gujarat and was able to win over large tracts of land. Mihira Bhoja's reign lasted 46 years and his kingdom included Kathiawara peninsula, Punjab in the northwest, Kalachuri territories of Gorakhpur, Awadh and Bundelkhand. Under Bhoja I, the territory of the Gurjara-Pratiharas spread from the foothills of the Himalayas in the north to the river Narmada in central Bharat and from the lower Ganga valley in the east to Sindh in the west.

Raja Bhoja stood as a fort of defence against Islamic aggression and was a great empire builder.



Gurjara Pratihara Empire - 900 CE

Arab historian Sulaiman on Raja Mihira Bhoja

> …the Gurjara king maintains numerous forces and no other Indian prince has so fine a cavalry… Among the princes of India, there is no greater foe of the Muhammadan faith than he.

When Mihira Bhoja passed away in 885 CE, he was succeeded by his son **Mahendrapala I**. Mahendrapala I maintained the kingdom left by his father and further extended the kingdom. His spiritual preceptor Rajasekhara composed many literary works like Karpuramanjari, Prapanch Pandav, Bhrinjika and many more that throw light on the grandeur of the Pratihara kingdom and Kannauj.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

What can we learn from Raja Mihira Bhoja's life and his character?

GURJARA-PRATIHARA ADMINISTRATION

Effective administration helped the Pratiharas constantly expand their empire and defend against external aggression. The rulers adopted the highest position and titles like Maharajadhiraja and Parambhaterak. Samantas were the feudatory chiefs who were appointed by the rulers.The Samantas provided military and administrative support to the king and helped in local governance. Various positions were created for effective governance that included:

Tantrapala	-	King's representative in Samanta states
Dandanayaka	-	Head of Justice and Administration
Baladhikrat	-	Army chief
Dandapashika	-	Police chief
Kottapala	-	Head of fort
Mahattar	-	Village administration head

States were divided into bhuktis, bhuktis into mandalas, mandalas into cities and villages. Councils administered the cities and were called Goshti, Sanviyaka and Panchakula.

LIFE IN THE TIMES OF THE PRATIHARAS

There are many sources including literature, excavations, inscriptions, monuments, temples and foreign traveller accounts that shed light on society, art, culture and more during the times of the Gurjara-Pratiharas. Rajashekara's dramas narrate the prosperity of the kingdom and the high status accorded to women of those times. The Dharma of building water tanks, temples and other works of charity were done during the Gurjara -Pratihara period. Temples commissioned by Mihira Bhoja stand tall till today. The Gurjara-Pratiharas were patrons of arts, architecture and literature. The prosperous and open socio-religious life of the people of the Gurjara-Pratihara kingdom was a high point in the history of Bharat. The Chaturbhuj temple in Gwalior has inscriptions dating back to 876 CE. The Pratihara rulers supported all religious sentiments. This is supported by the fact that many generations of the Pratihara rulers starting from Devaraja were devotees of Vishnu, Shiva, Bhagavati and Surya.

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Khajuraho Temple in Madhya Pradesh

Bateshwar Temple complex, Morena

The Gurjaras are known for their sculptures, carved panels and open pavilion style temples. Their style of temple building is seen at Khajuraho, now a UNESCO* World Heritage site.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Attempt to draw the lineage of Gurjara Pratihara kings in a flow chart.

DECLINE OF THE GURJARA-PRATIHARAS

Mahendrapala I's reign ended in 908 CE and was succeeded by Mahipala. The period between 913 CE and 944 CE was filled with multiple losses for the Pratiharas under Mahipala and the subsequent rulers. Mahipala was defeated by his eternal foe, the Rashtrakuta king Indra III. Kannauj was plundered. There were many rulers after Mahipala that included Rajyapala (960 CE–1018 CE) and the last ruler Yashpala after whom the Gurjara-Pratiharas power came to an end.

THE PALAS

RISE OF THE EARLY PALAS

By the middle of the 8th century, the Pala dynasty started a new epoch in Bengal and Bihar. Realising the need for a strong central empire the independent petty chiefs came together and recognised the suzerainty of one political ruler whom they all trusted - **Gopala**. He was elected as king by the general body of people. Gopala established peace in the consolidated lands of eastern Bharat by defending against invasions. The dynasty ruled for 18 generations over four centuries.

DHARMAPALA CAPTURES KANNAUJ

In 770 CE **Dharmapala** succeeded his father, Gopala. The long-drawn power struggle with Gurjara-Pratihara from the west and Rashtrakutas from the Deccan, for ruling over Kannauj started during Dharmapala's time. Dharmapala was defeated by **Vatsaraja** (Pratihara dynasty), who in turn was defeated by Dhruva (Rashtrakuta dynasty). **Dhruva** turned back south after his victory. Dharmapala took this opportunity to conquer Kannauj and the major northern territories. In the presence of the chiefs of the surrounding kingdoms, Dharmapala placed his representative Chakrayudha as the king of Kannauj. By 800 CE, his victorious military campaigns expanded the empire from Indus in the west, to Kedara (Himalayas) in the north and beyond river Narmada in the south.

DEVAPALA'S GOLDEN REIGN

Devapala was born to Dharmapala and a Rashtrakuta queen Rannadevi. He was as skilled and brave as his father. When he was crowned the king in 810 CE, he peacefully inherited the vast empire and firmly

UNESCO : United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

established his authority. Devapala appointed his cousin Jayapala as his military general and undertook daring military missions. In the north-east, the king of Pragjyotisha surrendered without a fight and at Utkala (Odisha), the ruler abdicated his capital and fled away. He exterminated the last traces of Hunas (nomadic tribe from Central Asia) and proceeded to Kamboja. He also kept a check on his constant rivals, Bhoja I (Gurjara-Pratiharas) and Amoghavarsha (Rashtrakutas). He subjugated the Pandyas in the south. According to a later inscription by Narayanapala, Devapala's campaigns expanded the kingdom from the Himalayas to the Vindhyas and from the eastern to the western seas. Devapala ruled for at least 35 years.

The Pala empire's extent and glory diminished after Devapala. There was political turmoil in the kingdom following his death. Devapala's nephew Vigrahapala (son of Jayapala) took over the throne.

Pala empire under Devapala (810 - 850 CE)

DID YOU KNOW?

Devapala's fame rose beyond the borders of Bharat. When the king of the Sailendra dynasty (that ruled Java, Sumantra, Malay) requested him for a grant of 5 villages to support a monastery he had built inside Nalanda University, Devapala accepted. He held a privileged position in the Buddhist world.

MAHIPALA RESTORES THE PALA GLORY

Over the next five generations, the Palas lacked the vigour of their forefathers and lost a significant chunk of their territory. Powerful invaders like the Chandellas and Kalachuris stormed the kingdoms towards the end of the 10th century CE. Around the same time, the Kambhoja Gaudapatis declared their independence and conquered parts of western and northern Bengal. When the Pala kingdom shrunk to just parts of Bihar, there rose a dynamic Pala ruler who brought back the lost vitality – **Mahipala I**.

When Mahipala I took over in 988 CE, he recaptured Northern and Eastern Bengal within just 3 years of his accession. He restored the Buddhist monasteries that were built by his forefathers. His name is glorified in the ballads and folklore of Bengal.

Lineage of the Palas

DECLINE OF THE PALAS

The rise of feudal power led to the disintegration of the Pala Empire. Vijaya Sena, conquered Bengal, fighting the kings of Gauda, Kamarupa and Kalinga. He established independent power in Bengal immediately after the demise of Ramapala. The Pala dynasty found its end after nearly 400 years of rule.

Let us explore some of the facets of Pala's glorious rule – effective administration, flourishing art architecture and more.

ADMINISTRATION BY THE PALAS

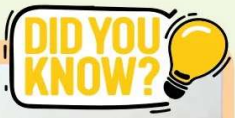
The early Palas could effectively maintain a vast kingdom because of their sound administrative policies. They adopted the Gupta's style of management and made it more efficient. Monarchical rule was followed. He was advised by the Prime Minister. The kingdom was divided into Vuktis (provinces), Vishayas (divisions), Mandalas (districts). The Palas patronised both Buddhists and Hindus. They gave land grants to

priests, temples, monasteries and peasants. Even the feudatory chiefs who served the empire by providing military services were given land grants. The Palas appointed an elaborate list of government officials– vassal kings, foreign minister, head ambassador, tax collector, accountant, head of land measurements, chief justice, police forces, secret service, head of dairy farms, goat farms, buffalo farms, to just name a few. Many copper plate inscriptions found from this era stands testimony of their superior administration. There was peace and harmony in the society because of the extensive public welfare activities undertaken like digging wells, establishing townships and serving justice.

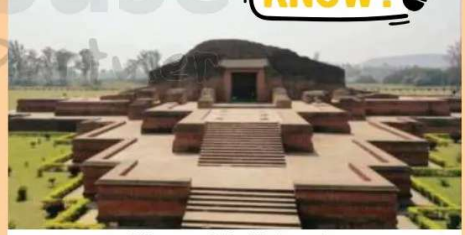
PALA'S EXCELLENCE IN ART & ARCHITECTURE

Somapura Mahavihara, Paharpur

Somapura Mahavihara, Paharpur built by Dharmapala is the largest Buddhist vihara in the Indian subcontinent. It was an educational center with residential facilities consisting of 177 rooms. It was built around a spacious courtyard with a Stupa in the center. The site covers an area of 27 acres of land that includes a quadrangular court measuring more than 900 feet. Dharmapala's father Gopala I had established the Odantapuri Vihara, the second oldest Mahavihara after Nalanda University.



Dharmapala established the famous Vikramashila University, with 114 teachers and about 1000 students. It produced eminent scholars like Atisha Dipankara (founder of the Sarma traditions of Tibetan Buddhism). Subjects like philosophy, grammar, metaphysics, logic etc. were taught here. It specialised in Tantrism and Vajrayana sect of Buddhism, housing several temples within the complex. There were six huge colleges with a big building at the centre.



Vikramashila University

Taking inspiration from this architecture, Buddhist monasteries in Myanmar and Indonesia were designed. Sculptural art and terracotta art reached their pinnacle during Pala rule. The Pala bronzes are considered to be examples of matured art. In the Buddhist manuscripts found from the region, more than 400 paintings are featured – this shows the artistic genius of the times. These paintings have influenced the Tibetian and Nepali paintings of the later 14th century.

FLOURISHING LITERATURE OF THE PALAS

The Pala's patronised several Sanskrit scholars. Many Buddhist Tantric works were authored and translated during the Pala rule. Sandhyakara Nandi was a talented Sanskrit poet who was patronised by the last Pala king Madanapala. He composed the most acclaimed literature of the times, Ramcharita, that described the conquest of Varendra (north Bengal) by King Ramapala. He interestingly compares the life of Ramapala and the Ramayana and earned the title Kalikalavalmiki for his work.

TRADE AND COMMERCE IN THE PALA LANDS

The main source of revenue for the state was from agriculture. Rice, sugarcane, mango, bamboo, coconut were the important agricultural products. The empire thrived in agro-based products. The Pala kings granted land to the farmers. Mineral resources were abundant in the region. Iron ore existed in plenty. They knew the process of smelting ore and were famous for manufacturing the double-edged sword. Bengal became the sought-after harbour for fine quality cotton fabrics and maintained trade of cotton goods with distant countries, like Arabia and China. Silk industry was very popular in Bengal and had a worldwide market. Gur (jaggery) produced in Bengal, was exported to countries like Ceylon, Arabia and Persia.

SOCIAL, CULTURAL AND RELIGIOUS RESURGENCE

Having looked at the major kingdoms that existed in this epoch* let us take a glimpse at the social, cultural, religious and literary aspects that were prevalent.

- This period (700 CE to 1000 CE) witnessed the continuation of the Dharmic lifestyle of the people from the previous era. There was also, the assimilation of new ideas from different thought systems. Dharmashastras became the basis for the conduct of all the people across the social strata.
- During this period women continued to be the center of the family system. They took part in all the social and religious activities. They held the rights to inherit property, manage real estate and express their opinion on politics and governance. Women were at par with men in education.
- Temples formed the nerve center of the economy - Textiles, metal making, toolmaking and jewellery design industries rose to great heights. Merchants enjoyed prosperity and supported the society by contributing to temple building, education, creating lakes, etc.
- Emperors maintained huge armies. Hence lots of soldiers were paid well. Kings became patrons of Vedas and Vedic sacrifices and donated graciously to the priests. Thus all sections of society lived prosperously with interdependence and mutual respect.
- This age saw a huge cultural and religious resurgence*. Among the trading class, Jainism gained popularity. Great scholars like Adi Shankaracharya, Ramanuja, the Alvars and the Nayanars lived and spread the Bhakti tradition that superseded all inequalities in the society. The idea of individual Bhakti became popular. Emphasis was laid on love, self-surrender, truth, morality and cleanliness. Women seers* like Andal, Akka Mahadevi, and Karaikkal Ammaiyar inspired people into the spiritual tradition of Bhakti.

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CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Why do you think the temple formed a central node in the social ecosystem of this period? Was there more to a temple, than just being a place of worship?

CONCLUSION

The period between 700 CE and 1000 CE witnessed a glorious display of valour, prosperity, and cultural resurgence. Great leaders ruled their empires in a dharmic way to find their place in the endless list of glorious rulers of Bharat. This was a period of great strength and achievement for Bharat. The rise and fall of the three major empires – Rashtrakutas, Gurjara Pratiharas, Palas – were witnessed in this epoch. The country saw vast cultural and religious resurgence and the Puranas served as a great source in bringing together the various sects of people. Art and architecture witnessed tremendous developments and concept of religious places (tirthas) strengthened the unity of Bharat. The rulers of Bharat served as protectors of Dharma. Philosophical literatures were generated in abundance during this period. Initial raids of external aggressors were thwarted but that was to change in the coming years.

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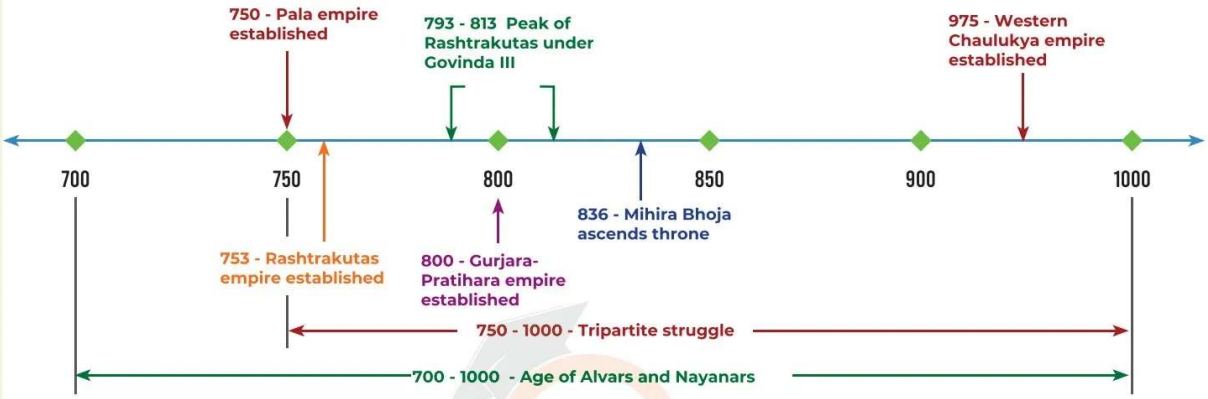
Epoch : Period of time **Resurgence :** Rising again to prominence **Seers :** One who sees with spiritual eyes

KEYWORDS

- Kannauj
- GDP
- Sone ki Chidiya
- Rashtrakutas
- Palas
- Gurjara-Pratihara
- Tripartite Struggle
- Krishna - I
- Ellora
- Amoghavarsha
- Mihira Bhoja
- Nagabhata
- Dharmapala
- Vikramashila
- Adi Shankaracharya
- Ramanuja

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The Rashtrakutas were the chieftains of _____ dynasty.
   a) Eastern Chaulukyas b) Kalyani Chaulukyas c) Badami Chaulukyas d) Pallavas
2. Under the reign of _____ , the Rashtrakuta empire extended to its maximum extent.
   a) Govinda I b) Govinda III c) Dhruva d) Amoghavarsha
3. _____ was the Gurjara-Pratihara king who stopped Arab armies from moving towards the east of the Indus River.
   a) Dharmapala I b) Bhoja I c) Nagabhata I d) Nagabhata II
4. True or False
   Statement A : King Dhruva of the Rashtrakutas won over King Vatsaraja of the Pratiharas.
   Statement B : King Dhruva of the Rashtrakutas won over King Dharmapala of the Palas.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) Both are false d) A & B are true

MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Raja Mihira Bhoja	He held a privileged position in the Buddhist world
Vatsaraja	Under him, Gurjara-Pratihara empire expanded from foothills of the Himalayas in the north to the Narmada river in the south
Devapala	He captured forts like Anartta and Malava
Nagabhata II	His dramas depicted the social life during the rule of the Gurjara-Pratiharas
Rajashekara	He defeated Dharmapala and expanded the kingdom, but got defeated by Dhruva in turn

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ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who built the Kailasanatha temple at Ellora? What are its special features?
2. Who was the Rashtrakuta king who ruled the longest? Why was his reign considered peaceful?
3. Who established the Western Chaulukyas? How did they end the rule of the Rashtrakutas?
4. Why were the cities of Manyakheta and Devagiri important to the Rashtrakutas? What were the main sources of revenue for the Rashtrakutas?
5. How was the military expansion of Nagabhata II important to the Gurjara-Pratiharas?
6. Give 2 examples to explain the social life under the Pratiharas.
7. Give 2 reasons on why Devapala's rule was called the golden period of Pala's reign?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. What is GDP? Between 1 and 1000 CE, how did Bharat contribute to 32% of world GDP?
2. What is Tripartite Struggle? Why was Kannauj an important city to rule?
3. Write a short note on the achievements of any 3 kings of the Rashtrakuta clan.
4. Explain 4 major examples highlighting the glorious rule of the Rashtrakutas.
5. Why was Raja Mihira Bhoja's rule important in the reign of the Gurjara Pratiharas?
6. Mahipala's name is glorified in the ballads and folklore of Bengal - Why is it so? Cite reasons.
7. Who established the Vikramashila University? What were its key features?
8. Write a short note on the flourishing art and literature during the Pala rule.
9. Explain any 3 points about the religious and cultural renaissance during the 700-1000 CE in Bharat.

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. (a) Western Chaulukyas make Kalyani their capital
   (b) Krishna III expands the Rashtrakuta empire
   (c) Govinda III is succeeded by Amoghavarsha
   (d) Kailasa temple is built
2. (a) Devapala expands the Pala empire to its maximum
   (b) Dharmapala builds the Somapura Mahavihara
   (c) Gopala is elected as the king of the Palas
   (d) Vijaya Sena establishes an independent empire in Bengal

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PICTURE BASED QUESTIONS
MAP WORK

1. Where can this monument be found?
2. Who built this monument?
3. On which currency issued by the Government of India, can you find this monument?

1. Where can this UNESCO monument be found?
2. What style of architecture does it depict?
3. Who were the deities worshipped by this lineage of rulers?

Mark the following places on the outline map of India

- The place where Kailasa temple was built by Krishna I.
- The place to control where the Tripartite struggle happened.
- The city built by Amoghavarsha.

Chapter 2

EARLY RESISTANCE TO INVADERS

"The Muhammadan conquest of India is probably the bloodiest story in history. It is a discouraging tale, for its evident moral is that civilization is a precarious thing, whose delicate complex of order and liberty, culture and peace may at any time be overthrown by barbarians invading from without or multiplying within"

- Will Durant

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Assess the causes of foreign invasions into Bharat and the destruction caused by the invaders
- Identify the bravehearts of Bharat who offered stiff resistance to the barbaric invaders
- Discuss the outcome and impact of the significant battles fought by the Bharatiya rulers against the unethical tyrants

INTRODUCTION

In the beginning of the 8th century CE, the Arabs, having conquered Baghdad, Syria, Persia, Egypt and Carthage in northern Africa, crossed over the Gulf of Gibraltar and entered the Iberian Peninsula around 711 CE. The following year, they conquered Sindh as well. Since they now controlled both land and sea routes in the region, they were able to cut the direct link between Bharat and Europe, affecting trade and commerce. However, the valorous kings of Bharat prevented the influx of the Islamic invaders into mainland Bharat between 700 and 1000 CE.

During this period, Bharat flourished in every aspect and was known for her mastery over the subjects of mathematics, philosophy, logic, ethics, statecraft, military sciences, medicine, pharmacology, toxicology, veterinary sciences, astronomy and astrology. Arab authors like Sulaiman and Al-Biruni attempted to chronicle the same in their works. The systems, rules and customs of ancient Bharat were invaded, subdued and modified by a succession of conquerors. The invaders who came in brought with them a new religion, language and a new way of governance that unsettled the native spirit of the land.

FORAY* OF ARABS AND TURKS

Bharat's citizens lived a life of abundance and prosperity. Those who arrived as visitors to witness the grandeur of our nation stood astonished and awestruck. At the same time, Bharat could also not escape the predatory eyes of a section of the globe. The Arabian and Turkic kings who held an intolerant religious belief, intending to establish Islamic rule in Bharat and to create a fortune by plundering our wealth forayed into Bharat from across the borders. Let us look into the attempts of invasions and the way Bharat's bravehearts defended and repulsed them at most times.

Forayed : To enter/invade into a new region

EARLY ARAB INVADERS DEFEATED BY BHARAT'S RULERS

Attempt 1 : Around 636 CE - Naval attack on Bharat ordered by Caliph Omar at Thane.
Attempt 2 : 637 CE at Bharuch in Gujarat.
Attempt 3 : Around 643 CE - By sea at Debal (near modern day Karachi).

BATTLE OF KIKAN

By 650 CE, the Arabs had established their power in France and Central Asia. Keen to conquer Bharat, the Caliph (Islamic head) sanctioned an expedition to attack the Sindh region again. A large army led by Haras Ibn Marra-al-Abdi reached the frontier of Sindh at a place called Kikan. Kikan, a small state near the Bolan Pass, was made up of different pastoral clans from the Jat community coming under the administration of Sindh. The Jats of Kikan crushed the superior military force of Haras. Haras was killed and a few survivors from his army retreated to inform the Caliph of the defeat. Sindh put up a brave front, under the leadership of **Raja Chach** (622 CE - 662 CE). His kingdom was very powerful extending up to the borders of Kashmir and Kannauj in the north and Kirman in the east.

BATTLE OF KIKAN	
When? 663 CE	
Where? Kikan, Sindh	
Who were the combatants?	
Jats of Kikan	Caliph's army
Who were the commanders?	
Jat Commander	Haras ibn Marra-al-Abdi
Outcome : Arab army defeated	
SIGNIFICANCE : Bravery of the Jats	

SINDH DEFENDED BY RAJA DAHIR & RAJA JAISIMHA

Six attempts were made by the Caliph to capture Sindh. Five of the attempts were defeated by the kings of Bharat even though the armies of the Caliph were militarily superior in number and resources. It was only in 680 CE that Makran fell to the Arabs. To avenge the long years of resistance of Sindh, the governor of Iraq, Al Hajjaj sent Ubaidullah to raid Debal, a seaport in Sindh. Sindh was under the leadership of **Raja Dahir** (663 CE - 712 CE). In the battle that followed, Ubaidullah was killed and the Arabs retracted. A second and a larger army was sent under Budail. Army under Budail launched an attack on Sindh that was bravely defended by **Jaisimha**, the son of Raja Dahir. A pitched* battle ensued. In the end, the invading Islamic army was routed and Budail was killed.

Raja Dahir

SINDH LOST

Unable to come to terms with the Arab army's humiliating defeats, Al Hajjaj despatched his nephew Muhammad Bin Qasim to attack Debal. In 712 CE, Qasim led the Arab Muslim armies into a fierce battle with Raja Dahir (663 CE-712 CE). One of Raja Dahir's chieftains, Mokah, betrayed his king and kingdom and joined the invaders. In the ensuing battle, Raja Dahir laid down his life. After Raja Dahir's death, his widowed queen Rani Bai fought bravely. When she could not withstand the attack, burnt herself along with other women to escape the infamy* of falling into the hands of the invaders. Women preferred to give up their life over being treated as slaves by the enemies, their honour came first. Sindh fell into the hands of the aggressors.

> "I am going to meet the Arabs in open battle and fight them as best as I can. If I crush them, my kingdom will then be put on a firm footing. But if I am killed... it will be said that Raja Dahir of Sindh sacrificed his precious life for the sake of his country, in fighting with the enemy."

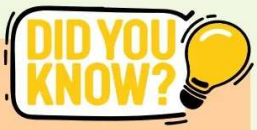
Pitched : Intense **Infamy :** Being infamous

Bharat got to see the viciousness* of the invaders. Raja Dahir's head was cut and sent to the Caliph. Qasim and his army killed the soldiers of Dahir, looted the wealth of Sindh and took the women and children as slaves. The captured people were converted to Islam. Temples were destroyed and mosques were built using the spoils of war. Bharat had not seen such cruelty during wars.

Mulasthana (present-day Multan in Pakistan), a great city with a grand civilization dating back thousands of years, fell to Qasim's army. It was considered a very important sacred pilgrimage centre like Kashi, Mathura and Prayag. The grand Aditya temple in Mulasthana was the nerve centre of the city. The entire wealth was plundered and a part sent back to the Caliph.

SINDH RECLAIMED

Arab occupation of Sindh did not last long. Around 715 CE, Qasim who was the governor of Sindh was called back to Iraq where he died. Junaid Ibn Marri took over as governor of Sindh and tried moving further into Bharat during 723 CE. He set his eye on Ujjain only to face a defeat at the hands of an emerging hero of the times – Nagabhata I. Nagabhata founded the Gurjara -Pratihara dynasty, 'Pratihara' literally meaning 'gate keeper'.



Pratiharas were considered to be the descendants of Lakshmana, brother of Sri Rama. Prince Lakshmana acted as a doorkeeper to his elder brother King Rama. Hence the Pratiharas adopted this title.

Nagabhata fought the invading Arab army and destroyed it. The Guhila army under Bappa Rawal helped Nagabhata in driving away the invaders. The Arabs then tried to gain access further north, through the mountains of Kashmir, where they were stopped and decisively defeated by Lalitaditya Muktapida in alliance with the king of Kannauj Yashovarman. The Arabs then tried the south route reaching a place called Navsari, which was under the prince Avani-Janasraya Pulakeshin belonging to the dynasty of Chaulukyas of Vatapi. Pulakeshin defeated the Arabs. Facing defeat at every location, the Arabs fled Sindh, crossing the river Sindhu. Sindh was thus reclaimed.

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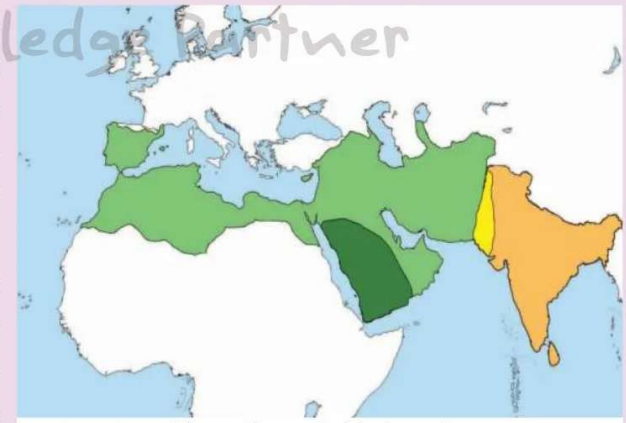
RESISTANT BHARAT

Have a look at the map. The area in dark green was the extent of the Arab empire after the death of Prophet Muhammad in the year 632 CE. By 712 CE, in just a matter of 80 years, the caliphates subjugated vast geographies marked in light green.



The rapid spread of Arab empire

In the case of Bharat, it took 70 years just to breach the border and occupy its farthest territories-Sindh (parts of current-day Pakistan, marked yellow on the map). Even their occupation of Sindh lasted for 20 years. They were pushed beyond river Sindhu effectively reducing their presence to two small states of Mansura and Multan.

Viciousness : Cruel and immoral

FRONTIER FIREWALLS

Despite being one of the mightiest armies of the world, the Arabs feared some of the bravehearts of Bharat. Their very names sounded the death knell to invaders. We will now look into some of the unsung heroes who successfully defended Bharat.

BAPPA RAWAL

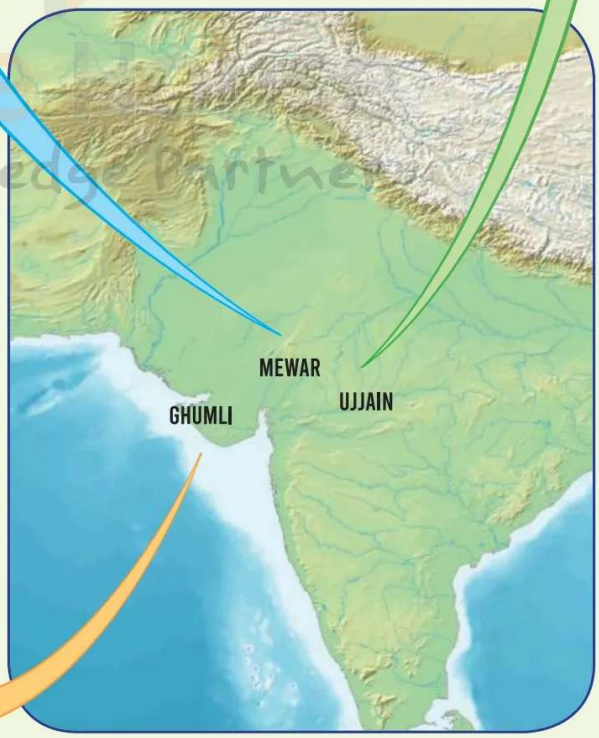
Among those who drove away the Arabs, Bappa Rawal is a very significant warrior and statesman.
He destroyed the Arab armies and chased them into the deep desert beyond Ghazni. To fortify the northwest Frontier, Bappa Rawal built a city named Rawalpindi, which is still surviving in Pakistan today. From the military base in Rawalpindi, Bappa Rawal launched more than 15 attacks on Ghazni, Afghanistan expanding the kingdom of Mewar up to Iran. Great warriors like Rana Sangha, Maharana Pratap and Rana Uday Singh are all Bappa Rawal's descendants.

MIHIRA BHOJA

Hailing from the Pratihara dynasty, Mihira Bhoja was one of the few kings who had a very long reign of almost 50 years. He was a nightmare to the Arabs who describe Bhoja thus: "This king maintains numerous forces and no other Indian prince has so fine a cavalry. He is unfriendly to the Arabs but acknowledges their greatness. Among the princes of India, there is no greater foe of the Muhammadan faith than he."

AGGUKA I

Agguka I (r. c. 770 - c. 790) was a ruler of a lesser-known Saindhava dynasty of coastal Gujarat. In 756 CE the governor of Sindh sent a naval fleet against the Saindhavas which was repulsed by the strong navy of Agguka. Later in 776 CE, another naval expedition by the Arabs was defeated. Saindhava inscriptions that have been excavated provide the following details - Agguka I defeated the Arab navy and forced the Arabs to flee. Due to this the Caliph, Al Mahdi, gave up the project of conquering any part of Bharat through the sea routes. Agguka I was titled "Samudradipati" or "master of the seas".



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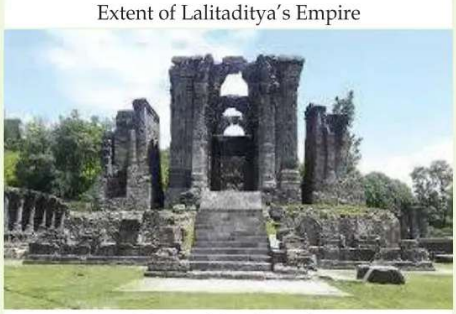
CONTRIBUTIONS MADE BY THE DYNASTIES OF BHARAT

KARKOTAS & LOHARA

The most famous emperor of the Kashmir Karkota dynasty was **Lalitaditya Muktapida** (724 CE-760 CE). This dynasty ruled over North-Western Bharat from 625 CE until 885 CE. The Lohara dynasty succeeded the Karkota dynasty.

Kalhana, in his book Rajatarangini praises king Lalitaditya's fierce military campaign in Northern Bharat and Central Asia. Lalitaditya's empire not only spread across major portions of Bharat, but also ran into present day Afghanistan and Central Asia. He commissioned several temples in Kashmir, including the Martand Sun temple. Kashmir's prosperity enticed Islamic invaders to want to gain complete control over it. Lalitaditya defeated Junaid, the Arab Governor of Sindh in a battle thus preventing the Arabs' attempt to plunder Kashmir. He also defeated the Momin of Uzbekistan four times and killed him in the fifth battle. Art, architecture, culture and learning flourished so greatly right through his rule that it went down in history as the golden age of Kashmir. He established several towns, including a new capital at Parihasapura while maintaining the traditional capital at Srinagar. Lalitaditya was a great ruler who impacted not just Bharat but also central and south Asia. Kashmir under Lalitaditya assumed prime importance in the political, spiritual and cultural spheres.

Extent of Lalitaditya's Empire


Martand Sun Temple

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DID YOU KNOW?

The Rajatarangini of Kalhana highlights the wealth of Bharat during Lalitaditya's period. He constructed many temples in Parihaspura (22km northwest of current day Srinagar). The major temples housed grand deities (murthis) of :

- Parihasa Keshava made of 3,600 kgs of silver
- Muktha Keshava made of 979 kgs of gold
- Narhari suspended in air by fixing magnets above and below the murthi

Lalitaditya erected a copper statue of Buddha weighing 62,000 kg during his period. Most temples built by Lalitaditya were looted and destroyed when invaders took over the regions ruled by him.

Lalitaditya Muktapida

BRAVE INDIAN QUEENS OF THE LOHARA DYNASTY

Rani Sugandha (902 CE–906 CE)

Rani Sugandha of Kashmir was married to Raja Shankaravarman of Utpala. Kalhana's Rajatarangini documents her as having accompanied her husband on many military conquests. On Raja Shankaravarman's untimely death, Rani Sugandha took over as regent of Kashmir and her young son Gopalavarman was placed on the throne. The towns of Sugandhapura and Gopalapura in Kashmir were built by Rani Sugandha.

Coins released during Rani Sugandha's rule

Rani Didda (958 CE–1003 CE)

Rani Didda of Kashmir was a powerful ruler who was the grand daughter of Raja Bhima Shahi. Bhima Shahi was the ruler of Kapisa (Kabul) and Gandhara (Kandahar). Didda's father ruled Lohara and she married the king of Kashmir, Kshemagupta. On the death of her husband, she ruled as regent for around 20 years after which she directly ruled Kashmir as its queen. Popular British archaeologist Aurel Stein remarks about Didda that she remained in peaceful possession of the Kashmir till her end, and was able to bequeath* it to her family in undisputed possession.

Coins released during Rani Didda's rule

ISLAMIC INVASIONS ON BHARAT

The frontiers of Bharat were starting to get tested by the external invaders. Areas around present day Afghanistan were under the Hindu-Shahi kings who started facing these invaders. Sabuktijin (977 CE to 997 CE) was the first Muslim ruler who attempted the invasion of Bharat from the North-West.

THE INVADERS FROM GHAZNI

The word Ghazni means Jewel. Ghazni was geographically in a strategic position. It was on the main path that connected Gandhara (now Kandahar) and southern Afghanistan. Ghazni was captured by Alp-Tjins the father-in-law of Sabuktijin. Sabuktijin started attacking the Shahi kings and this land route proved vital in the later invasions.

RAJA JAYAPALADEVA, THE FRONTIER HERO

Raja Jayapaladeva, ruler of Udbhandapura belonged to the Hindu Shahi dynasty. The Shahis were kings of North-Western Bharat and commanded a vast region that included the Kabul Valley, Gandhara, Laghman, Kashmir, Sirhind, and Peshawar. Seeing the rising power of Sabuktijin, Jayapaladeva started strengthening his kingdom's defences. He also recruited the help of the previous ruler of Zabul, Abu Ali Lawik, to strengthen the defence. Not only was local help taken but also Jayapaladeva was able to convince rulers of far-flung kingdoms. Troops came from Ajmer, Delhi, Kannauj and Kalinjar. With this combined might Jayapaladeva attacked Sabuktijin in Ghazni around 987 CE.

Raja Jayapaladeva

The battle for Kabul was long and resulted in loss of many lives. Due to the harsh weather, Jayapaladeva was forced to negotiate for peace. However, it wasn't an offer of surrender.

In a letter to Sabuktijin, Jayapaladeva thundered,

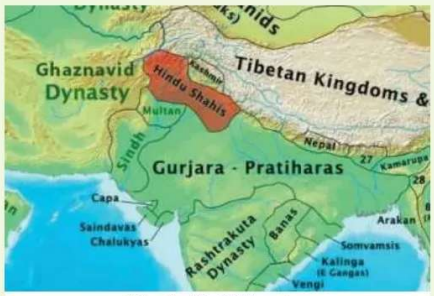
> "You know the nobleness of Hindus. They fear not death or destruction. In affairs of honour and fame we would place ourselves upon the fire like roast meat, and upon the dagger like the sunrays."

BATTLE OF KABUL	
When? 987 CE	
Where? Ghazni	
Who were the combatants?	
Hindu Shahi	Ghaznavid
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Jayapaladeva	Sabuktijin
Outcome : Jayapaladeva loses	
SIGNIFICANCE : Sabuktijin takes full control of Kabul valley	

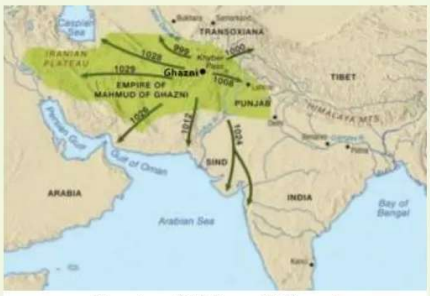
Bequeath : Entrust

The peace agreement was however short-lived. The fighting resumed and Jayapaladeva was defeated and driven out of Kabul. Sabuktijin now had control of the entire Kabul valley and the river Sindhu. Sabuktijin died soon after and a power struggle started. His younger son Ismail who was appointed his successor got overthrown by the elder son Mahmud, infamously referred to as Mahmud of Ghazni.

RISE OF MAHMUD GHAZNI AND FALL OF RAJA JAYAPALADEVA



Hindu Shahi Empire



Empire of Mahmud Ghazni

Mahmud Ghazni on taking up the throne started consolidating power by gaining control over key regions of Central Asia, Seistan and Iran. He then shifted his focus to Bharat. Mahmud used the Caliphate's recognition that enabled him to command armies and attack Bharat. Mahmud Ghazni set out on a war to raise the standards of Islam and exert its dominance over the non-believers of Islam.

In 1001 CE Mahmud attacked Jayapaladeva near Purushapura (present-day Peshawar). During a period of time that was negotiated to be peacetime, Mahmud launched a surprise attack on Jayapaladeva's armies. Utter confusion within the ranks of Jayapaladeva's armies resulted in a quick win for Mahmud. Following his defeat, Jayapaladeva was taken prisoner.

What followed was massive loot and plunder of Jayapaladeva's kingdom. Hindu temples were broken. Jayapaladeva, his family and ministers were tortured, chained and paraded in the streets. Thousands of women and children were taken away as slaves and forcibly converted to Islam. Jayapala was then released on the condition that he would pay a compensation of fifty elephants plus 2,00,000 dirhams. Until then, he had to leave his son and grandson as hostages. After his release from Mahmud's bondage, Jayapaladeva wrote to his son Anandapala and publicly declared to his citizens that he was unfit to rule any longer. He thought himself unworthy of the throne he occupied, and burnt himself on a funeral pyre to which he set fire with his own hands. This was a demonstration of the Hindu sense of honour.

BATTLE OF PURUSHAPURA	
When?	1001 CE
Where?	Purushapura
Who were the combatants?	
Hindu Shahi	Ghaznavid
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Jayapaladeva	Mahmud Ghazni
Outcome : Jayapaladeva loses	
SIGNIFICANCE : Mahmud Ghazni takes control of Peshawar	

A WAR OF MANY FIRSTS FOR BHARAT

The attack by Mahmud was in many ways a kind of war that Bharat had not faced. There were no rules, ethics or concern for non-fighting people. Bharat is a land of honour and valour. Its kings followed the rules of war mentioned in Dharmashastras, Ramayana and Mahabharata This was in sharp contrast to the Islamic invaders who indulged in deception, treachery, and cruelty. Historical accounts of the invasions mention that the purpose behind the invasions was driven by religious ideology.

The invaders indulged in destroying all temples, large scale looting and destruction of cities, forcibly converting people to Islam, taking women and children as slaves for sale in overseas markets.

The Ghazni army used foul and vile tactics against the Hindu soldiers to disgust them on the battlefield. For example, they used faeces mixed in water and splashed on the fighting Hindu warriors. The Ghazni army took advantage of the disgust triggered in the Hindu soldiers and killed them

Dr KM Munshi (Indian independence movement activist, educationist) says:

> The Indian Kings, all of whom accepted the law of Dharmasastras, waged wars according to certain humane rules. The shrine, the Brahmana, cow were sacrosanct to them. War being a special privilege of the martial class, harassment of the civilian population was considered a serious lapse. The high regard which all the Kshatriyas had for the chastity of women, also ruled out abduction as an incident of war.
>
> The wars in Central Asia, on the other hand were for the destruction of the enemies and for appropriating* the womenfolk…. When, therefore, Mahmud's army swept over North India, it saw torrents of barbarians sweeping its rich plains, burning, looting, indulging in indiscriminate massacre….burning down magnificent shrines enriched by centuries of faith, enforcing an alien religion at the point of sword, capturing hundreds of thousands of men, women and children to be sold as slaves in the market of Ghazni.

RESILIENCE OF BHARAT

Over the next several years, Mahmud Ghazni captured Bhatia, Multan, Bhatinda, Nagarkot, Thanesar, Mathura, Kannauj, Gwalior and Banaras. Every city he conquered was subject to untold horrors. However, he was always met with brave resistance in all places and Mahmud had to suffer heavy losses. We explore here, some of the key events during his incursions* into Bharat.

SANGRAMARAJA CRUSHES GHAZNI AGAIN AND AGAIN

Sangramaraja ruled the regions near Kashmir from 1003 to 1028 CE and founded the Lohara dynasty. Expansion of their kingdom was considered part of Kshatriya Dharma, duties of Hindu kings. They took great pride in their religion, ancestry and the inherited wisdom. The idea of forsaking all that the previous generations had held dear to them and accepting an alien religion under pressure was inconceivable to the Bharatiya royals like Sangramaraja.

Sangramaraja

BATTLE OF KASHMIR	
When?	1003 to 1021 CE
Where?	Tosha Maidan Pass, Kashmir
Who were the combatants?	
Kingdom of Lohara	Ghaznavids
Who were the commanders?	
Sangramaraja	Mahmud Ghazni
Outcome : Retreat of Mahmud Ghazni	
SIGNIFICANCE : **Mahmud Ghazni never returns to Bharat**	

Sangramaraja had helped Trilochanapala, the grandson of Raja Jayapaladeva, to fight Mahmud's armies. To take revenge Mahmud Ghazni attacked Kashmir in 1014 CE. Entering through the Toshamaidan pass, Mahmud attacked the forts of Sangramaraja. The fort city was well defended by Sangramaraja's able forces. Mahmud tried attacking on multiple points but all were met with brilliant counter moves by Sangramaraja. The siege and fighting continued at multiple places for more than a month when heavy snowfall began in the region. Mahmud's armies were split and couldn't communicate with each other. The strong defence of Sangramaraja forced Mahmud to retreat. Mahmud Ghazni returned in seven years

Appropriate : To take possession of **Incursion :** Invasion

to attempt capturing Kashmir again. Yet again the brave soldiers of the Lohara king fought and drove away Mahmud. Tasting multiple defeats Mahmud retreated to never come back to Kashmir.

Similarly around 1018 CE, when Mahmud Ghazni was trying to invade the regions around Bundelkhand he was defeated by **Raja Vidyadhara Chandela** who stopped Mahmud's invasions into the east of Bharat. There were multiple defeats suffered by Mahmud Ghazni against Vidyadhara including the battle for the fort of Kalinjar around 1022 CE.

DESTRUCTION AND REBUILDING OF SOMNATH

Ruins of Somnath Temple destroyed by Mahmud Ghazni

In 1025 CE Mahmud Ghazni started another round of plunder by entering Bharat and reaching all the way upto Modhera. However sensing increased resistance, Mahmud Ghazni decided to move back towards Mulasthan. In 1026 CE, he attacked the city of Somnath. Which anchored around the famous Jyotirlinga Somnath was a prosperous city which was plundered by Mahmud Ghazni. Many thousands of devotees of Somnath who had assembled to protect the Shivalinga were killed mercilessly. The Shivalinga was broken into pieces and the pieces were sent to be placed on the footsteps of the public mosque and a palace in Ghazni and Mecca for people to trample* over. The gold and precious items in the temple were taken away and the entire temple was set on fire.

DID YOU KNOW?

Mahmud Ghazni killed more than 40,000 people who were trying to protect the temple from getting destroyed.

Life returned to normal very quickly. Within 5 years Gujarat, richer and more powerful than before, rebuilt the Somnath temple on a more magnificent scale. It created the artistic wonders of the Dilwara temple. Neighbouring kingdoms, that included Malwa and parts of Gujarat, were enjoying great prosperity associated with the enthusiastic pursuit of learning, literature and art.

DID YOU KNOW?

- Somnath Temple before being destroyed had 3 lakh visitors during eclipses.
- 2000 villages were granted to the temple by various kings for the maintenance of the temple.
- Shivalinga was anointed with Ganga Jal brought from Haridwar, about 1500 km away.
- 2000 Brahmin priests were engaged to perform pooja.
- 300 barbers were employed to tonsure the devotees.
- One gold chain that supported a giant temple bell weighed 8000 kg. Its value today would be INR 3600 crores!

DID YOU KNOW?

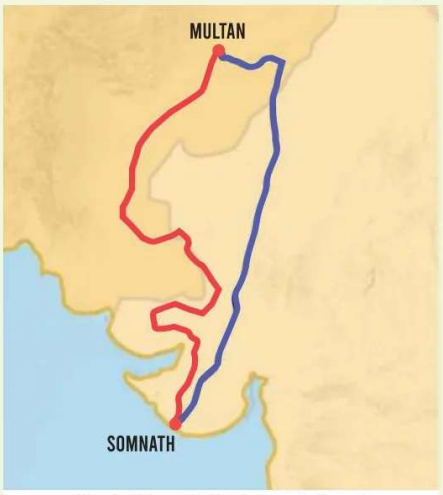
The temple of Somanth was destroyed and rebuilt 17 times. Its final reconstruction was done when Bharat became independant in the year 1951.

Trample : to walk over, heavily

GHAZNI FEARS RAJA BHOJA - TAKES DETOUR

Raja Bhoja

After looting Somnath, Mahmud Ghazni started moving up towards Mulasthan. By this time, Raja Bhoja had organized an army to go after Mahmud. Raja Paramara Bhoja (Paramara dynasty) was one of the greatest kings of Bharat. He was not only a great military leader but also one of the greatest intellectuals. He wrote more than 80 books on topics ranging from grammar, music and poetics to architecture, chemistry, hydraulics, city and planning. Raja Bhoja had created a large army presence in Kathiawar through which Mahmud was planning to pass to reach Mulasthan (Multan). Mahmud decided to not risk passing through Kathiawar and was forced to go through a narrow inlet between Kutch and Kathiawar. Mahmud hired a guide to take his armies and wealth through the desert at Sindh. For three days the guide led them in circles within the desert. Many soldiers and war animals died of thirst. The guide, a devotee of Somnath, had outwitted Mahmud and was killed. As Mahmud and his armies neared Mulasthan, they were met by an army of Jats who attacked and killed many of Mahmud's soldiers and also took away part of the wealth. When Mahmud Ghazni reached Ghazni, he was left with a small fraction of his army and an even smaller portion of the wealth he had looted. Mahmud never returned to Bharat after this journey.



Route taken by Mahmud Ghazni

Note: the route in Blue was the ideal route that should have been taken. Ghazni and his army travelled in the route marked in Red across the great Indian Desert in the map.

Impact of Mahmud Ghazni's invasion:

1. Afghanistan and parts of Punjab were now under Islamic rule.
2. Mahmud Ghazni's tactics of invading Sindh became a proven example for the later invaders to follow.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Assume you were in the city of Somnath when Mahmud Ghazni attacked it. Discuss how this invasion and plunder would have your life.

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RAJA SUHELDEV DRIVES OUT THE LOOTERS

SALAR MASUD'S ENTRY

Mahmud Ghazni met his end in 1030 CE. However, there were remnants of the Ghaznavid dynasty that had evil designs on Bharat. In 1031 CE, Salar Masud the nephew of Mahmud Ghazni charged into Bharat with a large army of more than 100,000 soldiers and defeated the Delhi ruler **Raja Mahipal Tomar** and proceeded on towards Kannauj. Using Kannauj as a base, Salar Masud started to attack regions like Barabanki, Bahraich, Sitapur, Lucknow and Shravasti in the region of current-day Uttar Pradesh.

RAJA SUHELDEV'S TACTICS

Raja Suheldev was the eldest son of Raja Mangaldhwaja of Shravasti, chieftain of a small kingdom called. Suheldev was increasingly aware of the need to rid Bharat of invaders like Salar Masud. He brought together a federation of more than 21 Passi and Bhar chieftains who faced the risk of attack. However, unlike earlier kings, Suheldev was very aware of the unethical fighting tactics of invaders like Salar Masud. He understood that there were no rules that the invaders followed. Also, he understood that Salar Masud's army took cover behind cows when they came to battle as Hindus

Raja Suhel Dev

Suheldev was born in a socially under privileged family. But he rose to the level of a king, through his capability and valour.

would not attack cows. Multiple battles happened between the invaders and Suheldev's chieftains. After a minor setback, Raja Suheldev reorganized his tactics and army. After preparing for techniques to combat Salar Masud's army and their firepower, Raja Suheldev and his people were ready to fight Salar Masud's forces. In June 1033 CE, Raja Suheldev with his forces and with the active support of Raja Bhoja met Salar Masud's army at Chittaura Jheel in present day Bahraich.

BATTLE OF BAHRAICH

A fierce battle at Bahraich between the invaders and Bharatiyas under Raja Suheldev resulted in heavy casualties. Raja Suheldev was well prepared, making sure that he had reserve forces to come in at the correct time to keep attacking. Raja Suheldev went after Salar Masud and in the fight between them wounded him severely. The main commanders of Salar Masud were also killed or severely injured. With their leader down and their generals out of action, Salar Masud's army was headless. Salar Masud and his generals pleaded for mercy. They requested to be let go with their lives. Suheldev understood that if he allowed Salas Masud and his army to retreat, they would go back, recoup and attack Bharat again with a strengthened force. This would be very harmful for the people of Bharat. At this point, Raja Suheldev did what most kings of Bharat had failed to do. He killed Salar Masud and his generals. A few soldiers were spared to take the news back to the land of Ghazni.

BATTLE OF BAHRAICH	
When?	13 & 14 June 1033 CE
Where?	Bahraich, Uttar Pradesh
Who were the combatants?	
Kingdom of Shravasti	Ghaznavids
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Suhel Dev	Salar Masud
Outcome : Decisive Victory of Suhel Dev	
SIGNIFICANCE : No Islamic invasions for the next 150 years	

News of the complete destruction of the Ghaznavid army and the bravery and strictness of Raja Suheldev and his people spread far and wide. Salar Masud's defeat reached regions even beyond Ghazni. The Battle of Bahraich ensured that for the next 150 years, no Muslim invader set foot on the soil of Bharat out of fear.

Due to Raja Suheldev, Bharat was free from invasions for almost 150 years. That is, Bharat was free from the plunder of its wealth, destruction of its temples and its women and children were not taken as slaves. What would have been Bharat's loss if Raja Suhel Dev had only thought about his small kingdom and did not take the initiative to bring together several chieftains of the region?

CONCLUSION

Attempts of the Arab Muslim invaders who were ravaging Europe and Middle East were prevented for more than seven decades.

Noted historian KM Munshi in History & Culture of the Indian People – Vol. 4 writes.

> In spite of unremitting pressure, exerted for over centuries, the Arabs were only left with the two petty states of Mansura and Multan in the 9th and 10th centuries. When compared with their dazzling victories over the contemporary states in the Middle-East, in Europe and over Persia, this insignificant result obtained in India was a tribute to the superior military strength and political organisation of the Indians.

Notwithstanding* the military might of our kings, Bharat faced the type of wars that were unseen and unheard of. The rules of war were never followed by the invaders. The concept of a just war in Hinduism is based on right and wrong. The Arthashastra and Dharmashastras classified victorious kings into Dharmavijayi, Lobhavijayi and Asuravijayi. The Dharmavijayi extracts only a symbolic tribute from the defeated king. The Lobhavijayi takes over the territory and wealth of the vanquished*. The Asuravijayi, the cruelest, seizes the territory and wealth and kills all the soldiers of the defeated king. The Muslim invaders were far worse than even the Asuravijayi. They killed the people of the land, took the women and children as slaves, forcibly converted the surviving people to their religion, looted the wealth, destroyed temples, and committed unspeakable atrocities.

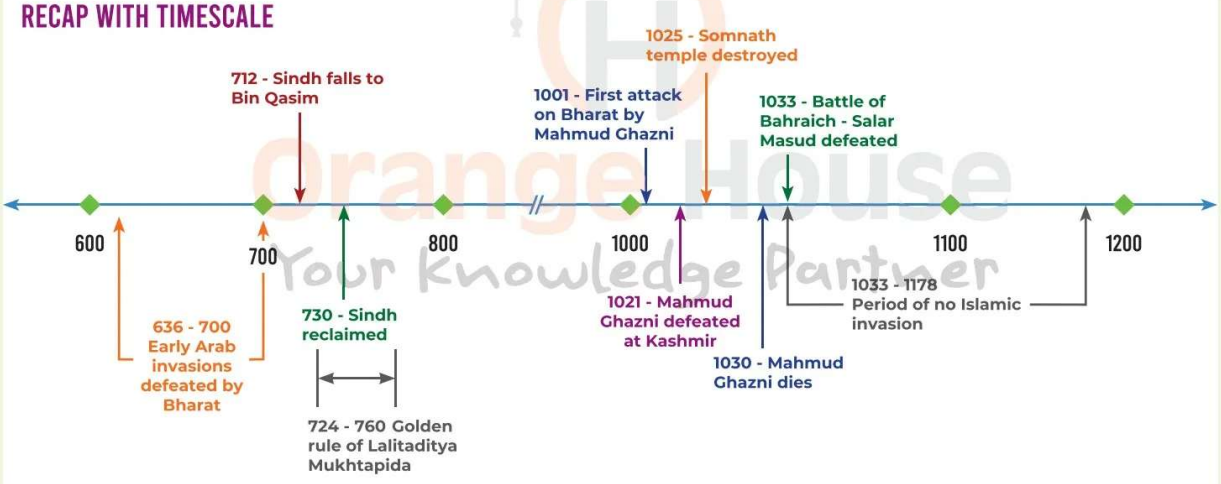
In the turn of the 11th century, many rulers of Bharat did not understand this vile* nature of the invaders and had to suffer the consequences at the hands of the Ghaznavids. However, there were visionary rulers like Raja Suheldev who understood the enemy and were able to prevent the influx of invaders for almost 150 years. As we turn the pages of history, Bharat faces its next challenge,

****

KEYWORDS

- Arabs and Turks
- Sindh
- Raja Chach
- Raja Dahir
- Muhammad bin Qasim
- Caliph
- Bappa Rawal
- Lalitaditya
- Karkota
- Rani Didda
- Kabul
- Mahmud Ghazni
- Jayapaladeva
- Battle of Kashmir
- Somnath destruction
- Raja Suheldev

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



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QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. When Ubaidullah raided Sindh, _____ defeated him and saved Sindh.
   a) Raja Jayasimha b) Raja Dahir c) Rani Bai d) Bappa Rawal
2. _____ was one of the grandest cities of Bharat and a pilgrimage place that fell in the hands of Qasim
   a) Mulasthana b) Kashi c) Prayag d) Ujjain
3. Pratihara means _____.
   a) Teacher b) Cook c) Washerman d) Gate Keeper

Notwithstanding : in spite of **Vanquished :** defeat **Vile :** immoral

4. Since 632 CE, the Caliphate expanded fast. But it took _____ years for them to breach Bharat's farthest boundary
   a) 10 b) 30 c) 70 d) 150
5. _____ built the city of Rawalpindi and launched 15 attacks on Gazhni from here.
   a) Nagabhatta I b) Bappa Rawal c) Mihira Bhoja d) Agukka I
6. Which of the following was not created by Lalitaditya Muktapida?
   a) Parihasa Keshava b) Muktha Keshava c) Somnath c) Marthanda Sun Temple
7. _____ was the founder of the Lohara dynasty
   a) Sangramaraja b) Jayapaladeva c) Lalitaditya d) Didda Rani
8. Which of the following rulers did not face Mahmud Ghazni in a battle?
   a) Jayapaladeva b) Vidyadhara Chandela c) Sangramaraja d) Rani Suganda

REARRANGE THE FOLLOWING EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. (a) Rani Sugandha takes over as the regent of Kashmir.
   (b) Sabuktijin vs Jayapaladeva (Battle of Kabul).
   (c) Agukka I defeats naval expedition by the Arabs.
   (d) Death of Prophet Muhammad.
2. (a) Raja Paramara Bhoja blocks Mahmud Ghazni's route
   (b) Salar Masud enters Bharat
   (c) Raja Vidyadhara stops Ghazni from entering eastern Bharat.
   (d) Raja Jayapala is arrested by Ghazni.

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who won the Battle of Kikan? Why was it important?
2. Who wrote Rajatarangini? Name 3 kings/queens it elaborates upon.
3. What was the result of the Battle of Kabul?
4. How did the Arthashastra classify the victorious kings? Which category will the Islamic invaders fall under?
5. Which regions/kingdoms did the following rulers belong to:
   a. Raja Dahir b. Bappa Rawal c. Rani Didda d. Raja Suheldev

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Who were the bravehearts who defended Sindh when Muhammad bin Qasim attacked? Explain the aftermath of the war with examples.
2. How was Sindh reclaimed from Junaid Ibn Marri? Name the Bharatiya resistors and the routes that they protected.
3. Write in brief about any 2 of the frontier firewalls of Bharat.
4. Who was Lalitaditya Muktapida? How did he defend Bharat? Cite examples of prosperity under his rule.
5. Explain the resilience of Gujarat by citing the example of Somnath.
6. Explain the contribution of the following rulers in protecting Bharat and the impact of their actions on the invaders
   a) Raja Paramara Bhoja b) Sangramaraja
7. Why did Raja Jayapaladeva lose against Mahmud Ghazni? What was the consequence?
8. What happened in the Battle of Bahraich? How was it different from the earlier battles against the Islamic invaders? How did this war keep Bharat safe from invasions for 150 years?

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CASE STUDY

What followed was large scale loot and plunder of Jayapaladeva's kingdom. Bharat had never seen such brutality and cruelty. All the wealth was plundered from the citizens of the area. Hindu temples were broken. Jayapaladeva, his family and ministers were tortured, chained and paraded in the streets. Thousands of women and children were taken away as slaves and forcibly converted to Islam. Jayapala was then released on the condition of receiving fifty elephants plus 2,00,000 dirhams till which time he had to leave his son and grandson as hostages. After his release from Mahmud's bondage, Jayapaladeva wrote to his son Anandapala and publicly declared to his citizens that he was unfit to rule any longer. He thought himself unworthy of the throne he occupied, and burnt himself on a funeral pyre to which he set fire with his own hands. This was a demonstration of the Hindu sense of honour.

1. How were the rules of war different before the Ghaznavids entered Bharat?
2. Was Jayapaladeva a good king? Support your answer with reasons.
3. Why did Jayapaladeva end his own life? What does it show about his principles?

MAP WORK

Mark the following places on the outline map of India

- Ghumli
- Mewar
- Ujjain
- Ghazni
- Shravasti
- Mulasthana

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Chapter 3

GLORY AND GUTS

"One individual may die for an idea, but that idea will, after his death, incarnate itself in a thousand lives."

- Subhas Chandra Bose

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss the glorious achievements of the Cholas under Rajaraja Chola and his successors
- Examine the social and political scenario when Muhammad Ghori attacks Bharat
- Identify the Bharatiya rulers from different regions who resisted the tyrants like Muhammad Ghori, Qutbuddin Aibak and more
- Discuss the outcome and impact of the significant battles

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INTRODUCTION

Even as invasions in northern Bharat affected the nation, few portions in the north and most of southern Bharat were largely unaffected. Almost 70% of the country carried on with their usual way of life where the Dharmashastras were followed, and Hinduism flourished. Regional pride of the rulers ensured that arts, learning, and literature thrived. The Chaulukyas, Eastern Chaulukyas, Eastern Gangas, Kakatiyas, Yadavas, Pandyas and Hoysalas were the major kingdoms that flourished between the 11th and 14th centuries in southern Bharat.

One of the greatest rulers in Bharat's history was laying the foundations of a glorious empire, which became be one of the most important kingdoms of that time in terms of its power, size, and cultural achievements. The ruler was Rajaraja Chola who expanded the Chola empire between 985 CE and 1014 CE.

In northern Bharat, the Ghaznavid dynasty was nearing its end and strong rulers of Bharat were able to thwart attacks. However, the Ghurids from Ghor started their vicious attacks on Bharat that would lead to a difficult time for Bharat.

MIGHTY CHOLAS - THEIR ACHIEVEMENTS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

RAJARAJA CHOLA ESTABLISHES A MIGHTY EMPIRE

The period between 980 CE and 1080 CE was glorious for the Cholas. The Chola empire was in a phase of expansion and consolidation. Rajaraja Chola (born Arulmozhi Varman) and his lineage greatly expanded their kingdom. Rooted in his culture, Rajaraja was one of the greatest patrons of art and architecture.

A COMPLETE SWEEP OF THE SOUTHERN KINGDOMS

On taking over the Chola kingdom in 985 CE, Rajaraja started expanding the Chola kingdom through conquests. The immediate threat in the south were the Cheras, Pandyas and Sinhalas who had formed an alliance to fight Rajaraja. He attacked Chera king Bhaskara Ravi Varman at Kandalur Salai, a coastal town in the Chera kingdom and won. Raja Amarabhujangan of the Pandyas was then defeated in battle and his territories were annexed. Regions like Kollam, Kodungaloor, Vizhinjam and Madurai were now under the Cholas.

Rajaraja Chola

GOING OVERSEAS

Mahinda V who was ruling Anuradhapura, Sri Lanka, was forced to retreat to south-western Sri Lanka due to internal problems. Rajaraja saw this as an opportunity and attacked Sri Lanka. Northern Sri Lanka was captured and included as a province of the Chola empire called Mumudi Chozha Mandalam. The capital of this province was Jagannathamangalam (present-day Polonnaruva).

A beautiful temple for Shiva was erected here that is still well preserved and outlines the glory of Chola architecture. Inscriptions that were found indicate that Rajaraja conquered "old islands of the sea numbering twelve thousand" which are present-day Lakshadweep and Maldives.

BATTLE OF ANURADHAPURA	
When? 993 CE	
Where? Anuradhapura	
Who were the combatants?	
Cholas	Sinhalas
Who were the commanders?	
Rajaraja Chola	Mahinda V
Outcome : Chola victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Further expansion into southeast Asia with Ceylon as a base	

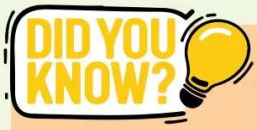
GOING NORTH

The regions in and around Mysore were conquered by Rajaraja but he met stiff resistance from the Western Chaulukyas led by Tailapa II. However, after the death of Tailapa II, Rajaraja through his alliances made sure that he expanded in the Mysore region. Soon Kalinga was captured by Rajaraja. When he assumed power, the Chola kingdom was negligible, constantly under attack from the Rashtrakutas. But Rajaraja through his valour, political acumen*, rightful conduct and military might made the empire into an invincible* empire. He went on to create an extensive, well-knit empire that went even beyond the seas. His empire was efficiently organized, well administered, nd tightly protected. Education, art and architecture flourished.

HIGHLIGHTS OF CHOLA RULE

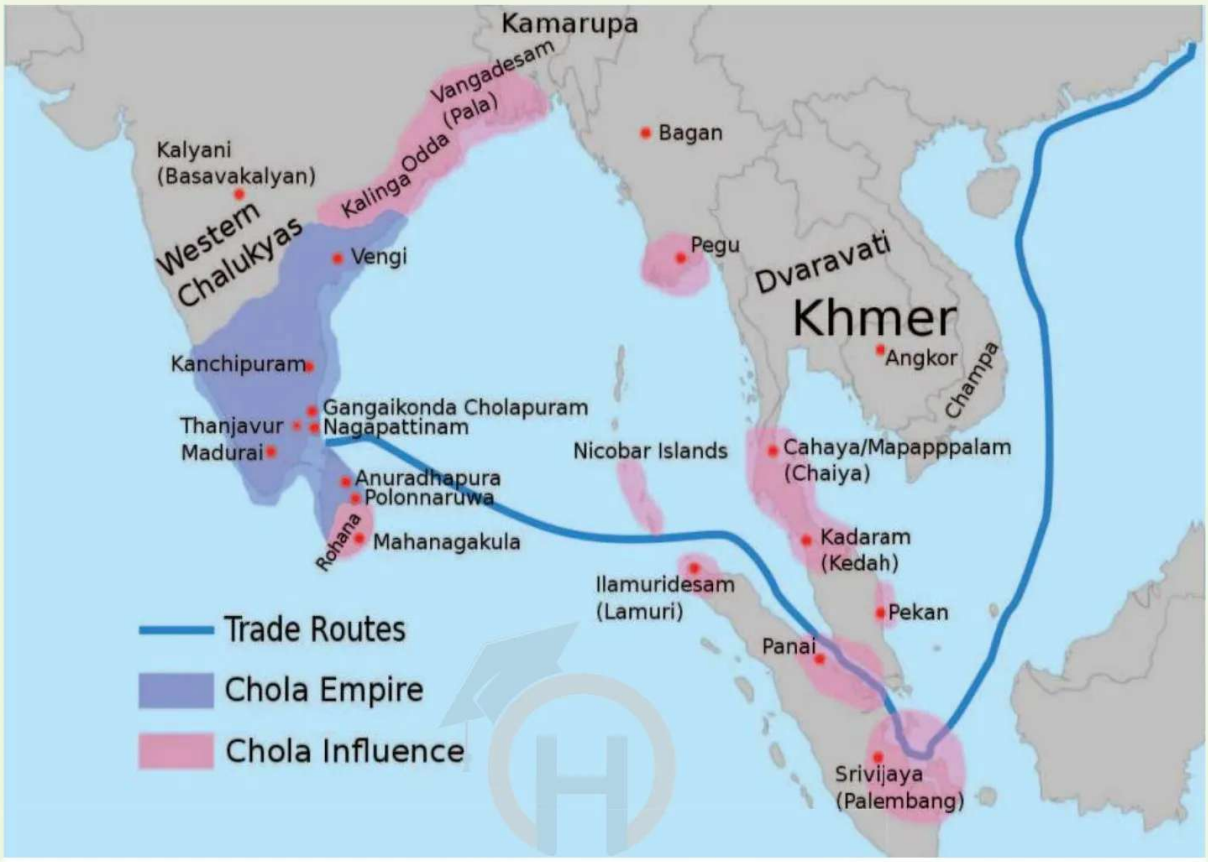
RELATIONSHIP WITH CHINA

Rajaraja was a visionary ruler who understood the importance of trade for a flourishing empire. Rajaraja sent a group of traders to China in 1015 CE. The relationships established continued even when Rajaraja's son Rajendra Chola took over the empire and even extended to his son Kulotunga Chola.



Travelling in mid-sea is always a challenge - high tides, rains & lightning, attack by pirates are common. Hence there are possibilities of loss of goods due to these reasons. In order to mitigate the unexpected loss, the goods are insured. This practice of insurance has been in place since the Vedic age!!!

Acumen : Ability to make good judgements **Invincible :** Too powerful to overcome



South-East Asia under Chola Empire

A PIONEERING NAVAL SUPERPOWER

The Cholas were truly pioneers in recognizing the importance of a strong navy. Their supreme authority in the seas went to the extent where the Bay of Bengal came to be called a 'Chola Lake'. Their empire came to include Sri Lanka, Nicobar islands, the Malay peninsula and Sumatra. Having a superior navy made sure that Bharat was able to exert considerable influence in overseas regions. Pagan and Kambuja (Cambodia) in southeast Asia, Java, Sumatra, Borneo and Bali were all kingdoms that formed part of Dvipantara Bharata (Bharat Beyond the Seas). Various classes of ships were designed and built.

They include :

Kattumaram - Typically logs of wood bound together primarily used for transporting goods from ships anchored in harbours to the shore.

Sangara - Medium-sized ships made of large logs of wood with steel in the sides for protection, to carry cargo

Colandia - Large ships to cross oceans on long voyages. They could hold hundreds of people and cargo

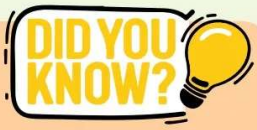
Besides these, there were warships that were also constructed and used by the Cholas. Rajendra Chola, son and successor to Rajaraja, further strengthened this naval fleet and went on to capture more regions in southeast Asia including Kadaram (present-day Malaysia). This led to him being called **Kadaram Kondaan** (the one who conquered Kadaram).

Model of Chola era ship hull reconstructed by ASI

The main ports around which the Cholas operated were Nagapattinam, Kadalur, Poompuhar and Thoothukudi. Further inland, there was a smaller fleet of ships maintained in Kanchipuram along the Palar river.

Astronomy and navigation are very important in the shipping trade. Astronomy and navigation were taught in universities in major regions like Madurai, Kanchi, Thanjavur and Tiruchirapalli. Inscriptions have been found detailing an astronomer called Suryadeva Dikshitha living around 1191 CE who has written detailed works on astronomy. Scholars of various parts of Bharat interacted in fields like astronomy and navigation. It is said that seafarers of the time had in-depth knowledge of almost 56 stars seen in the lower latitudes of the northern hemisphere.

Postage stamp released by Government of India

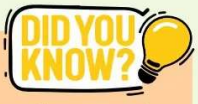


From inscriptions and archaeological evidence, we understand that many navigation instruments were used by the Cholas. For navigation using the stars, a **Ra-palagai** was used. **Tappu-palagai** enabled measurements of speed. Palagai in Tamil means board. To measure the depth of water flat bronze plates were used and the human hand was used for understanding the altitude of stars. The study of weather, winds, and currents were an advanced skill that the Chola mariners possessed.

EXPERTS IN ADMINISTRATION

The Cholas understood the need for setting up an efficient administrative system and a lot of our current systems of governance have developed from them.

- The village was the smallest unit of administration. A Chola empire consisted of a group of villages called Kurrams (Tehsils). Many Kurrams made up a nadu or valanadu. Many nadus made up a mandala.
- During Rajaraja's time, there were around 8 to 9 mandalas. Every mandala was managed by an officer. There was an efficient hierarchy* of people in the governance of the land. Promotions of the people working for the government were given based on merit. This was even true for the princes of the land.
- Rajaraja understood that different layers of administration may lead to corruption and disconnect him from his people. Hence, the Chola king appointed an official called the Naduvirikkai. This person helped in communication between the citizens of the land and the king.
- Land revenue was the main source of income for the government. 17% was collected as tax. Other than land revenue, customs and tolls also brought income to the treasury. Since land revenue was critical, a massive land ownership survey was instituted by Rajaraja and continued by his successors. Various types of lands were measured and ownership information was documented. Any problem on ownership was resolved quickly If government lands were illegally occupied by common people or vice versa, a committee solved the disputes.



Were the King's orders valid by itself?

Only when the respective officials in the administration signed off could orders become functional. It has been found that important government orders required about 40 different officials to sign off. This was to ensure that the orders were executed and monitored properly.

Hierarchy : A system that organises based on level of importance/power

KUDAVOLAI SYSTEM

Uttaramerur inscriptions bring to light the Kudavolai system. This system was a very notable and unique feature of the village administration of the Cholas. There were 30 wards in each village. A representative for each ward was elected through the Kudavolai system. Names of the contestants from whom one would be chosen were written on palm leaf tickets. These palm leaves were put into a pot and shuffled. A child picked up palm leaves one by one from the pot. Persons whose name tickets were picked up by the child were declared elected. Like this 30 members for thirty wards were elected. This kind of peculiar election system was called Kudavolai system. Out of the thirty elected members, twelve members were appointed to the Annual committee, twelve members to the Garden committee and six to the Tank committee. Members of the standing committee and a Gold committee were also elected.

Qualifications to apply and contest elections included :

1. The person should be between 35 and 70 years.
2. They should possess one veli (6.6 acres) of land and a house built on taxable land.
3. They should have knowledge of the Vedas and mantras.

People who were not qualified to contest elections included :

1. People who had killed cows, women, children and pious people.
2. Thieves, drunkards and criminals who had been punished.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Why do you think the eligibility conditions as above were fixed? How does it compare with the eligibility of members contesting elections nowadays?

MANAGING WATER, A PRIZED RESOURCE

Agriculture was one of the most important activities in the Chola kingdom and water was an important resource. There were some portions of the Chola kingdom that fell in a rain shadow region. Hence, Rajaraja built major reservoirs, lakes and canals to feed the different parts of the kingdom. There was no, drought during Rajaraja's reign. Going back in time to the 2nd century, remember that it was a Chola king, Raja Karikala Chola, who built the Kallanai dam. This dam stands strong even till today irrigating more than a million acres of land.

DID YOU KNOW?

"Uyyakondan Kaalvaai" is a canal built during Rajaraja's time. This canal was around 70kms long with more than 100 branches. This canal still exists but has been polluted by us in recent times!

VIBRANT INCLUSIVE SOCIETY, GRAND ARCHITECTURE & ART

Society flourished under Rajaraja Chola and his successors. Women held a very high position in the kingdom. Among other things, they served as judges of peace, land administrators and teachers. The grand architecture of the Cholas and the stupendous bronze sculptures are appreciated even after 1000 years. The Thanjavur Brihadeeshwara temple is one of the most famous temples that was built during Rajaraja's time. Built with more than 1,30,000 tons of granite, the Brihadeeshwara temple is dedicated to Brihadeeshwara (Shiva) and Periyanayaki (Parvati). One of the titles of Rajaraja was Sivapadasekaran.

Brihadeeshwara temple, Thanjavur

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The main vimana is 216 feet tall with just the top dome weighing more than 80 tons. The sculptures are a treat to the eyes. The sculptures of 81 karanas (Bharatanatyam dancing postures) can be found here that show the evolution of fine arts like sculpting and dancing. Fine sculptures in bronze displayed the intricate workmanship of the artists of the Chola period. Chola bronzes are still considered a gold standard in the art world.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

1. How was 80 tons lifted to a height of 216 feet and placed on top of the vimana of the Brihadeeshwara temple?
2. Think about the ancient structures near your school or home and list down their age and their function. Discuss how these structures were planned and built to last for such a long time.

Chola bronze sculpture of Lord Nataraja

An ardent devotee of Lord Shiva, Rajaraja Chola was an inclusive and tolerant ruler. He was able to recover large portions of the holy Shaiva scriptures called the **Thevaram** and hence was referred to as **Thirumurai Kanda Cholan**. The murthis of the Nayanmar saints came to be included in temples during his rule and chanting of the hymns composed by Appar, Sundarar and Sambandar were started that continues till date. Large temples for Lord Vishnu were built from the proceeds of the royal family in many places. A Buddhist Chudamani vihara was constructed in Nagapattinam and Rajaraja donated an entire village called Anaimangalam to support the vihara. Jainism flourished under the Cholas. Rajaraja continued supporting all faiths of Bharat like the kings before him and this was continued after his time as well.

DID YOU KNOW?

Gangaikonda Cholapuram was the new capital of the Cholas established by Rajendra Chola I after conquering the mighty Pala empire. Commerating his victory, he brought water from river Ganga to consecrate the deities in this temple. He also brought the priests and scholars from Vangadesa to perform the Vedic rituals. The Brihadeeshwara Temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram was constructed as a replica of the temple at Thanjavur.

Brihadeeshwara temple, Gangaikonda Cholapuram

The Chola empire (848 CE -1280 CE) emerged as a major power during the reign of **Raja Raja Chola I** and **Rajendra Chola I** who were great warriors and conquerors. The Chola dynasty reigned over Southern Bharat, and expanded its territories by successful naval expeditions to parts of southeast Asia, Sri Lanka, the Maldives and Bengal in the 11th century. The Cholas were revered as protectors of Dharma and generous administrators. Southern portions of Bharat achieved excellence in art, architecture, literature and religion during Chola rule. Let us understand what happened in northern Bharat during the period.

INVASIONS RESUME, RESISTANCE CONTINUES

Islamic invasions resumed with Muhammad Ghori in the late 12th century. Muhammad Ghori was a Ghurid. Ghurids were vassals of the Ghaznavids who overthrew the Ghaznavids and established their rule going forward. Muhammad Ghori's first attempt to enter Bharat was via the Bolan Pass. Gujarat of that time was ruled by the Chaulukyas. Let us briefly look at the Chaulukyas.

DEFENCE BY THE CHAULUKYAS

The Chaulukyas dynasty, later known also the Solanki dynasty, ruled parts of present day Gujarat and Rajasthan in north-western Bharat, between 940 CE and 1244 CE. Their capital was located at Anahilavada (modern Patan, Gujarat). At their peak, their rule extended to the Malwa region in present-day Madhya Pradesh. They belonged to the Solanki clan of Rajputs and were great patrons of art and architecture. They constructed the awe-inspiring Dilwara Temples, Modhera Sun Temple and Rani Ki Vav in the style of Maru-Gurjara architecture.

Chaulukya Kingdom

Modhera Sun Temple

Rani Ki Vav

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Notice the intricate design of these temples and monuments built in the early 11th century by the Chaulukyas rulers. Is it possible to create such architectural marvels without machines? What kind of tools would the Chaulukyas have used?

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RANI NAYAKIDEVI'S MIGHT

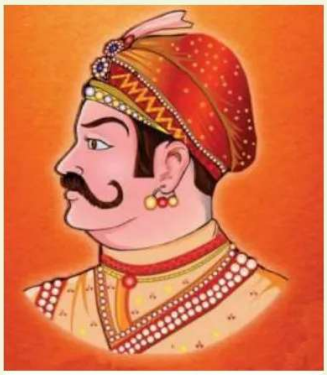
To capture Gujarat, Muhammad Ghori with a large army moved through the Thar desert (western Rajasthan) towards Anahilavada and reached the foothills of Mount Abu in 1178 CE. Muhammad chose to enter Bharat via Anahilavada as this region was ruled by a young prince. He was the Gujarat Chaulukyas king **Mularaja II**. His mother, **Rani Nayakidevi**, acted as his regent to rule the region. Muhammad assumed that he could easily capture a region ruled by a boy and administered by a woman. He severely underestimated the capabilities of Rani Nayakidevi. The Rani was skilled in sword fighting, cavalry, military strategy, diplomacy and all other subjects of statecraft. This was a very unique encounter where Mularaja II, still a small boy, was led to the battlefront by his mother, the valorous Rani Nayakidevi.

BATTLE OF KAYADARA	
When? 1178 CE	
Where? Kayadara, Gujarat	
Who were the combatants?	
Chaulukya	Ghurids
Who were the commanders?	
Rani Nayakidevi	Muhammad Ghori
Outcome : Retreat of Muhammad Ghori	
SIGNIFICANCE : Muhammad Ghori never returns to Gujarat	

At Kasahrada (Kayadara) in Sirohi Gujarat, Muhammad Ghori and his large army suffered a crushing defeat. Muhammad was so scarred by this defeat that he never dared to attack Gujarat again. Muhammad Ghori barely managed to escape to Ghazni.

ENCOUNTER WITH RAJA PRITHVIRAJ CHAUHAN

Prithiviraj was born in 1141 CE and ascended the throne in 1178 CE, after the death of his father Raja Someshwar Chauhan. Prithviraj was declared the heir to his maternal grandfather's throne as well because of his courage and sharp acumen. With this, Prithiviraj gained control over Delhi as well. His capital was located at Ajmer and his empire covered much of present-day Rajasthan, Haryana, Delhi, and some parts of Punjab, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. Prithviraj's territory extended from Thaneswar in the north to Jahazpur in the south.



Prithviraj Chauhan

When Ghori attacked and captured Sirhind, the local chieftains of Prithviraj informed him of the desecration of villages and attacks on women by Muhammad's army. Shocked by these reports Prithviraj headed out with a large army to put an end to the miseries of the people of Sirhind.

THE FIRST BATTLE OF TARAIN

In 1191 at Tarain (near Delhi), the two armies clashed. The vastly superior forces of Prithviraj quickly destroyed the army of Ghori. The speed with which Prithviraj had assembled his troops and attacked Sirhind caught Muhammad Ghori by surprise. The administrator of Delhi Govindaraja, was very effective in leading the attack on Muhammad.

BATTLE OF TARAIN 1	
When? 1191 CE	
Where? Tarori, Haryana	
Who were the combatants?	
Chauhans	Ghurids
Who were the commanders?	
Prithviraj Chauhan	Muhammad Ghori
Outcome : Prithviraj wins	
SIGNIFICANCE : A grave mistake to allow Ghori to flee which Bharat will repent	

In the fierce battle that followed Muhammad Ghori was severely wounded and had to be taken away from the battlefield by his soldiers. Ghori's army started retreating to save themselves. Muhammad Ghori and his important generals were almost captured by Prithviraj as they were fleeing the battlefield. However, Prithviraj did not want to chase and capture them as they had turned their backs and were running away. This was a mistake that Prithviraj and the rest of Bharat will repent*. Muhammad Ghori managed to escape to Ghor. Angry at his loss, Muhammad started putting together a large army.

THE SECOND BATTLE OF TARAIN

In 1192, Muhammad Ghori set forth towards Tarain once again to avenge the loss of the first battle. With an army of more than one lakh soldiers, he marched towards Delhi. However, as he got nearer to Tarain, Muhammad decided to use unethical tactics. He sent word to Prithviraj asking for a truce. Prithviraj lowered his guard and lowered the preparedness of his army. Early one morning when Prithviraj's men were still asleep, Muhammad Ghori struck. Caught unprepared, Prithviraj and his army suffered great losses. The speed and ferocity of Muhammad's army soon decimated

BATTLE OF TARAIN 2	
When? 1192 CE	
Where? Tarori, Haryana	
Who were the combatants?	
Chauhans	Ghurids
Who were the commanders?	
Prithviraj Chauhan	Muhammad Ghori
Outcome : Prithviraj loses	
SIGNIFICANCE : Most of northern Bharat falls into the hands of Islamic invaders. Rajputs greatly weakened.	

Repent : Feel sorry about

Prithviraj's army. There are varying accounts of what happened to Prithviraj. As per one of the accounts Prithviraj was captured and killed. However, the local history and folklore recall Chand Bardai's version.

Impact of the second battle of Tarain:

a. A large portion of northern India fell into the hands of the Islamic invaders from Ghor.
b. The Chahamana Rajputs were greatly weakened, and Rajput rule almost came to an end.
c. The confidence of the rulers of various regions in Bharat was shaken.
d. Muhammad Ghori proceeded to destroy and loot Ajmer, Hansi, Saraswati, Samna and Delhi. His slave and military general Qutbuddin ransacked Ayodhya in 1193 and razed temples which were the cornerstone of Hindu civilization.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Was it right for Prithviraj to allow Muhammad Ghori and his army to leave? Being magnanimous to the enemy Vs protecting the nation from future invasions – discuss and debate which is the greater good.

PRITHVIRAJ RASO BY CHAND BARDAI

In the second battle of Tarain, Prithviraj was captured alive by Muhammad Ghori who took him to Ghor. Prithviraj's eyes were gouged out. At this shocking news, Chand Bardai, a poet to Prithiviraj went on his own to Muhammad's court. Chand Bardai submitted his request to him that, "I must be killed in the same or any other manner as my master. Secondly, I submit that the Sultan should himself witness a demonstration of exceptional archery skill of my master in the wonderful art of hitting an object, hearing to the sound it produces". This request made Muhammad curious about this wonderful art. Even then with every precaution, the necessary arrangements for the demonstration were made. Twenty-one pans were hung. Muhammad Ghori sat with his noblemen at a high place in the court to witness the feat. Chand Bardai and Prithviraj were made to sit before the pans with heavy security. As soon as the sound rang out the blinded Prithviraj took an unmistakable aim at the pan concerned and hit the mark. As this feat was repeated with exceptional accuracy for twenty-one times, the whole court was thrilled with wonder. Muhammad himself couldn't hold back praising Prithviraj's skill and exclaimed "Wah Wah". At that very moment, the captive Chand Bardai sitting near Prithviraj composed a couplet on the spot, guiding Prithviraj to shoot, without wasting a moment. The blinded Prithviraj took aim in the direction of the sound made by Muhammad Ghori and killed him with a sharp arrow. At once there was an uproar and confusion everywhere, but before the guards of the Sultan could fall upon them with their weapons, Prithviraj and Chand Bardai drew out their own swords and cut off their own heads!

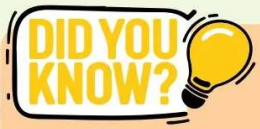
LESSONS THE KINGS NEVER LEARNT

Many kings of Bharat had still not learnt their lesson. They were steeped in their tradition of tolerance. Jayasimha Siddharaja (1094-1143 CE) punished his people for interfering with the worship of the invaders. Different Sufi teachers carried out conversion activities–Mumin Arif near Devagiri (which was under the Yadavas) and Jalaluddin Ganjrawan were some of the Sufis of the time. Sarangadeva (1294-1297 CE) granted money for building a mosque in Prabhas Patan with the blessing of the Somnath priest!

EMERGENCE OF THE SLAVE DYNASTY (MAMLUK)

Within two years after winning the Battle of Tarain, Muhammad Ghori, fearing repulsion from the Hindu rulers, chose to not remain seated in Delhi but to return to Ghazni, his hometown. In 1206, Muhammad Ghori appointed Qutbuddin as the Naib* of his empire. He came to be known as Qutbuddin Aibak. This marked the beginning of the Slave dynasty and the Delhi Sultanate.

The Delhi Sultanate that was established ensured that Islam assumed political power. The rulers differentiated between the people of Bharat and the foreign mercenaries* that they brought along with them. Conversion activities were rampant-by allurement* and the sword. Hindus were denied their right to worship, right to basic civil rights and dignities. Some communities converted to the new religion for royal favour or protection. Although many compromises had to be made by the Hindus, they still held on to their beliefs and spirituality.



The famous Qutb Minar complex supposedly constructed by Qutbuddin Aibak and other subsequent sultans was a temple dedicated to Lord Vishnu. Remains of about 27 destroyed Hindu and Jain temples were used to construct this complex. The Minar was a Vishnusthamba of the Gupta Period. The images below show temple pillars and motifs that can be seen even today at the Qutb Minar complex.

Source: Muslim historian Maulana Hakim Syed Abdul Hai and Archaeological Survey of India.

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SOLANKIS DRIVE OUT QUTBUDDIN AIBAK

Between 1194 and 1195, a large group of tribal people from Mehr sought the help of the Chaulukya king **Bhima II** to expel the Turks from Rajputana. They joined hands and attacked the army of Aibak. Unable to withstand this combined onslaught Aibak withdrew his troops. However, in 1197, Aibak attacked the Chaulukyas with extra troops. Aibak won and installed a governor and returned to Delhi. In 1201 CE Bhima reorganized himself and drove the Turks out of Gujarat gradually. They continued to defend their territories from Iltutmish, the successor of Aibak, and other subsequent rulers of the Delhi Sultanate, until it was ultimately overrun by Alauddin Khalji.

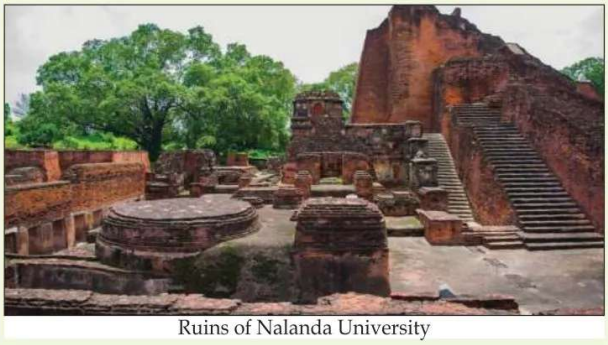
RISE AND FALL OF BAKHTIYAR KHALJI

Bakhtiyar Khalji was a soldier in Awadh province's army. Wanting to gain prominence, he set his eyes on the Magadha territory (present day Bihar). He attacked the famous Nalanda University and mercilessly slaughtered thousands of innocent Buddhists and Hindus. He demolished the university and burnt down the university library, which burnt for over 3 months. He also ravaged other universities like Odantapuri and Vikramashila. From there he proceeded to Bengal and defeated the Sena king Lakshmanasena.

Naib : A person who is second in command, after the King
Mercenary : Warrior
Allurement : To attract by bribing

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Why would someone want to attack students and teachers at a university?
What do the attackers gain by destroying large libraries filled with rare and important books?



Ruins of Nalanda University

BAKHTIYAR KHALJI BAITED

In 1206 CE, Bakhtiyar passed through Assam with an army of about 12,000 men towards Tibet. **Raja Prithu** of the Kamarupa dynasty, intentionally let Bakhtiyar pass through his empire without offering any resistance. Raja Prithu strategised and destroyed every resource of the region that fell along the route taken by Bakhtiyar Khalji. Upon reaching Tibet, Bakhtiyar Khalji and his army were shocked on seeing a huge army waiting to attack them and so he decided to retreat. But while returning through the Kamarupa region, the invading army found that they had no resources like food crops, shelter, etc. A huge dam that the army used to cross a river was also found broken. Taken by surprise, Bakhtiyar and his men took shelter at a nearby temple. Raja Prithu waiting for this moment launched a surprise attack and vanquished the army of Bakhtiyar Khalji. Bakhtiyar along with a few men escaped from the place and reached Bengal. Bakthiyar Khalji after suffering a catastrophic* defeat was crushed and broken and never led any campaign thereafter. He went into depression and was ultimately assassinated by another general named Ali Mardan.

BATTLE OF KAMARUPA	
When? 1206 CE	
Where? Kamarupa, Assam	
Who were the combatants?	
Kamarupa empire	Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Prithu	Bakhtiyar Khalji
Outcome : Decimation of Bakhtiyar Khalji and his army	
SIGNIFICANCE : Led to Bakhtiyar Khalji's ultimate end	

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DID YOU KNOW?

After Kamarupa dynasty, the northeast provinces (present day Assam and northeastern states) were ruled by a dynasty called Ahoms. They challenged all invasions and maintained the sovereignty of Assam for the next 600 years until 1826 !!!

CONCLUSION

The Cholas flourished under Rajaraja and under his son Rajendra Chola, the Chola empire reached its greatest heights. Andhra, parts of Madhya Pradesh, Bengal, Orissa (Odisha) and Bihar, Sri Lanka and most parts of South Asia came under Chola rule. Art, literature, architecture, and society flourished. Major contributions were also made in philosophy, drama, music, and dance.

Northern Bharat came under attack from Islamic invaders that were driven away by brave rulers and warriors. However, this also meant that the normal way of life was impacted and rulers started concentrating on just their regions. Through the heroic deeds of Bharatiyas like Jayapaladeva, Raja Bhoja, Rani Nayakidevi, Raja Suheldev and Prithviraj Chauhan, Bharat was able to retain its cultural roots.

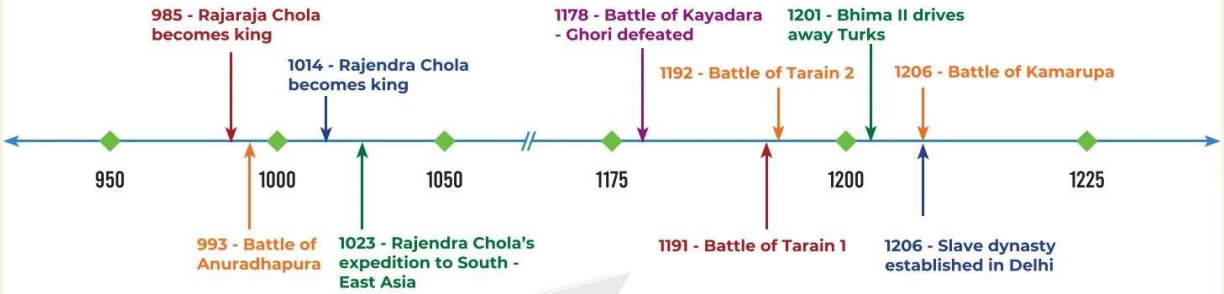
****

Catastrophic : Disastrous

KEYWORDS

- Rajaraja Chola
- Kandalur Salai
- Dvipantara Bharata
- Ship building
- Sea navigation
- Kudavolai system
- Chola bronze
- Brihadeeshwara
- Gangaikonda Cholapuram
- Rajendra Chola
- Chaulukyas
- Battle of Kayadara
- Rani Nayakidevi
- Prithviraj Chauhan
- Battle of Tarain
- Mamluk Dynasty
- Bakhtiyar Khalji
- Raja Prithu
- Muhammad Ghori

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Which of the following places did Rajaraja Chola **NOT** rule over?
   a) Kollam b) Madurai c) Jagannathamangalam d) Kalyani
2. _____ was called a Chola lake.
   a) Bay of Bengal b) Indian Ocean c) Arabian Sea d) River Kaveri
3. True or False

Statement A :Rajendra Chola recovered large portions of the Shaiva literature called the Thevaram.
Statement B : Rajaraja Chola donated an entire village called Anaimangalam to support the Buddhist Vihara.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) Both are false d) A & B are true

4. True or False

Statement A : Qutbuddin Aibak built the Qutb Minar from temple ruins
Statement B : Qutbuddin Aibak was the first king of the Delhi Sultanate
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) Both are false d) A & B are true
5. _____ was the Chaulukyan ruler who defeated Qutbuddin Aibak.
   a) Prithviraj Chauhan b) Nayakidevi c) Bhima II d) Suheldev
6. Who got the title Kadaram Kondan?
   a) Rajaraja Chola b) Rajendra Chola c) Kulothunga Chola d) Mahinda V

ANSWER IN BRIEF

1. What were the main sources of revenue for the Cholas?
2. What is special about the temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram?
3. What was the role of a Naduvirikkai in the Chola administration?
4. What was the impact of the Second Battle of Tarain?
5. What can we learn about Prithviraj from the Prithviraj Raso retold by Chand Bardai?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Why were the Cholas called the naval superpower? Explain their achievements in the field of shipping with examples.
2. What are the key features of the Kudavolai system of elections? Why were such eligibility criteria chosen?
3. Give examples to explain the social and religious life during the Chola times.
4. Who fought the Battle of Kayadara? If not for this battle, what would have happened?
5. What was the result of the First Battle of Tarain? Why did Prithviraj allow the enemy to retreat? How did this decision cost him?
6. What damage did Bakhtiyar Khalji cause to Bharat? How was he baited and defeated?

PICTURE BASED QUESTIONS

1. Identify the structure. Where is it?
2. Which dynasty built this piece of work?
3. Which deity is this place dedicated to?

1. Identify the structure. Where is it?
2. Who built it?
3. Explain 3 salient features of this temple.

CASE STUDY

In the fierce Battle of Tarain I (1191), Muhammad Ghori was severely wounded and had to be taken away from the battlefield by his soldiers. The attack on the invaders was very powerful that Ghori's army started retreating to save themselves. It is said that the top commanders and Muhammad Ghori were close to being captured by Prithviraj Chauhan as they were fleeing the battlefield. However, Prithviraj Chauhan did not want to chase and capture Muhammad and his generals as they had turned their backs and were fleeing. This was a mistake that Prithviraj Chauhan and the rest of Bharat will stand to repent. Muhammad Ghori managed to escape to Ghor. Angry at his loss, Muhammad put together a large army and came back to attack Prithviraj Chauhan in 1192.

1. Why did Prithviraj allow the enemy to retreat? What was the result of his action?
2. What were the strengths and weaknesses of Prithviraj Chauhan as a king?
3. What could have Prithviraj done differently so that Battle of Tarain II (1192) could have been avoided?

MAP WORK

Mark the following places on the outline map of India.

- any 2 seaports of the Cholas
- the capital of Rajaraja Chola
- the battlefield where Rani Nayakidevi defeated Muhammad Ghori
- Raja Prithu's kingdom

Chapter 4

BRAVERY AND SACRIFICE

"Be not afraid of anything. You will do marvelous work. The moment you fear, you are nobody. Be a hero."

- Swami Vivekananda

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Assess the terror regime under Alauddin Khalji, Malik Kafur and Muhammad bin Tughluq and how the Bharatiya rulers responded.
- Describe the impact of Bhakti saints on the social life of Bharatiyas during this chaotic era.
- Identify the various dynasties from the south and the north who defended against the aggressors in the spirit of resilience.

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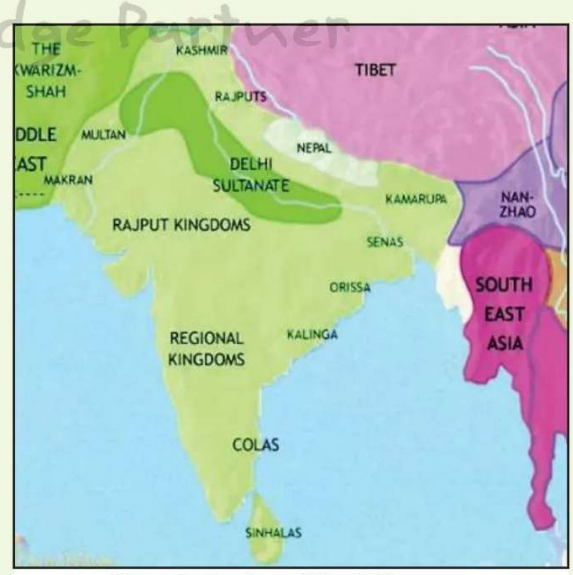
INTRODUCTION

Northern Bharat between the 13th and 15th centuries not only bore the brunt of the ruthlessness of the Delhi sultanate but also witnessed unyielding heroism by the valorous descendants of Prithviraj Chauhan and others. While the power of the Rajputs had significantly weakened after the demise of Prithviraj Chauhan, there were valorous Rajput rulers who kept bravely fighting against invasions. The Mamluk dynasty started to wind down and the Khalji dynasty came to power during 1290 CE. Bharat was to face severe oppression under the new rulers of Delhi. Large parts of Bharat started coming under the rule of the Khaljis but would this last? Southern Bharat had been relatively insulated till this period. However, this was to change soon. The Khaljis made inroads into the south. Kingdoms of southern Bharat started experiencing the impact of invasions and many regions of the south offered stiff resistance to the invaders.



Bharat during the middle of 13th century

CHAHAMANA DYNASTY

Prithviraj Chauhan, about whom we have studied in the previous chapter belonged to the Chahamana dynasty of Shakambhari. There were other clans of the dynasty -

- Chahamanas of Ranastambhapura
- Chahamanas of Naddula
- Chahamanas of Lata
- Chahamanas of Dholpur
- Chahamanas of Partabgarh
- Chahamanas of Jalor

The different clans united on many occasions to fight the Delhi Sultans. For instance, **Udayasimha,** the Chahamana king of Jalor, formed a confederacy against Iltutmish, forcing him to retreat from Mewar in 1241 CE.

The successors of Iltutmish were constantly kept at bay by the kings of Rajputana for almost 4 decades. By the end of the 13th century, the Mamluk dynasty came to an end and Jalaluddin Khalji took over as Sultan of Delhi marking the beginning of the Khalji dynasty.

RESISTANCE AGAINST THE KHALJIS

HAMMIRA DEVA'S VALOUR

Hammira Deva was one of the most important Chahamana kings of Ranthambore. In 1290 Jalaluddin Khalji invaded Ranthambore and attacked the fort. Even though the enemy used the Trebuchet in war, the Chahamanas under King Hammira courageously repulsed the attack, shattering the dreams of Jalaluddin to capture Ranthambore. Within 2 years, Jalaluddin made his second attempt to capture Ranthambore, and yet again he was repulsed by Hammira. Jalaluddin Khalji was treacherously killed by his nephew Alauddin Khalji who took over as the Sultan of Delhi in 1296. Ranthambore was attacked by Alauddin's armies under his general Ulugh Khan. Hammira's forces defeated them. Another army under Nusrat Khan was sent by Alauddin that met with the same fate.

Trebuchet

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ALAUDDIN'S DECEPTION AND HAMMIRA'S FALL

BATTLE OF RANTHAMBORE	
When? 1301 CE	
Where? Ranthambore, Rajasthan	
Who were the combatants?	
Chahamanas	Khaljis
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Hammira Deva	Alauddin Khalji
Outcome : Chahamanas defeated by betrayal, but fought till the end	
SIGNIFICANCE : End of the Chahamana dynasty of Ranthambore	

In 1300 Hammira Deva gave asylum to two Mongol Generals, who were enemies of Alauddin Khalji. This angered Alauddin and he decided to trick Hammira. In 1301 Alauddin decided to trick Hammira. He invited Hammira for peace talks. Hammira accepted the offer and sent two of his generals, Ratipala and Ranmal. Alauddin promised the generals that if they helped him in capturing Ranthambore, they would be given the entire kingdom as a gift.

Hammira Deva

The two generals agreed and betrayed their king. They led their forces outside and joined Alauddin's army. Hammira offered his brother Virama, his minister Jaja, and the rebel Mongol leader Muhammad Shah to escape through a safe passage. But all of them refused to desert him. Virama died fighting by his side. Jaja, whom Hammira had appointed as his successor, died two days later while defending the fort. Muhammad

Shah was wounded in the battle and later executed on Alauddin's orders. Hammira and his loyal companions marched to the top of the fort mound and slew the enemy forces with all their might until they fell dead. The women inside the fort chose to embrace death and protect their honor rather than getting caught by the tyrants. They stepped into the fire and self-immolated themselves. With the fall of Hammira, the Chahamana dynasty of Ranastambhapura came to an end.

THINK!!!

Hammira Deva provided Asylum to Alauddin's enemies even though he foresaw that it could cause him trouble in the future. Alauddin invited the generals of the enemy camp for peace discussions, and instead lured them into becoming traitors. How we treat our guests showcases our value system.

REIGN OF TERROR UNDER ALAUDDIN KHALJI

At the beginning of the 14th century, Bharat witnessed a reign of unprecedented intolerance and violence under Alauddin Khalji

- In 1299, Gujarat came under Alauddin Khalji. Somnath temple was destroyed again. During his Gujarat aggression, Alauddin captured many young Hindu boys who were made slaves. One such young and handsome boy who was forcibly converted to Islam and who grew close to Alauddin was **Malik Kafur**.
- Hundreds of temples were destroyed.
- Alauddin Khalji levied 50% tax on agricultural produce. This impoverished the Hindu peasants. Alauddin did this to curtail financial resources required for any rebellion against his government. Those failing to pay taxes were brutally tortured and enslaved.

JIZYA

Alauddin imposed an exorbitant 50% - 75% tax on Hindus called Jizya. This tax crippled the lives of common people. Qazi Mughisuddin, legal advisor of Alauddin, advised that Jizya was mandated to humiliate Hindus and it was the religious duty of the sultan to impose it.

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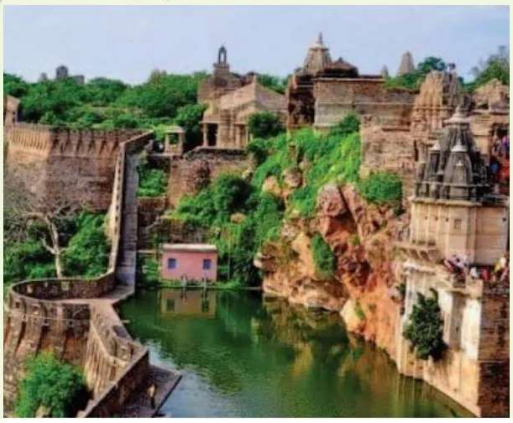
HEROIC RESISTANCE

CHITTORGARH CHALLENGES ALAUDDIN KHALJI

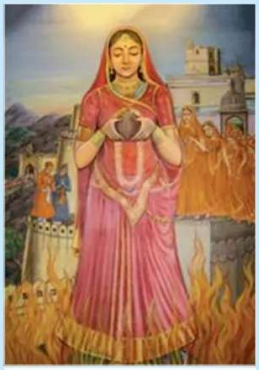
After subjugating Ranthambore, Alauddin Khalji set his eyes on Mewar (in present-day Rajasthan). Mewar was under the rule of a clan of Rajputs called **Guhilots** who were initially the vassals of Gurjara-Pratiharas. In 1303, Alauddin Khalji besieged the fort of Chittorgarh. **Raja Ratna Simha** offered strong resistance.



A view of Chittorgarh Fort

The Rajput army resisted Alauddin Khalji's army for 7 long months. Eventually, the fort ran short of resources and the invading army entered the fort. In the ensuing war that took place, Raja Ratna Simha was killed. Alauddin Khalji's army stormed the fort and ravaged everything that they saw. More than 30,000 Rajput soldiers were killed mindlessly. When Alauddin Khalji went in search of Rani Padmini to take possession of her, she along with other Rajput women had already committed Jauhar or self-immolation, choosing to embrace fire than lose honour.

RANI PADMINI


Rani Padmini

As per the traditional accounts of Mewar, Alauddin hearing about the beauty of Rani Padmini, wife of Raja Ratna Simha, was overcome by his lust of acquiring the Rani. He besieged the Chittorgarh fort and sent a message to Ratna Simha to allow him inside the fort for peace talks. Alauddin is admitted inside the fort where he gets a glimpse of Rani's beauty. Alauddin invited Ratna Simha in return to his camp. The king obliged but Alauddin treacherously arrested Ratna Simha and demanded Rani Padmini in exchange for Ratna Simha's release.

The news reached the Mewar camp. Infuriated, the Rani planned a mission. Assisted by two valiant and trusted men, Gora and Badal, and a group of soldiers dressed up as women, Padmini entered Alauddin's camp. Gora and Badal secured the release of king Ratna Simha. King and Queen escaped from the place, while the massive army of Alauddin was blocked by Gora, Badal and their small team of soldiers. Rajputs put up a super-human fight killing hundreds of enemies. They lay down their lives in service of their King, Queen, and their Nation.

It is said that Gora and Badal were beheaded during their fight but their torso continued fighting killing more men of the sultan.

BATTLE FOR CHITTORGARH	
When? 1303 CE	
Where? Chittorgarh, Rajasthan	
Who were the combatants?	
Guhilot Rajput	Khalji Army
Who were the commanders?	
Ratna Simha	Alauddin Khalji
Outcome : 30,000 Rajputs slaughtered, hundreds of women commit Jauhar	
Significance : Bravery of Rajputs men and women further highlighted	

SITALA DEVA'S VALOUR

In 1308 CE, Alauddin Khalji's eyes turned towards Siwana (in Rajasthan). Raja Sitala Deva defended Khalji's vigorous attack. The walled fort city was besieged by Khalji's army for not just a few months but for more than six long years.

When the Sultanate army was facing an inevitable loss, Alauddin adopted a vile tactic. He contaminated the main water tank of Siwana with cows' blood. As the cows are sacred to Hindus, Siwana lost its main source of water and Sitala Deva was eventually defeated by the Khalji troops. Sitala Deva faced the invaders with might and courage and was ultimately slain along with thousands of his brave soldiers.

THINK!!!

How can someone defend their fort for 6 years? Don't you think surrounded by enemies for such a long a time is extremely challenging and psychologically stressful?

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

The barbaric invaders used vile and lowly strategies to take advantage of the principles of the Hindus. Standing by traditions and sacrificing one's life for it or deviating from traditions to stay alive and safeguarding it. What in your opinion is correct?

SERENITY IN THE MIDST OF CHAOS

Many parts of Bharat were experiencing a violent time due to the invasions. The normal life of people was

greatly disturbed. People lost their family members in the brutalities, had their wealth plundered, and places of faith destroyed. Fear lurked around every corner. However, even in such conditions, Bharat did not give up its spiritual quest. The bedrock of Bharat has been its spiritual strength and people were guided in this path by great saints.

THE BEACON OF LIGHT IN MAHARASHTRA

Sant Jnaneshwar

In a small village called Apegaon (in Maharashtra) on the banks of the Godavari, to a devout couple, Vithal and Rakhumabai was born **Jnaneshwar**. He lost his parents when he was around 8 years and grew up with his 2 brothers and a sister. Jnaneshwar by the age of 10 had mastered the Hindu scriptures and he was soon regarded as a spiritually evolved person.

Jnaneshwar travelled around with his brother and understood that it was important to take the knowledge in Hindu scriptures to the common people in a form and language that they will be able to appreciate. Jnaneshwar wrote a commentary on the Bhagavad Gita called Bhavartha Deepika (Light reflecting the inner meaning of the Gita). This text is popularly called **Jnaneshwari**. Jnaneshwari was written in Marathi and is made up of 9,999 verses in a rhyme called "ovi". What made Jnaneshwari so beautiful and popular? The simplified form of writing and interesting presentation that immediately captivated the common people. Jnaneshwar takes the tone of the important characters of the Mahabharata – like Krishna, Sanjaya, Arjuna, Dhritarashtra, etc making the entire teaching dramatic and appealing. He presented examples from the life of common people that made it easy for them to relate to and understand.

Jnaneshwar composed many works and created a movement among the people to realize their potential and evolve spiritually. Jnaneshwar attained samadhi* at the age of 21 at a place called Alandi in Maharashtra. A tradition that he started, called the Varkari, continues even today.

VARKARI TRADITION

Jnaneshwar traveled to Pandharpur (in southern Maharashtra) to pray to Lord Vitthala. Vitthala is a form of Lord Krishna.

Vaari (moving or going on pilgrimage) + Kari (doing) = Varkari
Meaning, devotee going on a pilgrimage.

Varkaris are devotees of Lord Vitthala who undertake a yearly pilgrimage on foot from various parts of Maharashtra to Pandharpur covering over 250 kms in less than 21 days. The Vaari finishes on Ashada Ekadashi (which falls in late June and July of every year).

Samadhi : Highest state of unity to reality/mortal death

The Varkari tradition is followed even today where people from all walks of life come together with just one identity–a devotee of Vitthala. The number of devotees on yatra has crossed one million. This annual yatra has had a significant economic impact with the town of Pandharpur developing into a major town. Many small towns and villages that lie along the route of the yatra have also developed into large towns.

The number of saints and poets that the Varkari tradition has given to Bharat is a reminder of the power of the Bhakti tradition in Bharat. Their lives, words, and action have inspired the ordinary person to follow a life of Dharma. It is this Varkari tradition that gave rise to further saints like Namadeva and Tukaram. Other regions of Bharat also saw many great saints uplifting the spirit of the people.

THE SPIRITUAL REVOLUTIONARY

Sri Madhvacharya

Sri Madhvacharya was another revolutionary monk who lived during the 13th century. He was nicknamed Bhima, as he maintained an excellent physique and loved running, jumping wrestling, and swimming. He formally studied the Vedas at a tender age and became an erudite scholar of the Vedas and Vedangas. He took up sannyasa at the age of 25 years. Madhvacharya traveled across Bharat, to understand the need of society at that point. Through the new stream of Vaishnava thought (Shad-Vaishnavism) he stressed on the constant remembrance of Lord Vishnu in and through all practices.

RESISTANCE BY THE SOUTHERN KINGDOMS

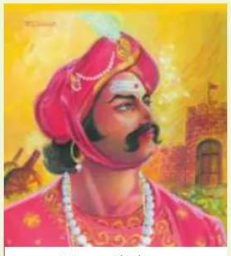
Many kingdoms offered stiff resistance to the attacks by the armies of the Delhi Sultanate. These kingdoms had flourishing societies that made great advances in art, architecture, culture, governance and beyond. Offered here is a snapshot of some important kingdoms.

YADAVA KINGDOM (1187 - 1317 CE)

BATTLE OF DEVAGIRI	
When?	1313 CE
Where?	Lasura, Maharashtra
Who were the combatants?	
Yadavas	Khaljis
Who were the commanders?	
Simhana III	Malik Kafur
Outcome : Yadavas lose	
SIGNIFICANCE : Devagiri annexed to Delhi sultanate	

Founded in 1187 CE by Bhillama V, a feudatory of the Chaulukya dynasty, Yadava Kingdom had Devagiri (present day Aurangabad, Maharashtra) as its capital. In 1210, the empire was at its peak and spread from the Narmada river in the north to the Tungabhadra river in the south, and from the Sindhu Sagar in the west to present-day Telangana in the east. The Yadava kings were great patrons of Kannada, Sanskrit and Marathi literature. In the year 1296, **King Ramadeva** faced the heat of aggression by Alauddin Khalji who successfully raided Devagiri. He had to pay a huge compensation to continue as the king, accepting the supremacy of Alauddin. In the year 1307, Alauddin deputed his general, Malik Kafur to Devagiri with a massive army that subjugated Ramadeva. After Ramadeva, his son **Simhana III** challenged Alauddin's supremacy. After a bloody battle, Simhana was killed and the Devagiri kingdom was annexed to the Delhi Sultanate.

KAMPILI KINGDOM (1296 - 1327 CE)


Kampilideva

In 1296, Singeya Nayaka III, a commander of the Yadava forces, declared independence from the Yadavas and formed the Kampili kingdom. His son **Kampilideva** was a valorous and successful king and expanded the kingdom. Kampilideva in the year 1313-1315 resisted Malik Kafur and made him retreat. In 1327–1328, the Delhi Sultanate under their new sultan Muhammad bin Tughluq attacked Kampili. Kampilideva defeated the sultan's troops twice, but when fresh reinforcements arrived from Devagiri, he was forced to shut himself up in the fort of Hosadurg (Anagondi). It was invaded by the enemy on all sides and lack of provisions made it impossible for Kampilldeva

to hold out for more than a month. He faced the invaders head-on and was martyred in the battle. Women committed Jauhar. The surviving sons of the king and his officers taken carried to Delhi as prisoners and forced to embrace Islam. Among these were the two brothers, **Harihara** and **Bukka**, who later founded the founders of the great kingdom of Vijayanagara.

KAKATIYA KINGDOM (1163 – 1323 CE)

The Kakatiya kingdom that was a feudatory of the Chaulukyas became an independent sovereign power in 1163. The region flourished during the entire 13th century. King Ganapathi Deva encouraged overseas trade, and abolished all taxes except for a fixed duty. Kakatiya rulers constructed temples and patronized learning centres. The glory and wealth of the Kakatiya kingdom, especially the famous mines of Golconda, attracted the attention of invaders. The first foray into the Telugu kingdom was made in 1303 by commander Fakruddin. It was a complete disaster for Fakruddin's army as the Kakatiya army repulsed the invaders in the battle at Upparapalli. A second attempt was made in 1309 by Malik Kafur. He managed to capture the forts of Siripur and Hanumakonda. Warangal fort was taken after a prolonged siege. Malik Kafur indulged in murder and mayhem around Warangal and this forced the Kakatiyas to make a pact and offer an enormous amount as tribute.

RANI RUDRAMADEVI (1262 - 1289 CE)

Kakatiya dynasty saw the ascension of a woman named Rudramadevi as the Queen of the empire who ruled for 27 years. She successfully conquered the neighbouring kingdoms to expand her empire. Marco Polo, a merchant traveller from Venice visited India and praised Rudramadevi's rule and her nature as a ruler.

DID YOU KNOW?

The famed Kohinoor diamond that crores of people go and see in the British museum actually belonged to the Kakatiyas.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

How did the Kohinoor diamond get to the UK? Trace it's route.

HOYSALA EMPIRE (1026 - 1343 CE)

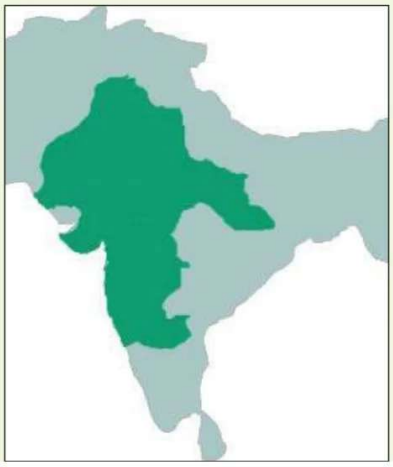
The Hoysala empire originated in the present-day Karnataka region, as a subordinate of the Western Chaulukya Empire. They expanded their territories and became a sovereign power during the times of king Vishnu Vardhana, who ruled for over 40 years. Hoysalas were great patrons of art and architecture. They constructed temples with intricate carvings and icons that stand as a testimony to the architectural prowess of Bharat. Their political influence had reached as far as Srirangam near Tiruchirapalli during the end of the 13th century.

An example of intricate Hoysala architecture
Lakshminarayana temple, Hosahonalu

Terror struck the prosperous Hoysalas when Malik Kafur plundered and sacked their capital city of Dwarasamudra in 1311. Hoysala king **Veera Ballala III** had to negotiate with Malik Kafur by paying a huge tribute and accepting the supremacy of the Delhi Sultanate.

MALIK KAFUR'S FORAY INTO MADURAI

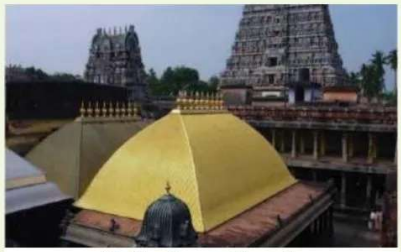
While at Dwarasamudra, Malik Kafur obtained information about the prosperity of Tamil Nadu. He also learnt about the temples of Tamil Nadu that served as great cultural centers. The Pandyas ruled most parts of Tamil Nadu. The two Pandya princes Sundara Pandya and Vira Pandya were engaged in a power struggle Malik Kafur took advantage of this and proceeded towards Virudachalam, the headquarters of Vira Pandya. Vira Pandya avoided open battle with the superior force of the invaders but frequently harassed the enemy through guerilla warfare. This ultimately exhausted the invaders, and Malik Kafur failed to secure the submission of the Pandya princes. Malik Kafur plundered the temples in Chidambaram, Virudachalam and Madurai. After the subjugation of the entire Deccan, the Delhi Sultanate grew to large extent covering more than 50% of Bharat's geography.



Spread of Alauddin Khalji's empire-1311 CE

Srirangam Temple

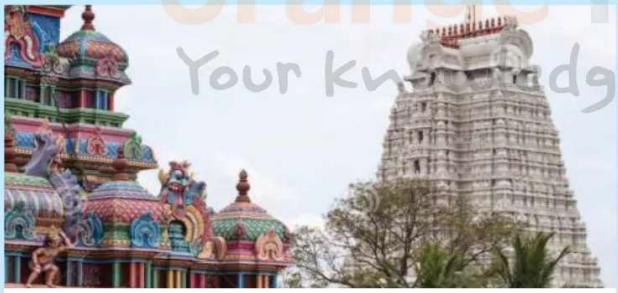
Madurai Temple



Chidambaram Temple

Orange House
Your knowledge partner

WHITE IN NAME, HEART AND DEED



Vellai Gopuram, Srirangam

Muhammad bin Tughluq invaded Tamil Nadu in 1323. He reached Tiruchirapalli and planned to plunder Srirangam. Knowing this, the pious citizens of the temple town decided to protect the temple. A massive 12,000 member human chain was formed. Though huge in numbers they were ordinary citizens. All the 12,000 people were slaughtered!!!

The invaders gained access into the temple and camped there, looting the temple and killing every Hindu they encountered. Aghast with the situation, a dancer named Vellayi cajoled the general of the sultan's army through her captivating dance. She led him atop a tower (Gopuram) stating that she knew where enormous treasure was hidden. Blinded by lust and greed, the general followed Vellayi to the top of the tower from where she pushed him to his death. Knowing that she won't be spared her life and honour, she jumped from the top, chanting the Lord's name and sacrificed her life. Even today, amidst many colourful towers in the Srirangam temple complex, one tall tower remains white. It is in memory of the fearless martyr Vellayi. In Tamil it is called 'Vellayi Gopuram'.

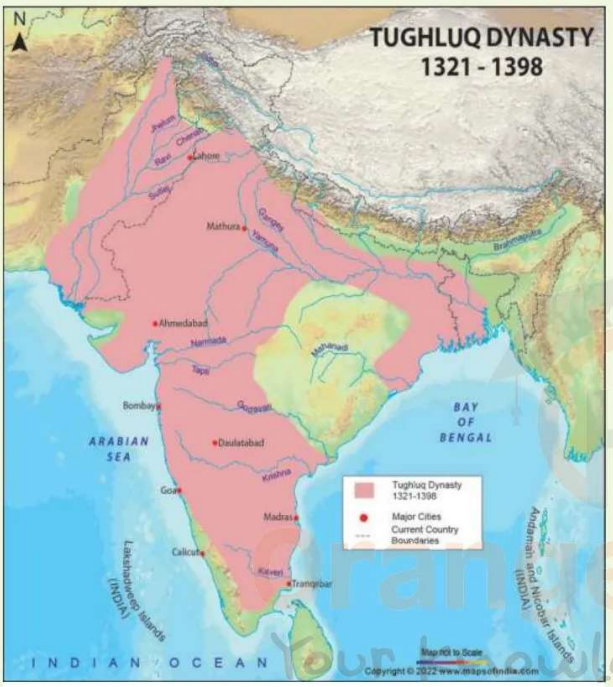
DEVELOPMENTS AT DELHI

DEATH OF ALAUDDIN KHALJI AND MALIK KAFUR

Alauddin Khalji died in 1316. Mubarrak Khan was the legal heir to the throne but Malik Kafur tried to assassinate Mubarrak Khan. Mubarrak Khan escaped and had Malik Kafur killed. Malik Kafur was dead within a month after the death of Alauddin Khalji.

SUCCESSION AND AFTERMATH

In 1320, Delhi saw its new sultan, Ghiyazuddin Tughluq. He continued with the same religious fanaticism* as his predecessors. Ghiyazuddin sent his son Muhammad bin Tughluq on an expedition to the south Tughluq subjugated the Kakatiyas and annexed the Pandya territories. After a ruthless massacre of the locals and a spree of temple desecration and looting he annexed Madurai to the Delhi sultanate.



Spread of Muhammad bin Tughluq's empire-1311 CE

In 1325, Muhammad bin Tughluq became sultan King Kampilideva of the Kampili kingdom had given asylum to Tughluq's political rival. Tughluq killed Kamipilideva yet the king gave his refugee a safe passage to the Hoysala king Veera Ballala III. Eventually,Tughluq killed them too and annexed Hoysala.

Soon after Muhammad ascended the throne of the Delhi Sultanate, almost all of Bharat except Mewar, Orissa and some parts of the eastern coast and Malabar Coast came under him. This was the first time in the history of Bharat that almost 75% of the country's geography fell into an invader's net. But this did not last long. Within a few years, Muhammad started tasting defeats one after the other. Let us briefly look into some of them.

FALL OF TUGHLUQ

HAMMIR SINGH OF MEWAR ARRESTS TUGHLUQ

Rana Hammir

After the fall of Ratna Simha, Alauddin Khalji had stationed a Hindu ruler name Maldev as the caretaker of Mewar. His son-in-law Hammir Singh led a coup, dethroned Maldev and took over the reign in 1326. Hammir Singh was the origin of the Sisodia dynasty. The Sisodia dynasty grew to rule over Mewar for the next five centuries.

BATTLE OF SINGOLI	
When? 1326 CE	
Where? Singoli, Rajasthan	
Who were the combatants?	
Sisodia Dynasty	Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Hammir Singh	Muhammud Bin Tughluq
Outcome : Arrest of Tughluq and decimation of the Sultanate army	
Significance : No invader could subjugate the Rajputs for 500 years	

Fanaticism : Holding extremely biased views

In 1336, Muhammud bin Tughluq marched with a large army towards Mewar tempting to take control. He was given a befitting reply at Singoli by Rana Hammir Singh. The sultanate forces were decimated and Chittorgarh fort was reclaimed. Hammir Singh arrested Muhammad bin Tughluq and released him. 3 months later only after he surrendered Ajmer, Ranthambore, Nagaur and other provinces and paid 50 million rupees and 1000 elephants as ransom. This marks the genesis of the Sisodia dynasty.

Hammir Singh's supremacy was unchallenged and accepted by the whole of Rajputana and he ruled for a long 48 years. From there on, the entire Rajputana remained a sovereign power and no invader could subjugate the kingdom for the next 500 years.

RECOVERY OF THE SOUTH

During the same time as Hammir Singh established his Mewar kingdom, a large confederacy of over 75 chieftains was formed in southern Bharat to overthrow the sultan.

The combined army drove away the Muslim garrison from the Andhra region. Musunuri Kapaya Nayaka took the lead, with active support from Prolaya Vema Reddy (founder of Reddy kingdom) and Veera Ballala III (Hoysala King). They expelled the sultan from the northern part of Tamil Nadu and placed their chief at Kanchipuram.

By 1328, Muhammad bin Tughluq had established his authority over almost the entire southern region of Bharat. But in less than ten years he lost the entire region south of the Krishna-Tungabhadra line, and even a part of Telangana and coastal districts of Andhra Pradesh.

DECIMATION AT KANGRA

In 1333, Muhammad bin Tughluq led an expedition to the Kullu-Kangra region of modern-day Himachal Pradesh in Bharat. He originally wanted to cross the Himalayas and invade China. However, he faced local resistance in Himachal. Prithvi Chand II of the Katoch kingdom of Kangra defeated the army of Muhammad bin Tughluq which was not able to fight in the hills. Most of the Tughluq forces perished and the survivors retreated. Historians note that this loss at Kangra was substantial and led to the weakening of the sultanate.

With successive defeats at the hands of the rulers of Bharat in various regions, and of treasury because of reckless economic policies, Muhammad bin Tughluq lost control of governance. He died in 1351 and was followed by a weak sultan Firuz Shah Tughluq.

BATTLE OF KANGRA	
When? 1333 CE	
Where? Kangra, Himachal Pradesh	
Who were the combatants?	
Hindu Katoch	Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Prithvi Chand II	Muhammad Bin Tughluq
Outcome : Decisive Victory of Prithvi Chand. Over 1,00,000 soldiers of the Sultanate army killed	
SIGNIFICANCE : Significant weakening of Delhi Sultanate	

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

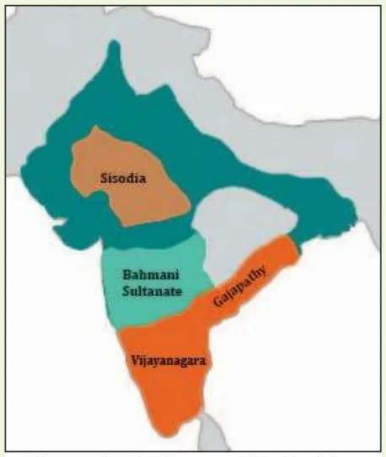
Muhammad bin Tughluq changed his capital from Delhi to Daulatabad, which are 1,200 km apart. Discuss if his action was wise. What would have been the consequences?

CONCLUSION

Large portions of Bharat in 1328 were under Muhammad bin Tughluq. However, the eastern side of Bharat and present-day Odisha, remained independent. It was because of a powerful empire called the Eastern Ganga dynasty whose king Narasimha Deva had dealt such a deadly blow to the sultanates during the end of

the 13th century, that even Alauddin Khalji and Tughluq did not dare to enter that region. By 1340, the Delhi Sultanate had shrunk considerably. Bhakti tradition re-infused by the great saint Jnaneshwar in Maharashtra, served as a great source of confidence for the ordinary people.

What is noteworthy is not how many times Bharat fell but how many times Bharat rose after the fall. The tenacity and perseverance of various rulers, their resolve to live and die for Sanatana Dharma and Swarajya led to the blossoming of two of the greatest empires of the world - the Sisodia empire in northern Bharat and the Vijayanagara empire in southern Bharat.



Bharat after Muhammad bin Tughluq

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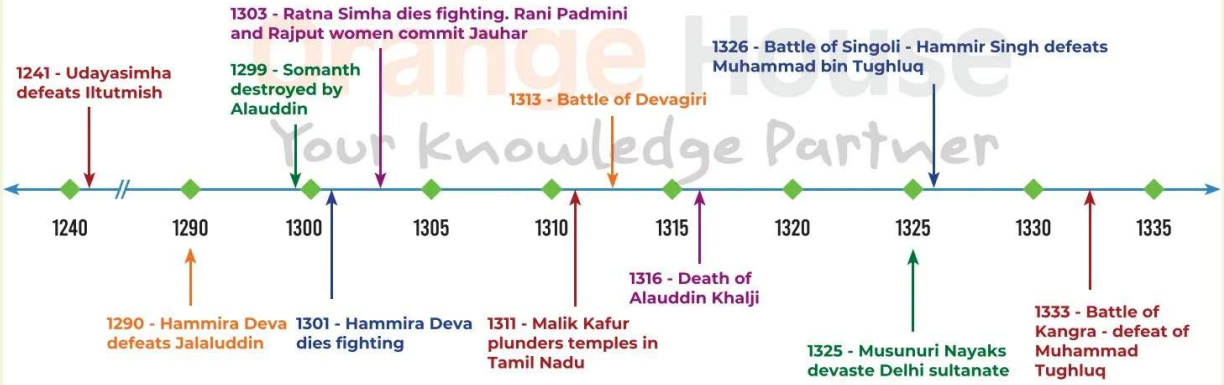
KEYWORDS

- Chahamana
- Hammira Deva
- Alauddin Khalji
- Jizya
- Chittorgarh
- Sithala Deva
- Sant Jnaneshwar
- Varkari
- Sri Madhvacharya
- Battle of Devagiri
- Muhammad bin Tughluq
- Kampilideva
- Rani Rudrama Devi
- Kakatiya
- Malik Kafur
- Veera Ballala
- Madurai
- Vellayi
- Rana Hammir Singh
- Battle of Kangra

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



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Your knowledge Partner

QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Following the Mamluk dynasty, _____ dynasty took over the throne of Delhi.
   a) Chahamana b) Lohara c) Khalji d) Rajput
2. Prithviraj Chauhan belonged to the _____ Chahamana dynasty.
   a) Shakambari b) Naddula c) Jator d) Ranastambhapura
3. _____ were the vassals of the Gurjara Pratiharas
   a) Simhas b) Guhilots c) Rajputs d) Kakatiyas

4. Sant Jnaneshwar translated the _____ so that common people could understand
   a) Upanishads b) Mahabharata c) Bhagavad Gita d) Ramayana
5. Which regions did NOT fall under Tughluq after his massive expansion drive?
   a) Marwar b) Mewar c) Anhilavada d) Hoysala
6. True or False
   Statement A: When Fakruddin attacked the Kakatiyas, the Kakatiyas won decisively
   Statement B: When Malik Kafur attacked the Kakatiyas, the Kakatiyas were forced to give a huge compensation and a few forts.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) Both A & B are true d) Both A & B are false

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN A CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. (a) Alauddin Khalji becomes Sultan of Delhi (b) Hammira Deva is betrayed by Alauddin
   (c) Hammira Deva repulses Jallaluddin Khalji's army (d) Rani Padmini embraces Jauhar
2. (a) King Ramadeva is attacked by Alauddin Khalji (b) Kampilideva made Malik Kafur retreat
   (c) Muhammad bin Tughluq becomes Sultan of Delhi (d) Rudramadevi rules the Kakatiya empire

ANSWER IN BRIEF

1. What is Jizya? How did it affect commoners?
2. What is Jauhar? Why did Rani Padmini and other Rajput women choose to embrace Jauhar?
3. What is the Varkari tradition? How does it impact the social and religious life of Bharatiyas?
4. How did the Musunuri Nayaks drive out the tyrant Muhammad bin Tughluq?
5. Name the southern kingdoms affected by Malik Kafur's raid
6. Why did Tughluq lose to Raja Prithvi Chand II in the Battle of Kangra? Mention the highlights and significance of the battle.

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Your Knowledge Partner

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. How did Chittorgarh and Siwana show their resistance to Alauddin Khalji? What was the reason for their defeat and death? Explain in detail.
2. How did the Hindu saints like Sri Jnanaeshwar and Sri Madhvacharya impact the society during this era?
3. How did Vellayi, a simple dancer, help in the resistance against the Delhi Sultanate?
4. Who was Malik Kafur? How did he expand the Delhi Sultanate to the southern parts of Bharat?
5. What happened in the Battle of Singoli? What is its significance?

CASE STUDY

In 1300 Hammira Deva gave asylum to two Mongol Generals, who were enemies of Alauddin Khalji. This angered Alauddin and he decided to trick Hammira. He invited Hammira for peace talks. Hammira accepted the offer and sent two of his generals, Ratipala and Ranmal. Alauddin promised the generals that if they helped him in capturing the fort of Ranthambore, they would be given the entire kingdom as a gift. The two generals agreed and betrayed their king. They led their forces outside and joined Alauddin's army. Hammira offered his brother Virama, his minister Jaja, and the rebel Mongol leader Muhammad Shah to escape through a safe passage. But all of them refused to desert him. Virama died fighting by his side. Jaja, whom Hammira had appointed as his successor, died two days later while defending the fort. Muhammad Shah was wounded in the battle and later executed on Alauddin's orders. Hammira and his loyal companions marched to the top of the fort mound and slew the enemy forces with all their might.

1. Why did Hammira give shelter to Alauddin's enemies?
2. What was the difference in the way Hammira won his battles and Alauddin won his wars?
3. Virama, Jaja and Muhammad Shah chose to fight along Hammira, even though they had the chance to leave. What can we learn about Hammira Deva from this?

MAP WORK

Mark the following places in the outline map of India:

- Ranthambore
- Chittorgarh
- Devagiri
- Delhi
- Daulatabad
- Madurai

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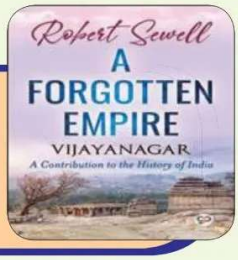
Chapter 5

VIJAYANAGARA – THE CITY OF VICTORY

"....A city that had merchants from Persia & Portugal crowding its shops, which displayed gold and gems as though they were common wares, a city whose sceptre was the law of the land till the point where land met sea."

- Robert Sewell



LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss about the rise of Vijayanagara Empire.
- Explain the greatness of king Krishnadevaraya
- Appreciate how culture, arts, architecture, literature flourished under the empire.
- Examine how the empire declined.

INTRODUCTION

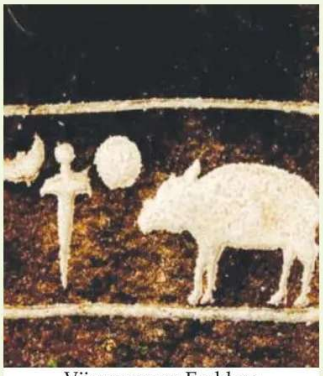
The south of Bharat was reeling under the onslaught of the invaders in the early 1300s. The Sangama brothers - **Harihara** and **Bukka** were administering and leading the northern parts of the Hoysala kingdom. They were captured by the invading forces of Muhammad bin Tughluq, converted to Islam, and sent to administer regions in present day Karnataka and Andhra as representatives of the Delhi Sultanate. Although Harihara and Bukka got converted to Islam, they were waiting for an opportunity to convert back to Hindu Dharma. The Hindu citizens of the area were also spirited to get away from the rule of the Delhi Sultanate. Harihara and Bukka saw a chance to revert to their original religion, Hinduism, and develop the regions they governed as independent rulers. Into the scene entered **Madhava Vidyaranya**, their spiritual mentor and guide. Vidyaranya enabled the Sangama brothers to set up their independent kingdom that laid the foundations for the Vijayanagara empire. Southern Bharat was able to release itself from the hold of the invaders.

HARES CHASING DOGS

Popular folklore talks about the choice of Hampi as the capital of the Vijayanagara empire. Harihara and Bukka were on an expedition when they see a hare being chased by a pack of dogs. Even as they see the hare run for its life, something unusual unfolds before them. The hare suddenly stops in its tracks. Turning around, the hare looks at the dogs and starts chasing them. The hunted turns into the hunter! Harihara and Bukka are astonished on seeing this and report this to their guru Swami Vidyaranya. On their guru's guidance, this area where they witnessed this incident was chosen as their capital city of Hampi.

SANGAMA DYNASTY

HARIHARA I


Vijayanagara Emblem

Harihara I was crowned king in 1336 CE in Hampi. The kingdom stretched from Dharwar and Badami in northern Karnataka to Nellore in the south-east.

The Vijayanagara empire emblem carried images of a varaha (boar), a sun, a moon and a sword. The sun and moon denote the long-lasting and illuminating nature of the kingdom. The sword signifies bravery and valour. The varaha (an avatar of Vishnu) signifies punishment of the wicked and protection of the world.

Harihara I ruled Hampi as a representative of Virupaksha, the God of Vijayanagara empire. Even the documents he signed were under the name of Shri Virupaksha

BUKKA I

Harihara I laid the foundation for an effective civil administration system that was taken over by Bukka I around 1356 CE. The outlying provinces of the kingdom were governed by his nephews under the supremacy of Bukka I. But Bukka's nephews thought of themselves as the final authority. Bukka I immediately sensed that this kind of ruling arrangement will lead to disintegration of the kingdom. He immediately appointed his sons to govern these outlying provinces and made them responsible for establishing his central authority. One of his sons, **Kumara Kampana**, was made governor of Mulbagal, a province in Karnataka. Kumara Kampana went on to become the key person to end the reign of the Madurai sultanate.

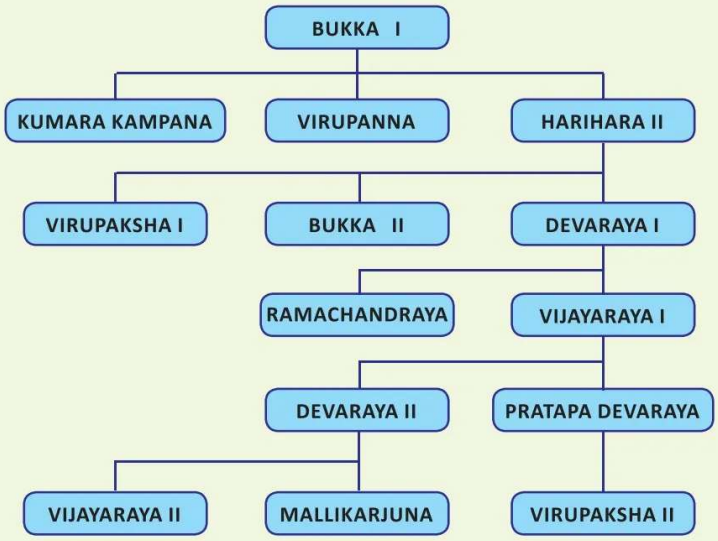
Vijayanagara Empire 1350 CE

KUMARA KAMPANA ENDS THE MADURAI SULTANATE

The Madurai region came under the grip of sultans like Jalaludin Khan in 1336 CE. The people of the region were tortured and killed indiscriminately. Hindu temples were razed to the ground. Ibn Batuta, the Moroccan Muslim traveler of that time details the atrocities of the Madurai sultanate. Kumara Kampana victoriously eradicated the Muslim presence at various centres in present-day Tamil Nadu. He freed Tamil Nadu and most of southern Bharat by slaying the sultan of Madurai in 1370 CE. The temples of Srirangam and Chidambaram suffered the worst during the rule of Muhammadans. Restoration of Srirangam, signaled the re-establishment of Hindu power in southern Bharat.

Regions of Arcot and Kondavidu came under the Vijayanagara flag. Bukka I successfully fought against the Bahmani sultans–once with Muhammad I and then with Mujahid. This brought Goa under the empire. The regions of Malabar and Sri Lanka were also won over by Bukka I. The rulers of these regions paid tribute to the Vijayanagara empire. The conquest of Madurai and beyond brought the regions all the way upto Rameshwaram under the Vijayanagara empire. Bukka I is considered the architect of the Vijayanagara empire.

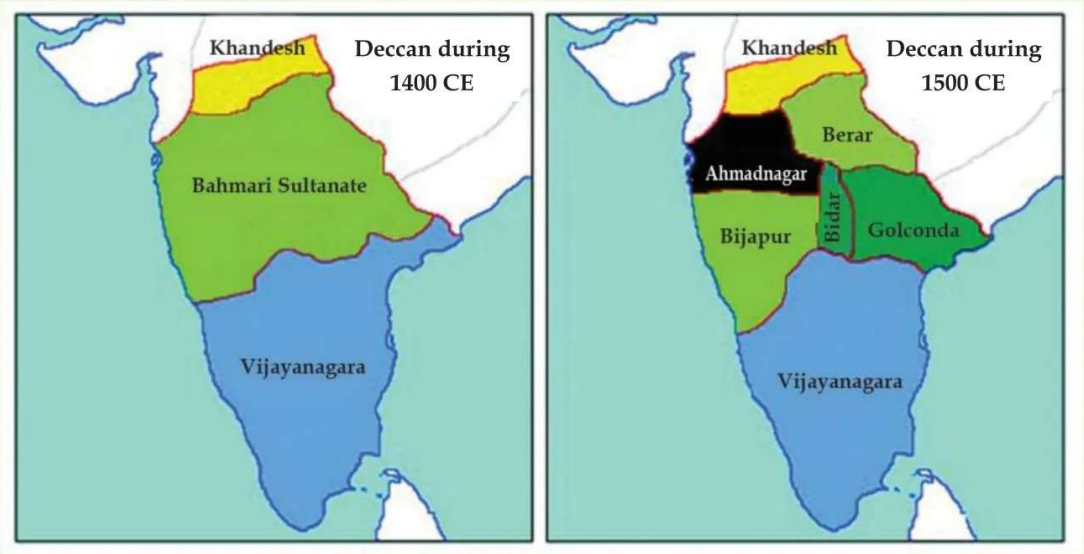
THE SANGAMA DYNASTY TREE AFTER BUKKA I

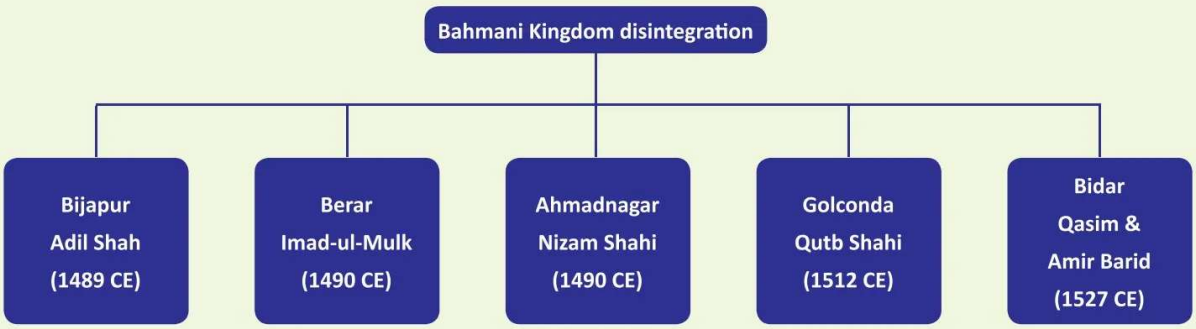


CHANGE IN POLITICAL FORTUNES

EMERGENCE AND DISINTEGRATION OF THE BAHMANI KINGDOM

Even as the Sangama dynasty was coming to a close due to weak and inefficient rulers, the Bahmani kingdom was also starting to break up. The rulers of the Bahmani kingdom believe that their roots were from Bahman, a mythological figure of greater Iran. Alauddin Hassan Bahman Shah revolted against the Delhi Sultan Muhammad bin Tughluq and established his own kingdom in the Deccan, marking the origin of the Bahmani kingdom. Muhammad Shah and his minister Muhammad Gawan had held the Bahmani kingdom together. However the death of Gawan quickened the disintegration. Yusuf Adil Khan, a slave under the Bahmani Sultan Muhammad Shah, had been appointed governor of Bijapur. When he saw the confusion in the kingdom he declared Bijapur as an independent kingdom under his rule. This marked the beginning of the Adil Shahi kingdom in 1489 CE. Thus, the Bahmani kingdom was broken up into 5 smaller kingdoms - Bijapur, Berar, Ahmadnagar, Golconda and Bidar.

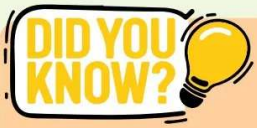




SALUVA AND TULUVA REIGN

With the Sangama rulers perishing, Vijayanagara came under the reign of the Saluvas followed by the Tuluvas. Saluva Narasimha , a brave general and governor, took over the responsibilities in 1485 CE. The achievements of Saluva Narasimha include the recapturing of the ports of Honnavar, Mangalore and Bhatkal from the Bahmanis. However, Saluva Narasimha suffered a major defeat at the hands of the Gajapati ruler of Odisha. This led to shrinkage of the Vijayanagara empire as many parts of coastal Andhra were lost to the Gajapatis.

The Saluvas were replaced by the Tuluvas in 1505 CE that laid the foundations for a revival of the Vijayanagara empire. 1509 CE saw the throne taken over by the great **Krishnadevaraya**.



Almeida, a viceroy of Portugal for the Indian coast, arrived in the Honnavar port around 1505 CE and was keen to establish trade links with Tuluva Narasa Nayaka. An Italian traveller Varthema praises Vijayanagara and records the presence of three layered walls for protection of the city. The Portuguese started engaging with Bharat – through both trade and military conquest.

KRISHNADEVARAYA, THE CREST JEWEL OF VIJAYANAGARA

The Vijayanagara empire saw its most famous ruler in 1509 CE, a king who never lost a war. The Ganga, Gajapati and Bahmani kingdoms shivered at the mere mention of his name. A king who was a scholar and patronized temples and poets. He was Krishnadevaraya.

Sri Krishnadevaraya

MILITARY CONQUESTS

Immediately after taking over the throne, Krishnadevaraya was involved in a major battle with the Bahmani sultan Mahmud Shah who had declared war against the Vijayanagara empire. The two sides met in Dony where Krishnadevaraya dealt a crushing blow to Mahmud. The Bahmani forces retreated to Kovelakonda and Krishnadevaraya's armies pursued them and forced another fight there and completely routed the Bahmani armies.

BATTLE OF RAICHUR

For over 200 years, the Vijayanagara and Bahmani rulers had been at war. A key fort, Raichur, was a constant source of many battles and it passed hands between the Vijayanagara and Bahmani kingdoms. Krishnadevaraya sought to capture Raichur and put an end to the feud. He met the armies of Bijapur sultan Ismail Adil Shah. Camped across the Krishna river was the army of Ismail Adil Shah. On 19 May 1520 the two forces met. While the initial advance of the Vijayanagara empire was furious, the canons of the Bijapur army created losses for the Vijayanagara army. This was a setback for Vijayanagara and as their

soldiers started falling back, a full scale retreat seemed imminent. Seeing this, Krishnadevaraya rallied all his soldiers from the front and charged at the Bijapur army. At great danger to his own life Raja Krishnadevaraya launched a counter-attack directing all his forces in a full scale frontal assault. The Bijapur army was driven to the river bank and were routed. Krishnadevaraya chased the Bijapur army beyond the river. Ismail Adil Shah managed to slip away. Raja Krishnadevaraya entered the Raichur fort victoriously. The victory was so resounding that the Bahmani sultans never dared to challenge the Vijayanagara empire during Raja Krishnadevaraya's rule.

BATTLE OF RAICHUR	
When?	20 May 1520
Where?	Raichur, Karnataka
Who were the combatants?	
Vijayanagara empire	Bijapur Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Krishnadevaraya	Ismail Adil Shah
Outcome : Bijapur Sultanate decimated	
SIGNIFICANCE : Bahmani sultans never challenged Vijayanagara again during the reign of Krishnadevaraya	

Krishnadevaraya conquered Raichur, Gulbarga and Bidar. After defeating the Bidar sultan, he placed Mahmud Shah as the ruler. This was to weaken his neighbouring rulers. Mahmud Shah was not liked by the Islamic rulers in the Deccan region and Krishnadevaraya ensured that there was disharmony among them.

THINK!!!

Why would Raja Krishnadevaraya place an enemy ruler on the throne after winning Bidar?

Extent of Vijayanagara empire under Raja Krishnadevaraya

A warrior general, Krishnadevaraya led his armies from the fro nt and won glorious victories. With the aid of an able minister in Saluva Thimmarasa, he maintained peace in the empire and ensured its prosperity. Krishnadevaraya is often referred to as a skilled and successful general, benevolent administrator, tolerant towards other religions and a lover of arts. He understood the need to engage with foreign forces like the Portuguese to ensure a stable kingdom.

DID YOU KNOW?

Krishnadevaraya had a massive army. It comprised of seven lakh infantry, twenty-two thousand cavalry and five hundred and fifty-one elephants ever prepared for war !!!

KRISHNADEVARAYA AND THE PORTUGUESE

The Portuguese were trying to establish forts on the West coast. To establish their presence in Bharat, they made many requests to Krishnadevaraya including asking for his help to invade Calicut. Krishnadevaraya refused that but allowed the Portuguese to build a fort at Bhatkal, a coastal trading town. In return, Krishnadevaraya was able to get a regular supply of hundreds of Arab and Persian horses that he inducted into his army.

THINK!!!

Was Krishnadevaraya correct in allowing the Portuguese to establish a trading post? Are there other examples where such an arrangement between nations have been done?

LIFE IN VIJAYANAGARA

HARNESSING WATER, A LIFE SOURCE

The regions in and around Hampi are rocky and arid. The Tungabhadra river is a key water source, but it is a rain-fed river and is not a perennial water source. How did the residents get water supplied to their farms, homes and palaces?

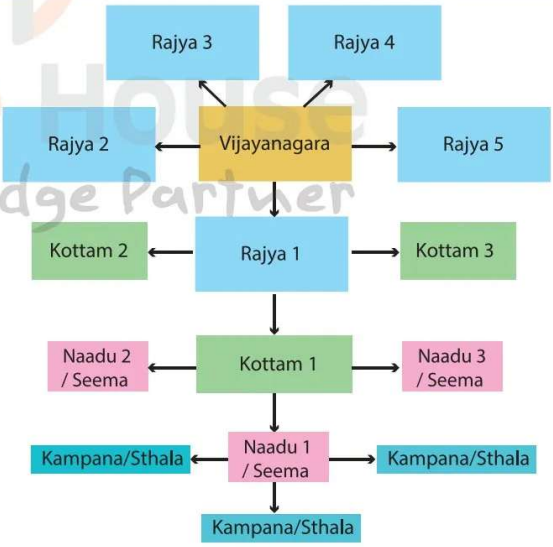
Aqueduct - built by Bukka

In 1345 CE Bukka constructed an Aqueduct to lift huge quantities of water from river Tungabhadra to nearby places. Deva Raya in 1410 CE built a dam across the Tungabhadra. He built a network of canals for irrigation. This ensured the agricultural prosperity of the region. To provide reliable drinking water supply to the people living in Vijayanagara, an extensive network of large canals interconnected with smaller canals took water to the homes of people. The world had not seen such water supply systems.

ADMINISTRATION

AN EFFICIENT ADMINISTRATION STRUCTURE

With the King at the top, Vijayanagara was administered with the help of a cabinet or Pradhana. This cabinet was led by a Prime Minister, the Mahapradhana. There were 72 departments (Niyogas) in a palace. To enable efficient administration, the empire was divided into five provinces (rajyas). Each province was further sub-divided into regions (Kottam), counties (Naadu) and municipalities (Sthala). The five rajyas had a governor and a commander to take care of administration and security. The governor of the rajyas were from the royal family who were familiar with the culture and the ways of the rajyas they ruled. This enabled efficient administration.



Vijayanagara administration structure

NAYAKA SYSTEM TO GOVERN

The Vijayanagara empire covered a large geography. Present day Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh were all under the Vijayanagara empire. The ruler gave away large tracts of land to **Nayakas** (or Nayaks), powerful generals or commanders. The Nayaks took care of the people and the regional needs. These included health management, irrigation, maintaining temples and all departments of a current day town or municipality. The Nayaks maintained a standing army to ensure the security of the region. Taxes were collected from the citizens of the region.

In return for the land grants given by the king, the Nayaks paid around half of the revenues collected as tribute to the central Vijayanagara rulers. They also sent their armies to assist the Vijayanagara rulers when required. Till around 1565 CE, the Nayaks were mostly military chiefs who governed and maintained an army.

THE MADURAI NAYAKS

Madurai Nayak governed region

Krishnadevaraya wanted to bring the Pandya kingdom under the Vijayanagara empire. In 1528 CE, Krishnadevaraya sent his popular general Nangama Nayaka to secure those regions. However, he started revolting against Krishnadevaraya. Krishnadevaraya sent Nangama's son Vishwanatha Nayak to quell the revolt.

Vishwanatha Nayak was successful in defeating his father and this was the start of the Madurai Nayak dynasty. Lands were cleared for cultivation, irrigation projects instituted, temples rebuilt and trade expanded. Most of the geography was divided into Palayams that were governed by local chiefs, known as Palayakarars (anglicized as Polygars).

Even after Vijayanagara fell, the Nayaka rulers continued in their respective areas. Some famous names in the Madurai Nayak dynasty include Thirumala Nayak and Rani Mangamma.

ECONOMY AND TRADE

The Vijayanagara empire was prosperous and its economy was renowned around the world. With a wide geographical spread of fertile lands and dry lands, agriculture thrived. Rice, wheat and sugarcane were grown in the fertile coastal belts. Pulses, cotton and millets were grown in the drier areas. Areca nut, betel and coconut were the main cash crops. Turmeric, cardamom, pepper and other spices were brought from the Western Ghats in present day Karnataka and sold in the cities.

Foreign Traders - Vijaya Vittala Temple Sculpture

The major sea-ports on both the west and east coast were conducive for trade. On the west coast, the ports of Honnavar, Mangalore, Bhaktal, Cannanore and Kochi were critical to trade. Machilipatnam on the east coast was one of the largest trading port and hub. Vijayanagara traded with China, Africa, Persia, Palestine, Java and the Far East and many more countries around the world.

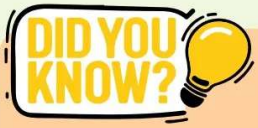
Hampi was one of the most important economic and trading hubs. Accounts of foreign travellers, historians and other sources indicate that Hampi was an important

Remains of Hampi Marketplace

market for precious stones and gold. It is said that pearls, rubies, diamonds were sold in the open. Imagine large heaps of diamonds on the streets where merchants and customers haggled* on the rates.

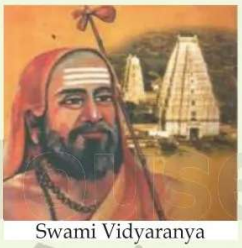
Goods Exported :
Spices, Cotton
Jewelery
Precious stones
Perfumes
Iron, Steel
Tobacco

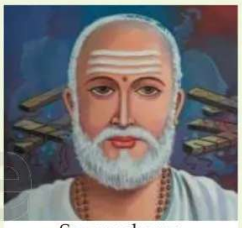
Goods Imported :
Mercury, Copper
Horses
Coral
Camphor
Luxury goods
Silk



Most farmers were given partial ownership of the land that they tended. Taxes were imposed when required and was calculated based on the extant of the land used and the necessity of the crop grown in the land. Confusing? Let us explore. The citizens of Vijayanagara loved perfumes. A key ingredient for making perfumes is rose petals. So, if a farmer cultivated rose in his/her land then the taxes would have been very low. Isn't that interesting?

RELIGION AND SOCIETY


Swami Vidyaranya


Sayanacharya

The Vijayanagara empire's society was characterized by openness and flexibility and Dharma assumed centre stage. Kanakadasa, a Kuruba who were typically shepherds or militiamen, was one of the most famous scholar and poet. From the potter community arose the great poetess Molla. Women were accorded a very high status in society and occupied important administrative and trade positions. Some of the most famous literary works of the time were composed by people like Ganga Devi (Madhura Vijayam) and Timmakka (Subhadra Parinayam). Vijayanagara rulers were firm devotees of Shiva and Vishnu. They were upholders of Hinduism. Sayanacharya, brother of Swami Vidyaranya was patronized by the Vijayanagara kings. He wrote commentaries on the four Vedas.

HARIDASA MOVEMENT - A SIGNIFICANT CONTRIBUTOR TO THE BHAKTI TRADITION

Swami Purandaradasa

Swami Kanakadasa

Knowledge of great philosophers like Sankara, Jnaneshwara, Madhvacharya were taken to masses through Dasa Sahitya or Literature of the devotees of the Lord. Lord Vitthala of Pandharpur was the primary deity worshipped by the Haridasas. Vyasatirtha, a famous saint in the Vijayanagara empire, was instrumental in creating the Haridasa movement. Some of the famous Haridasas (devotees) of this time include Purandaradasa and Kanakadasa. They helped inculcate Dharma among the masses and spread social awareness. Carnatic music was structured by the great Purandaradasa whose songs are sung in music concerts to this day. The Haridasa movement ensured that people were able to preserve their way of life and worship.

Haggle : Bargain

Bhakti movement helped people reconnect to their Dharmic roots and culture that had been erased due to Islamic invasions.

REFINEMENT IN CULTURE

ARCHITECTURE

The temples of Vijayanagara, the grand palaces, bustling markets, efficiently engineered water management systems, secured town planning and more indicate the advanced capabilities in the field of architecture in the Vijayanagara empire. The sculptors created poetry in stones like granite and soapstone.

Stone Chariot, Hampi

Virupaksha Temple, Hampi

Hazara Rama Temple: Scenes from Ramayana

Chennakesava Temple Murthi

Vidyashankara Temple

Grand temples like the Virupaksha temple and Chennakesava temple inspire us even today. The larger temples had a tall and grand gopuram called as Rayagopurams to indicate that it was built by the Vijayanagara kings. Krishnadevaraya commissioned some of the most famous Rayagopurams in the Chennakesava temple and Srisailam

temple. Temple carvings depicted scenes from the puranas, itihaasas and even daily incidents of those times. Stepwells have been discovered in Hampi that indicate influence of the Hoysalas in Vijayanagara architecture. The palaces were built with stone, wood, brick lime and finished with expensive metals and materials.

ARTS, LITERATURE AND MORE

Arts and literature flourished in the Vijayanagara empire. There were many poets, scholars and playwrights who composed in many languages for the learned and the masses. Works in Telugu, Kannada, Tamil and Sanskrit were composed during the rule of the Vijayanagara kings. Many rulers of Vijayanagara themselves were highly accomplished poets and scholars.

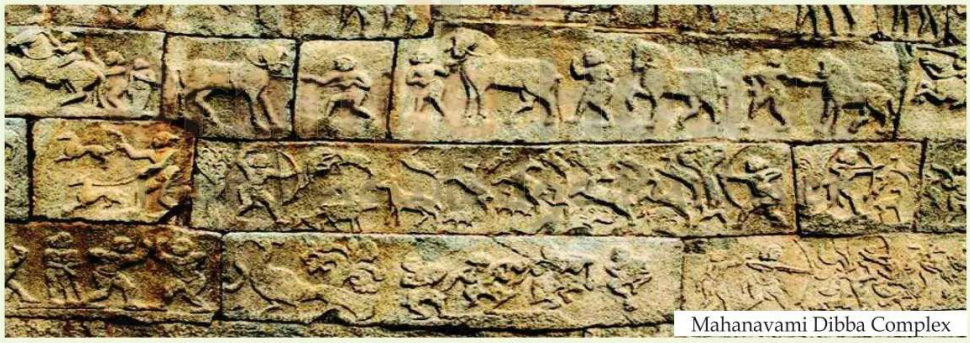
Raja Krishnadevaraya wrote many works including the Rasamanjari and Madalasa Charita in Sanskrit. A famous work in Telugu titled **Amuktamalyada** is his "master work or crowning achievement. Krishnadevaraya's court had eight reputed poets and scholars-the Ashta Diggajas.

DID YOU KNOW?

Tenali Ramakrishna, popularly known as Tenali Rama was one of the Ashta Diggajas. He was known for his superior intellect and humour. He was a great poet and composed works like Panduranga Mahatmyam

SPORTS AND PASTIME

Vijayanagara people were keen to display their skills in many sports. Wrestling, boxing, hunting and fencing were some of the sports that the citizens of Vijayanagara indulged in. Wrestling bouts were greatly enjoyed by the people and many women were also involved in these bouts. Duels with spears and many weapons were also a popular pastime. The panel in the Mahanavami Dibba complex in Hampi depicts women who are shown taming wild horses, wielding bows and spears and riding horses and elephants. Kabbadi, ball games and many other games are said to have been popular.



Mahanavami Dibba Complex

DID YOU KNOW?

Have you seen these statues of Raja Krishnadevaraya and his queens?

They are found at the famous Tirupati, Balaji temple.

Next time you visit the temple, make sure you look out for it!

Women Wrestling - Hampi

DECLINE OF VIJAYANAGARA

ALIYA RAMARAYA AND THE DECLINE OF THE VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

In 1529 CE, Krishnadevaraya died of illness when he was 58 years old. Achyutha Devaraya succeeded him. Many internal disturbances and external attacks were a feature of his reign where he lost Raichur and Mudgal to the Bijapur sultan. After his death in 1542 CE, there was some confusion in the succession but Aliya Ramaraya, the son-in-law of Krishnadevaraya, took over as regent till 1550 CE. Aliya Ramaraya then became king. For almost 15 years he ruled Vijayanagara during which time he inducted many people loyal to him in the army. He placed many Muslims in responsible positions within the army. During his reign, he constantly interfered in the politics of the states in the Deccan to keep them weak and to increase his power.

TALIKOTA AND ITS AFTERMATH

The sultans of Berar, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Bidar and Bijapur recognised the confusion being seeded by Aliya Ramaraya. They formed a coalition (except Bidar) and attacked Aliya Ramaraya in the Battle of Talikota in 1565 CE. The battle happened at present day Rakkasa-Tangadi which is southwest of Talikota. Aliya Ramaraya had prepared to ensure that the combined forces of the sultans do not cross the river Krishna. The Bahmani armies had identified some parts of the river that were unguarded. They pretended to attempt the river crossing at certain points that were guarded and failed at it. The Vijayanagara armies had their guard down with the initial success. However the Bahmani armies now pushed through the unguarded points to cross the river. Initially it appeared that Vijayanagara forces were winning but soon many of the Muslim generals in the Vijayanagara army, like the Gilani brothers who were appointed by Aliya Ramaraya, betrayed him. Tens of thousands of Muslim soldiers in the Vijayanagara army defected or deserted their side and helped the Bahmani armies. Aliya Ramaraya was captured and immediately beheaded. Seeing their dead king, the Vijayanagara army retreated. However, they couldn't get far as the pursuing Bahmani armies massacred the Vijayanagara forces.

One account of the war states that it took more than 12 days to count the dead bodies that lay between the battlefield and Hampi. The Bahmani forces then marched towards Hampi. They camped there for more than 6 months during which time they burned everything in their sight. All the wealth was plundered, temples and palaces demolished and anything within a 90 km radius was burned down. Grand and prosperous Hampi got referred to in Kannada as "Haalu" Hampi or "Ruined" Hampi.

BATTLE OF TALIKOTA

BATTLE OF TALIKOTA	
When?	January 1565 CE
Where?	Rakkasa-Tangadi
Who were the combatants?	
Vijayanagara	Deccan Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Aliya Ramaraya	Deccan sultans
Outcome : Defeat of Vijayanagara	
SIGNIFICANCE : Fall of the consolidated Vijayanagara empire.	

AN ASSESSMENT OF THE CAUSE OF THE DEFEAT AT TALIKOTA

When a civilization attains maturity and prosperity, it needs to be very careful to not become lazy and careless. Ramaraya became too comfortable when he thought he could manage the Bahmani sultans by creating divisions between them. However, they came together, bound by their common religious faith. The Vijayanagara empire was bound by Dharma and Aliya Ramaraya was inclusive enough to have many Muslims in his army. However, this proved to be a major factor in his loss at Talikota. The Bahmani sultans used the Muslims in Vijayanagara army to defect to their side. The Bahmani sultans fought amongst themselves. However, they were prepared to come together for the cause of their religion. Ramaraya thought

he was well prepared for war. However, he underestimated the enemy's collective power and motive. Will the future rulers of Bharat learn from these mistakes?

CONCLUSION

The contributions of the Vijayanagara empire to our nation and the world has been tremendous to say the least. It helped preserve the way of life of Bharat, especially in the south. This becomes more evident considering the mindless destruction of peoples lives, wealth and temples in the north by the Islamic invaders. But for the emergence and growth of Vijayanagara, the south would have met the same fate as that of the north. All aspects of our social and cultural life like dance, music, art forms, temple architecture, vedic worship etc would have crumbled if not for the rulers and citizens of the Vijayanagara empire. Prominent historian R.C.Majumdar summarizes, "…Modern Hindu India is indebted to the Vijayanagara kingdom in the south for having preserved the continuity of the culture and traditions, from the Vedic age downwards, which was in imminent danger of being altogether snapped. For it is impossible to deny that India was saved from this irretrievable disaster by the patronage of the rulers of Vijayanagara. While the (vedic) culture was submerged under the sea of Islam…it found its last refuge…at southern extremities. This plain truth is not realized by many historians."

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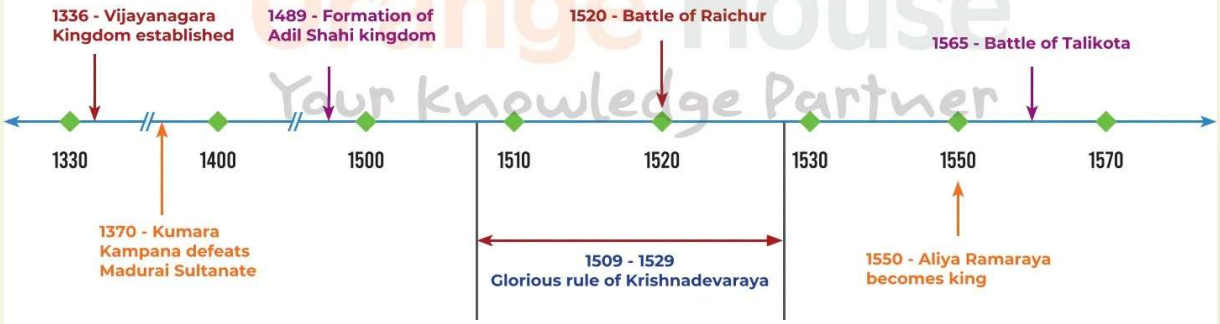
KEYWORDS

- Sangama Brothers
- Harihara and Bukka
- Swami Madhava Vidyaranya
- Bahmani Sultans
- Kumara Kampana
- Saluva and Tuluva
- Krishnadevaraya
- Battle of Raichur
- Nayaka system
- Stone chariot, Hampi
- Architecture
- Haridasa movement
- Ashta Diggajas
- Aliya Ramaraya
- Battle of Talikota

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Which of these was **NOT** a part of the Vijayanagara Empire.
   a) Saluva b) Sangama c) Gajapathi d) Tuluva
2. Look at the statements below and choose the right answer
   Statement A : Bahmani kingdom got broken up into 5 smaller kingdoms.
   Statement B : After Saluvas, the Vijayanagara empire came under the Sangamas.
   a) Both are True b) Both are False c) A is false but B is true d) A is true but B is false

3. Which of the following forces did the Vijayanagara kings NOT fight with?
   a) Gajapatis b) Madurai Sultanate c) Deccan Sultanates d) Portuguese
4. Which of the following statements is false
   a) Vidyaranya guided Harihara and Bukka b) Krishnadevaraya was a poet
   c) Saluva Narasimha was defeated by a Gajapati king d) Sultan of Bidar joined the Deccan sultanate against Aliya Ramaraya
5. In which of the following temples was not constructed by the Vijayanagara kings?
   a) Srisailam temple b) Raichur temple c) Chennakesava temple d) Virupaksha temple
6. Choose the right chronological order of events.
   A – Battle of Raichur B – Battle of Talikota
   C – Kumara Kampana's victory against Madurai Sultanate D - Formation of Bijapur Sultanate
   a) CDAB b) CABD c)BACD d)BDCA

MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Kumara Kampana	Deccan Sultanate
Krishnadevaraya	Gajapathis
Bukka I	Madurai Sultanate
Saluva Narasimha	Ismail Adil Shah
Aliya Ramaraya	Muhammad I

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Why did Harihara choose Hampi as the capital of his empire?
2. Who was Kumara Kampana? What was his contribution?
3. Vijayanagara kings were efficient in water resource management. Cite evidences to prove this.
4. What happened at Raichur in 1520? What was its importance?
5. Who were Madurai Nayaks?

Orange House
Your Knowledge Partner

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. What was the administrative system of the Vijayanagara empire?
2. Vijayanagara was a prosperous and thriving empire. Corroborate.
3. Krishnadevaraya was a master of both the sword and pen. Explain with examples.
4. Explain the Haridasa movement and its importance.
5. How did the Vijayanagara empire come to an end? Examine its causes.

CASE STUDY

The Vijayanagara empire's society was characterized by openness and flexibility and Dharma assumed centre stage. Kanakadasa, a Kuruba who were typically shepherds or militiamen, was one of the most famous scholar and poet. From the potter community arose the great poetess Molla. Women were accorded a very high status in society and occupied important administrative and trade positions. Some of the most famous literary works of the time were composed by people like Ganga Devi (Madhura Vijayam) and Timmakka (Subhadra Parinayam). Vijayanagara rulers were firm devotees of Shiva and Vishnu. They were upholders of Hinduism. Sayanacharya, brother of Swami Vidyaranya was patronized by the Vijayanagara kings. He wrote commentaries on the four Vedas.

a. Vijayanagara empire's society was characterized by openness and flexibility. Give an example.
b. Women enjoyed high social status. Give an example.

Give an example of how Vijayanagara kings patronized Hindu Dharma.

Chapter 6

RAJPUTS - THE MAHAKSHATRIYAS

"A renascent India, (was) brought by the valour and blood of the heroic Rajputs. A Rajput would rather die than break his promise. For, the stories of Rajput heroes in this kind are endless. You, Rajputs, have been the glories of ancient India."

- Swami Vivekananda

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss about the reign of the Rajputs and how they ascended to supremacy.
- Assess the role of the valorous Rajput kings and queens in defending Bharat
- Explain the importance of Maharana Pratap in the history of Bharat
- Examine the crucial battles fought by Rana Sangha, Rana Kumba, Rana Pratap, and more against the Mughals

INTRODUCTION

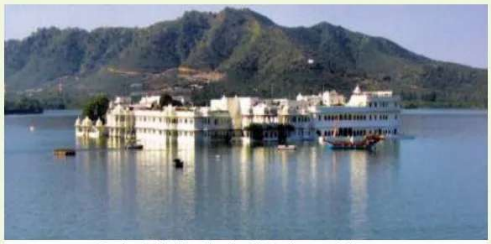
The aggression on Bharat's honour and resources by the invaders was met head-on by many brave warriors. The valorous and heroic Rajputs were one of the most effective and accomplished fighting forces that protected the country from invaders. The fountain of their strength can be traced to their spiritual foundation, the Shakti peeth* of Arbuda Devi in present day Mount Abu. While there are many ancestry lines of Rajputs, they majorly belong to the Ajmeris, Marwaris or Mewaris. The Rajputs of Ajmer and Jaipur were known as Ajmeris. The Marwaris hailed from the Yodhapura (present day Jodhpur) area. The Mewaris descended from the Sisodias. Towards the end of the rule of Alauddin Khalji (1316 CE), many of the independent kingdoms had been absorbed into the Sultanate. However, other Rajput families re-established their kingdoms. Their origins can be traced back to the Pratiharas, Chandelas and Paramaras. In this lesson, we learn about them in detail.

GROWTH OF MEWAR AFTER RANA HAMMIR

After Rana Hammir's death, his son **Kshetrasimha** ascended the throne and ruled for more than 25 years (1378 - 1405 CE). The weakening of Delhi Sultanate after the death of Sultan Firuz Shah Tughluq in 1388 CE allowed Mewar to focus on development the state and its subjects. Kshetrasimha's eldest son Lakshasimha or Laakha succeeded to the throne of Mewar in 1405 CE and ruled for 15 years.

There was boom in trade in the region during this time. Advanced system of weights and measures handled currency. International traders came to the region - one of the traders constructed the artificial lake near Udaipur known today as the Pichhola lake. This strong economic foundation funded Mewar's war campaigns in the 15th & 16th centuries and created great monuments. When the Sultan of Jaunpur imposed

Shakti peeth : A significant place of worship and pilgrimage of Goddess Shakti


Lake Pichhola in Udaipur, Bharat

taxes on pilgrims traveling to sacred places like Gaya, Benares and Prayaag, Laakha sponsored and supported the pilgrims.

Laakha married Hamsabai, daughter of Chunda who was the leader of Marwar state thereby enabling alliance between Sisodias of Mewar and Rathores of Marwar. **Ranamalla** (brother of Hamsabai) joined the court of Laakha and aided him in the activities of the state.

Ranamalla subsequently served as regent* to **Mokal**, son of Laakha in 1420 CE. Later, in 1433 CE, Mokal was killed during a battle against the Sultan of Gujarat. Ranamalla gathered the Rathore army of Marwar, marched to Mewar, expelled Mokal's assassin from Chittor and seated Mokal's son **Kumbha** on the throne. Rana Kumbha was a minor* when he became a king.

This alliance of Mewar and Marwar lasted for 25 years until the assassination of Ranamalla via a conspiracy of a few who didn't want Rathores' control on Sisodias of Mewar.

It's often the internal frictions leading to lack of unity that eventually make a society ripe for external aggressions.

Mewar Region

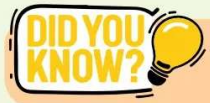
Marwar Region

RENAISSANCE UNDER RANA KUMBHA

Rana Kumbha

Rana Kumbha, one of the greatest rulers of medieval Bharat, was born in the Sisodia clan and ruled Mewar between 1433 and 1468 AD.

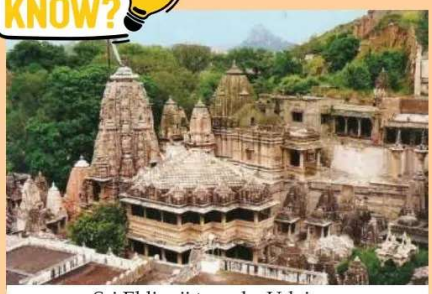
Post the death of Ranamalla, Rana Kumbha was engaged in wars for 7 years with the Rathores on the western front and Mahmud Khalji (Sultan of Malwa) on the southern front. Despite successive efforts by Khalji with the combined army of Malwa and Gujarat, Chittor could not be captured. Traumatized* by these defeats, Khalji didn't attack Mewar for another 10 years since 1446 CE. To commemorate this victory, Rana Kumbha erected the '**Vijay Sthamba**', a 37 m tall monument at Chittorgarh in 1448 AD. A period of peace followed during which Rana Kumbha constructed many temples, buildings and forts.



Rana Kumbha fought 56 wars and remained undefeated in every single one of them.

Regent : Minister/governor **Minor :** Under the age of 10 **Traumatized :** Deeply afraid

DID YOU KNOW?



Sri Eklingji temple, Udaipur

Eklingji (form of Lord Shiva) is considered the ruler of Mewar, and the kings ruled as his representatives. This temple of Eklingji in Udaipur was installed by Bappa Rawal in the 8th century. Despite repeated raids by the invaders and destruction of the original murthi, the Rajput rulers continued to reinstate the Murthi* as it was a symbol of hope and strength. The temple was rebuilt by Hamir Singh in the 14th century and Rana Kumbha in the 15th century. They called themselves the servants of Eklingji. In the 15th century the Malwa Sultanate ruler Ghiyath Shah ransacked the temple. Rana Raimal, son of Rana Kumbha, captured him, demanded a ransom for his release, and rebuilt the temple of the land with that ransom.

CAPTURE OF NAGAUR

After the death of ruler of Nagaur Firuz Khan in 1453-1454, his son Shams Khan sought the help of Rana Kumbha to dethrone his uncle and promised to dismantle fortifications of Nagaur in return. After capturing the throne, Shams Khan went back on his word and sought the help of the Sultan of Gujarat, Qutbuddin. Rana Kumbha waged war against Shams Khan and the Gujarat army, inflicted a crushing defeat and captured Nagaur.

BATTLE OF NAGAUR	
When?	1455 CE
Where?	Nagaur, Rajasthan
Who were the combatants?	
Sisodias of Mewar	Nagaur & Gujarat Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Kumbha	Qutbuddin Shams Khan
Outcome : Crushing defeat of Sultanate. Decisive victory of Sisodia empire	
SIGNIFICANCE : Rana Kumbha gained the treasury of the combined opponents	

TREATY OF CHAMPANER AND MEWAR'S RESISTANCE

After suffering defeat at Nagaur, Qutbuddin led another campaign against Mewar in 1455-56 but Rana Kumbha crushed it yet again. Qutbuddin signed a treaty with Sultan Mahmud Khalji of Malwa at Champaner to attack Mewar and divide the spoils among them. All the towns nearby Gujarat were to be attached to the kingdom of Qutbuddin, while the districts of Mewar and Ahiwara should be retained by the Malwa forces.

The Rathore leader Jodha (son of Ranamalla) was hoping he would become the next ruler of Mewar. But Ranamalla helped Kumbha ascend the throne. Hence Jodha sought revenge against Mewar by siding with Gujarat (the enemy camp). However, Rana Kumbha successfully defended Mewar against the multi-directional attack that lasted for 2 years.

Death of Qutbuddin in 1458 and subsequent hostilities between Malwa and Gujarat, brought the most difficult period of Rana Kumbha's life to an end.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

What does it take for a leader to defend the country when it is attacked from all sides simultaneously? What role should you play as a citizen of the country that is in the miseries of war?

Murthi : Main deity of the temple

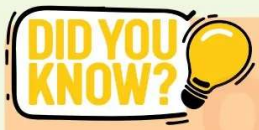
MULTI-FACETED RANA KUMBHA

Despite a large part of his reign was spent in warfare, Rana Kumbha devoted time for the cultivation of arts and literature. Eklingamahatmya, a contemporary work in Sanskrit extolls Rana Kumbha for his proficiency in Vedas, Smritis, Mimamsa, Upanishads, Natya Shastra (Drama), Rajaniti (Politics), Ganita (Mathematics), Vyakarana (Grammar) and Tarka (Logic). He wrote Rasikapriya, a commentary on Jayadeva's Gita Govinda and Chandisatakam. Rana Kumbha also wrote four dramas in different provincial languages.

Kumbha Shyam temple, Chittorgarh

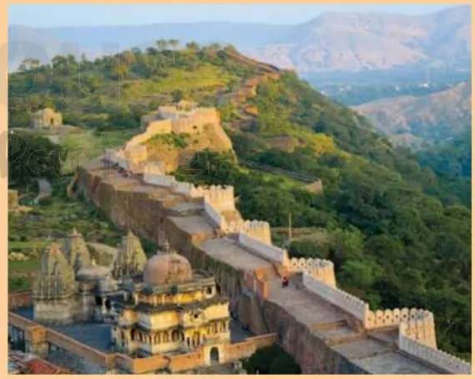
Chittorgarh Fort

Rana Kumbha took keen interest in music. His proficiency can be gauged from his three works on science of music called Sangitaraga, Sangitamimamsa, and Suraprabandha. He built several temples, notable among them being the Kumbha Swamyi and Adivaraha temple. He rebuilt the temple of Eklingji (Shiva) which was partially destroyed. For the purpose of strengthening the defense of his kingdom, Rana Kumbha built several forts like Achalgarh, Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh and many more.



Of the 84 fortresses that form the defense of Mewar, 32 were built by Rana Kumbha including the highest fort and most formidable citadel, Kumbhalgarh fort.

Kumbhalgarh fort is 3600 ft tall and a whopping 38 km wide. This citadel located in the western Aravalli hills has the second longest wall after the Great Wall of China.



His exploits on the battleground are peerless. Rana Kumbha was one of the greatest warriors this land has produced who stood for his people, for Dharma and became a symbol of Hindu resistance.

RANA RAYAMALLA'S REIGN

Rana Kumbha suffered a tragic death. He was killed by his eldest son Udaya who was in a hurry to occupy the throne. Even after ascending the throne, Udaya didn't get the approval of the Rajput nobility and was soon dethroned. His younger brother Rayamalla became king.

CHALLENGES

Rana Rayamalla ruled Mewar for 36 years (1473-1509 CE). His immediate challenge was to restore order in the state that was left in chaos under the brief rule of Udaya. Rayamalla's first challenge came from Kshema,

Rana Kumbha's younger brother, who was a lifelong enemy of the latter. Kshema saw an opportunity to assert himself and an intense battle took place at Dadimpur. Kshema was killed and Rayamalla won. Rana Rayamalla's next challenge was the conflict with Malwa. Ghiyasuddin Khalji, son of Mahmud Khalj, advanced to Chittor with his army where a bloody battle took place. The Sultan was defeated and had to retreat. The sultan of Malwa returned to attack Mewar under Zafar Khan. The Rajput army subsequently invaded Malwa. Rayamalla also successfully suppressed the rebellion that arose among the aboriginal tribes.

FIGHT FOR THE THRONE

Rayamalla had 13 sons, the first three in order of seniority being Prithviraj, Jayamalla and Sanga. The three brothers accompanied by their paternal uncle went to a woman named Biri Bai who was revered as Mother Goddess. They asked her as to who will succeed Rayamalla to the throne of Mewar. Biri Bai declared that Sangha would become the King. Enraged, Prithviraj and Jayamalla tried to kill Sangha. Sangha lost his eye but was saved by Surajmalla. Both escaped the kingdom and eventually settled near Ajmer.

Prithviraj became the heir to the throne and handled the administration of the kingdom. He was a gallant prince who fought several battles for Mewar. Unfortunately, towards the end of Rayamalla's reign, the king lost both Prithviraj and Jayamalla. Prithviraj was poisoned by his brother-in-law and Jayamalla died in a battle with a Rajput king. Amidst the gloom, news of Sangha being alive reached Rayamalla's years. Sangha came back to Mewar and ascended the throne in 1509 CE. Rayamalla died soon after.

RANA SANGHA

In 1509 CE, Sangha became the ruler of Mewar. A major part of his youth before becoming the king was spent in anonymity near Ajmer following the feud with Prithviraj. Despite leading a reclusive life, he transformed into one of the most ambitious and aggressive warrior kings to have ruled Mewar.

Rana Sangha

RELATIONSHIP WITH MALWA

When Mahmud Khalji succeeded to the throne, he sought help from Gujarat Sultanate to attack Mandu, capital of Malwa. The Rajput chieftain who was double-crossed by Khalji turned to Rana Sangha for help. By then Mandu was already captured. The Sultan of Gujarat left a part of his army with Mahmud Khalji in Mandu.

Now, Mahmud Khalji wanted to attack the district of Gagraon in 1519 with all his might but he was defeated comprehensively by Rana Sangha. The Sultan himself was captured alive. He was released after 6 months only on the condition that he paid a compensation amount, surrendered the golden heirloom ornaments looted from the Malwas and sent his son as a goodwill ambassador between Malwa and Mewar. In return Rana Sangha let Mahmud Khalji rule over parts of Malwa which belonged to him before the war began. Thus, Rana Sangha put to rest all hostilities with Malwa for the near future.

BATTLE OF GAGRAON	
When? 1519 CE	
Where? Gagraon, Rajasthan	
Who were the combatants?	
Sisodias of Mewar	Malwa, Gujarat Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Sangha	Mahmud Khalji
Outcome : Decisive victory for Sisodias	
SIGNIFICANCE : Malwa hostilities resolved	

CLASH BETWEEN MEWAR AND GUJARAT

The Kingdom of Sirohi was in turmoil with two cousins fighting to ascend to the throne. While one of them moved to Rana Sangha's camp by marrying his daughter, the other sought help from the Sultan of Gujarat, thus making Mewar and Gujarat rivals.

Rana Sangha was not only an ace military commander but also a diplomatic leader. Malik Ayaz led the Gujarat army to attack Mewar in 1521. After ransacking many places enroute, the Gujarat army reached the southern frontier of Mewar. Mahmud Khalji of Malwa also joined the Gujarat army.

Rana Sangha appeased the Sultan of Gujarat with gifts and made truce. He cut a deal with Mahmud Khalji by promising to release his son, who had been in his Darbar since 1519. He aggravated the internal politics within Malik Ayaz's regiment to turn them against each other. Thus Rana Sangha won the battle even without having to fight it.

RANA SANGHA DEFEATS IBRAHIM LODI

Rana Sangha shifted his focus to Delhi. In 1517, Ibrahim Lodi became the Sultan of Delhi. It took him 3 years to quell internal rebellions and take control of Delhi. When Sangha and Lodi clashed for the first time in 1517, the Mewar army proved to be too strong for Lodi's army. Rana Sangha was severely injured. He lost an arm to a sword cut while an arrow pierced his leg making him lame for life. Yet it was Mewar's victory.

Ibrahim Lodi again gathered a large army and attacked Mewar. He appointed 3 of his best generals to lead the attack. Lodi doubted one of his generals Husain Khan because of an earlier rebellion and ordered for his arrest. Husain quickly jumped to Rana Sangha's camp, along with a few hundred horsemen. The Rajput army marched forth and confronted the enemy at Dholpur and defeated them decisively. Husain Khan and his contingent however did not participate in this battle. He back-stabbed the Rajputs too. He captured a few war elephants and horses, and escaped. He presented them to Lodi and got accepted back into his fold.

BATTLE OF KHATOLI	
When?	1518 CE
Where?	Khatoli, Rajasthan
Who were the combatants?	
Sisodias of Mewar	Lodi Empire
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Sangha	Ibrahim Lodi
Outcome : Decisive victory for Sisodias	
SIGNIFICANCE : Mewar becomes very powerful in northern Bharat. Lodi fears Sangha.	

The defeat of Ibrahim Lodi was one of the greatest achievements of Rana Sangha. Mewar's boundaries extended till the Bayana river in the north, Raisen in the east, Dungarpur and Banswara in the south. Under Rana Sangha, Mewar became one of the most powerful kingdoms in Northern Bharat. After defeating Ibrahim Lodi, Rana Sangha became a threat to Delhi.

BABUR ESTABLISHES MUGHAL EMPIRE

Arrogance of Ibrahim Lodi and weakening of Delhi Sultanate under him, made him fall out of favor of the Delhi nobility. Ibrahim's uncle Daulat Khan Lodi invited Zahiruddin Babur, Timurid ruler of Kabul to invade Bharat and help get rid of Ibrahim Lodi. Babur readily agreed, but he had other intentions. Unlike previous Mongol invaders who plundered and left the country, Babur harbored a desire to dislodge the Delhi Sultanate and occupy the seat himself.

THE FIRST BATTLE OF PANIPAT, 1526 CE

Babur marched towards Punjab in 1525 CE and occupied Lahore and set up a garrison there. He returned to Kabul to gather reinforcements and returned to lock horns with Ibrahim Lodi who was ready with his army at Panipat in April, 1526 CE. Babur obtained a decisive victory against Lodi and that marked the beginning of the Mughal Empire in Bharat.

FIRST BATTLE OF PANIPAT	
When?	April 1526 CE
Where?	Panipat, Haryana
Who were the combatants?	
Timurids	Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Zahiruddin Babur	Ibrahim Lodi
Outcome : Loss of Delhi Sultanate.	
SIGNIFICANCE : Timurids establish the Timurid dynasty more widely known as Mughal dynasty in Delhi	

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BATTLE OF KHANWA

After the battle of Panipat and the fall of Delhi Sultanate, it was clear that Babur meant to stay in Bharat. Rana Sangha's imperial objectives demanded Babur's fledgling Mughal Empire be crushed. The Mewar confederacy included several Rajput Kings of Rajasthan including those of Sirohi, Dungarpur, Chanderi and Dhundhar. Even the Sultan of Gujarat Bahadur joined Rana Sangha's camp in return for the latter's help in securing the throne of Gujarat.

BATTLE OF KHANWA	
When?	March 1527 CE
Where?	Khanwa, Bharatpur, Rajasthan
Who were the combatants?	
Rajput confederacy	Timurids
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Sangha	Babur
Outcome : Losses suffered on both sides	
SIGNIFICANCE : The introduction of gunpowder and firearms changes the way wars are fought in Bharat.	

On 16 March, 1527 the Rajput army clashed with the entrenched positions of Babur near the village of Khanwa. As Babur notes in Baburnama, the Rajput army numbered around 2 lakh soldiers as compared to 15,000 men in Babur's army. Both sides fought an intense battle with reversing fortunes. Rana Sangha got injured and fell unconscious, quickly taken away from the battlefield by his fellowmen. The Mewar army nevertheless kept fighting. In this battle Mewar lost the best of her sons, but not without inflicting heavy losses on Babur's army.

Both contemporary Rajasthani songs and Muslim records mention that Rana Sangha was preparing for another confrontation with Babur, but he was poisoned by his own noblemen who probably didn't want to fight for a lost cause against Babur and his artillery. Rana Sangha died on 30 January, 1528.

WHAT WENT AGAINST MEWAR

TECHNOLOGY

While the Rajputs relied heavily on their cavalry, especially the war elephants, Babur's army possessed the next generation of weapons technology in the form of cannons and matchlocks. The marauding elephants of the Rajput army were rendered useless against the artillery firepower. Alarmed by the sound of the cannons the elephants retreated, ending up trampling over their own army. The use of gunpowder marked the end of the age of elephants as a weapon in Bharat's warfare.

Officer of Mughal Army with large matchlock

UNITY OF PURPOSE

Babur's army were spurred into action by a common goal, determined to go to any length to execute Babur's orders. On the other side, the Rajput army was huge but lacked solidarity. The Rajput forces were assembled from various alliance partners including Afghans who wanted to restore the Lodi empire. So there was no unity of purpose within the Mewar confederacy that took on Babur.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Is it important for an individual or society or a country to have a unity of purpose, a shared ideal/goal? What are its pros and cons?

LEGACY OF RANA SANGHA

Rana Sangha fought in the battle of Khanwa with one eye, one arm and a limping foot, not to mention dozens of wounds on his body. It's testament to the grandeur of his personality, charisma and valor that despite his handicaps he inspired confidence in the thousands of soldiers to go to war alongside him. Rana Sangha created one of the largest Hindu Kingdom of medieval Bharat, succeeded in uniting the numerous Rajput clans and defeated the Delhi Sultanate.

MEWAR'S PERIOD OF STRUGGLE

The death of Rana Sangha and the subsequent weak leadership and hostility over succession had made Mewar vulnerable to invasion. Mewar, the last bastion of Hindu power in North Bharat was facing existential crisis. Between 1528 CE and 1572 CE Mewar was ruled by Ratna Singh, Vikramaditya, Vanavir and Uday Singh. Mewar kept losing to the forces of the sultan of Gujarat and the Mughals. Chittor was constantly ravaged. It was only in the time of Uday Singh that a second capital was established to reduce the dependence on Chittor. This was the city of Udaipur.

DEVELOPMENTS AFTER RANA SANGHA

AN IMPORTANT ADMINISTRATOR AND RULER - RAJA HEMACHANDRA VIKRAMADITYA

Raja Hemachandra Vikramaditya

There are many accounts of the early years of **Raja Hemachandra** or Raja Hemu as he was popularly known. Hemu's early years were spent in Alwar, Rajasthan where he mastered many languages, the art of war and developed a keen sense for trade. Humayun, the Mughal ruler in Delhi was defeated by Shershah Suri in 1540 CE and driven out of Delhi. Shershah's son Islam Shah took over the throne in 1545 CE at which time Hemu was noticed by Islam Shah for his keen sense of administration and fighting. Being very hard-working and loyal, Hemu quickly rose up the ranks. When Adil Shah Suri took over the throne of Delhi in 1553 CE, Hemu was appointed as Chief Minister and he was the power behind the administration of the Delhi sultanate. Hemu was undefeated in more than 22 battles.

In 1555 CE, Adil Shah was displaced from the throne and the sultanate broke up. Humayun recaptured Delhi and Agra, while Hemu achieved triumph in Bengal. Following Humayun's demise in 1556 CE and Akbar's ascension to the Delhi throne, Hemu rapidly advanced towards Delhi, seizing numerous Mughal-controlled territories along the way. On October 7, 1556 CE, Hemu conquered Delhi, assuming the title of Vikramaditya and earning the name Raja Hemachandra Vikramaditya. This marked a pivotal event where a Hindu ruler assumed control of Delhi, displacing foreign dominion.

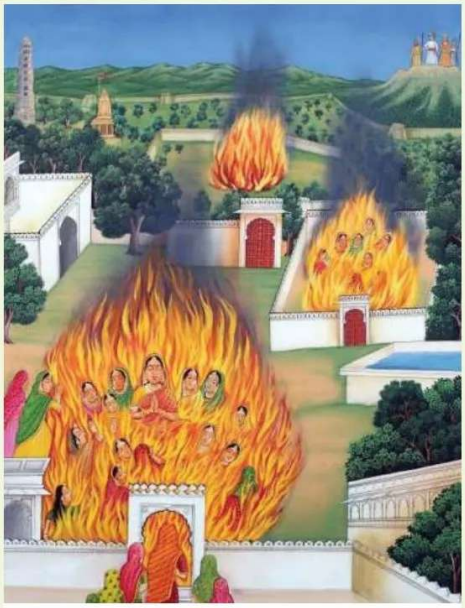
Raja Hemu promptly formulated a plan for administrative enhancement. One month later, Akbar and his armies attacked Delhi, culminating in the second Battle of Panipat on November 5, 1556 CE. Initially securing an advantage, During the battle, a stray arrow blinded Raja Hemu. Despite fighting valiantly, the king fell unconscious and died. The loss of their leader disheartened his army, ultimately concluding the battle. Raja Hemu demonstrated exceptional ambition and bravery, successfully overcoming the foreign rulers who had governed for over a century.

AKBAR'S BRUTAL ASSAULT ON CHITTOR

FANATIC AGGRESSION - 1	
Aggressor	Jalaluddin Akbar
Place / Year	Chittorgarh, Rajasthan / 1567 CE
Defender	Rao Jaimal Rathore, commander of Mewar army
Result of Aggression	About 10,000 soldiers and 30,000 civilians slaughtered 100s of women commit Jauhar

Around this time, a change of guard took place in the Mughal empire. Jalaluddin Akbar ascended the throne in 1556 CE succeeding Humayun. Raja Bharmal of Amber entered an alliance with Akbar by giving his daughter in marriage to Akbar. Thereafter, Raja Bharmal's son and notably his grandson, Maan Singh, joined Akbar's court.

One of the important policy under Akbar was the abolishment of the pilgrim tax in 1563 CE and jizya (a tax paid by non-Muslim subjects to the Muslim rulers) in 1564. This gave relief to the Hindus under his rule, and also won him friendship of Hindu chiefs of Rajasthan. All of this did not make Akbar drop his desire of annexing Rajasthan into the Mughal Empire.



The jauhar of Rajput women at Chittorgarh

Akbar embarked on his Mewar campaign in 1567 CE. On receiving the news of the incoming invasion, Uday Singh summoned the war council. It was clear that the Rajput army, still recovering from the Gujarat wars, could not resist the Mughal army. The king was advised to take refuge in the hills along with the princes, while a contingent commanded by Jaimal Rathore will stay back in Chittor to face Akbar's army. Uday Singh agreed and left for the hills leaving behind 8000 soldiers with Jaimal to guard Chittor.

The army led by Jaimal fought valiantly against Akbar's assault that lasted several weeks. On 23 Feb 1568 CE Akbar was finally successful in breaching the walls of the fort with the help of mines and artillery siege cannons. Jaimal also died in the process that signaled doom to the Rajput defenders. Women and children committed jauhar inside the fort, flames of which were seen by Akbar looking from outside the fort. On 25th Feb, 1568 the Rajput men opened the gates and launched a final assault on Akbar's army and embraced a valorous death with sword in hand. The Mughal soldiers then went on to slaughter 30,000 non-combatants, inhabitants and peasants as ordered by Akbar himself. (as referred to in the Tabaqat-e-Akbari of Nizamudin Bakshi and Akbarnama).

BROKEN MEWAR CONFEDERACY

A year later in 1569 Ranthambore fell into Akbar's hands, and in 1570 Bikaner and Jaisalmer entered into an alliance with Akbar. Uday Singh survived for 4 more years, living in Kumbhalmer. Till the end he refused to surrender to the Mughals unlike other Rajput chieftains who sent their daughters to the Mughal harem. He died on 28 Feb, 1572.

Thus after the Battle of Khanwa, the united confederacy that spanned across Rajasthan was broken. The descendants of the great Rana Kumbha and Rana Sangha will now have to struggle not only against the Mughals but also against the Rajputs to restore the honor of Mewar. In the words of Akbar's courtier Badauni - "a Hindu would wield the sword of Islam". It is under these circumstances that another prodigal son of Mewar, Pratap Singh started his journey.

RANI DURGAVATI

Rani Durgavati took the responsibility of ruling the Gond dynasty and resisting the advances of Akbar and his armies. Born in the Chandela Rajput dynasty to Raja Keerat Rai, she was married into the Gond dynasty. On the loss of her husband Dalpat Shah, she put her infant son on the throne and ruled the kingdom as regent. The Gondwana kingdom stretched over 23,000 villages. A superb administrator and brave warrior, she effectively protected her people from the hostile neighbouring kingdom that was under the Sultan of Malwa and later under Akbar. Their advances were countered by Rani Durgavati. In June 1564, Akbar's armies attacked Gondwana again with a very large force. Rani Durgavati led the battle from the front over several days and lost her life in the battlefield.

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RESURGENCE OF MEWAR UNDER MAHARANA PRATAP

MEWAR PREPARES FOR WAR UNDER MAHARANA PRATAP

Maharana Pratap Singh (1540 -1597)

Maharana Pratap Singh took over the reign of Mewar on 1 March 1572 CE. Maharana inherited a wounded empire still recovering from the loss of Chittor to Akbar. Maharana Pratap set out on his plan to fortify Mewar. He vowed to shun all luxury and comfort until Chittor is reclaimed. He made Kumbhalgarh as the state capital and strengthened it. The trade routes that passed through Mewar to the port at Surat were monitored and all Mughal caravans were intercepted and looted.

Maharana also received support from his friends in the Rathore household. Bhaama Shah donated his enormous wealth for the cause of Mewar enabling Maharana to fight the wars that he did. He also received support from Afghan leader Hakim sur Pathan, who was the descendent of Shershah Suri and had an axe to grind with the Mughals. He would die fighting alongside the Rajputs against the Mughal army in the battle of Haldighati.

Most severe of Maharana's policies was to abolish cultivation of land forcing many people to relocate to the Aravali hills. Objective of such a harsh measure was to deny any local food supplies to the Mughal army, thus forcing the Mughals to carry their own supplies when they attacked Mewar. Also the mass slaughter of the common populace by the Turks was now not possible. Movement of population to hills brought them in contact with the mountain dwelling "Bhil" tribe who welcomed them with open arms. Maharana Pratap, his family, the army and the entire population survived several years living on the fruits of the jungles with the help of Bhils. Maharana Pratap reciprocated the warmth of the Bhils by inducting them into his Army to fight as equal partners.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Which country and its populace will abide by a diktat that takes away their livelihood and forces them to migrate? Will it not result in civil war? How grave the situation must have been, how extraordinary a leader Maharana Pratap would have been to convince his subjects to endure this suffering for the cause of Mewar. Discuss

BATTLE OF HALDIGHATI

Maharana Pratap's armour displayed at Udaipur museum

Tension was building up between Akbar and the King of Mewar as multiple diplomatic advances made by Akbar were rendered futile. Maharana refused to bow down to the Mughal throne, and declared Mewar's independence. Failure of diplomatic missions forced Akbar's hand and he ordered an attack on Mewar and assigned Maan Singh as the commanding general of the army.

The battle of Haldighati was fought on 21 June 1576 CE near Gogunda. Maharana who had made Gogunda his temporary capital, had already taken position on the narrow mountain pass (ghati) while Maan Singh had arranged his army in battle formation in the plain below. While the exact numbers on either side are contested, it's clear that the Mewar army was outnumbered.
Maharana Pratap marched with his army in the morning of 21 June, and launched

DID YOU KNOW?

The total weight of Maharana Pratap's armour and weapons was 35 kgs

an attack on the Mughal army. Aware of the large army of the Mughals, Maharana Pratap decided to attack with speed and penetrate the Mughal defenses and end the battle quickly. The vanguard of the Mughal army was blown away by the initial assault by the Rajputs.

But the Rajput rampage was stopped by Maan Singh holding fort at the center of his army. Maharana Pratap rode on his famous steed, Chetak and confronted Maan Singh, who rode an elephant. Maharana threw his javelin at Maan Singh who ducked under it. Meanwhile, Chetak, who was as fearless as his master, placed its forelegs on the elephant and got wounded by the sword tied to the elephant's trunk. Jhala Maan, one of the warriors in the army who bore close resemblance to Maharana, sensed that his King was in danger. He advised Maharana, who was also severely injured by then, to leave the battlefield. Jhala Maan wore Maharana's crown and the Mughal army attacked him mistaking him for Maharana Pratap. A wounded Chetak carried Maharana out of the battlefield and breathed its last only after ensuring his master was out of danger.

Chetak leaping and planting its front legs on the Maan Singh's elephant

Model of Maharana Pratap's horse, Chetak attached with elephant trunk

The Mewar army soon retreated from the battlefield as soon as Maharana had reached safety. Maan Singh desisted from pursuing the army for fear of ambush in the hills. Next day, when the Mughal Army took over Gogunda, the town was empty, with no provisions in store. The Mughal army had to survive on meat and fruits for days. Akbar was disappointed with the result of the battle. He even removed Maan Singh from his court briefly for failing to annihilate the Maharana.

The battle of Haldighati ended in stalemate with neither side achieving its objectives. The battle lasted for a few hours only but was extremely intense. The place came to be known as "Rakht Talai" or the lake of blood, giving a glimpse of the many warriors who died that day.

BATTLE OF HALDIGHATI	
When? June 1576 CE	
Where? Gogunda, Udaipur	
Who were the combatants?	
Mewar Rajputs	Mughals
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Pratap	Akbar, Maan Singh
Outcome : No winner emerges.	
SIGNIFICANCE : Mughals severely routed and a disappointed Akbar removes Maan Singh from his court. Mewar retains its independence.	

BATTLE OF DEWAIR AND THE TRIUMPH OF MAHARANA PRATAP

What followed the battle of Haldighati was Akbar sending his army again and again under different commanders to wrest Mewar from Maharana but with little success. Gogunda was recaptured by Maharana. In September, 1583 the decisive battle of Dewair was fought between the Rajput forces and the Mughal garrison led by Shahbaz Khan. The Mughal army was decimated at Dewair. Maharana pursued the retreating army to Amet and captured the garrison there. Subsequently, Kumbhalemer was captured, 84 garrisons and 36 Mughal outposts were run over by the Rajput army. Mughals had already fled from Udaipur by then.

By 1586, Maharana had captured all of Mewar except Ajmer, Chittor and Mandalgarh. Akbar did not attack Mewar thereafter till the end of his reign. The most powerful ruler of the time gave up on his dream to destroy Maharana Pratap and annex Mewar.

Maharana Pratap died in January 1597 after getting wounded while hunting. Thus ended the life of the greatest hero of medieval Bharat. The consolidation of Mewar during this period, the accumulation of resources and wealth, helped the coming generations under Amar Singh and Raj Singh to fight and defeat Jehangir and Aurangzeb respectively.

BATTLE OF DEWAIR	
When?	September 1583 CE
Where?	Dewair, Mewar
Who were the combatants?	
Rajputs	Mughals
Who were the commanders?	
Rana Pratap	Akbar,Shahbaz Khan
Outcome : Thumping victory of Rajputs	
SIGNIFICANCE : 36,000 Mughal soldiers surrender. 30 Mughal camps destroyed. Mewar retained its independence	

THINK!!!

Have a look at the map. Akbar, with his massive and vast Mughal Empire (shown in green) could not subjugate Maharana Pratap's tiny Mewar (shown in red). For more than 14 years, Maharana Pratap remained unconquered

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CONCLUSION:

Looking back we may think that the Rajputs were involved in a lot of infighting. There are also many instances where their misplaced sense of self-respect led to them giving up their lives and losing ground to adharmic invaders. The Rajputs placed great importance on thseir promises even if the conditions under which such promises were made had greatly changed. This was exploited by their enemies who followed no ethics in the wars.

The Rajputs definitely were extraordinary warriors who offered great resistance to the Islamic invaders and preserved the culture of Bharat. The stellar women of the Rajput dynasties were selfless in their bravery and sacrifices that serve to further the might of the Rajputs and their contributions to Bharat.

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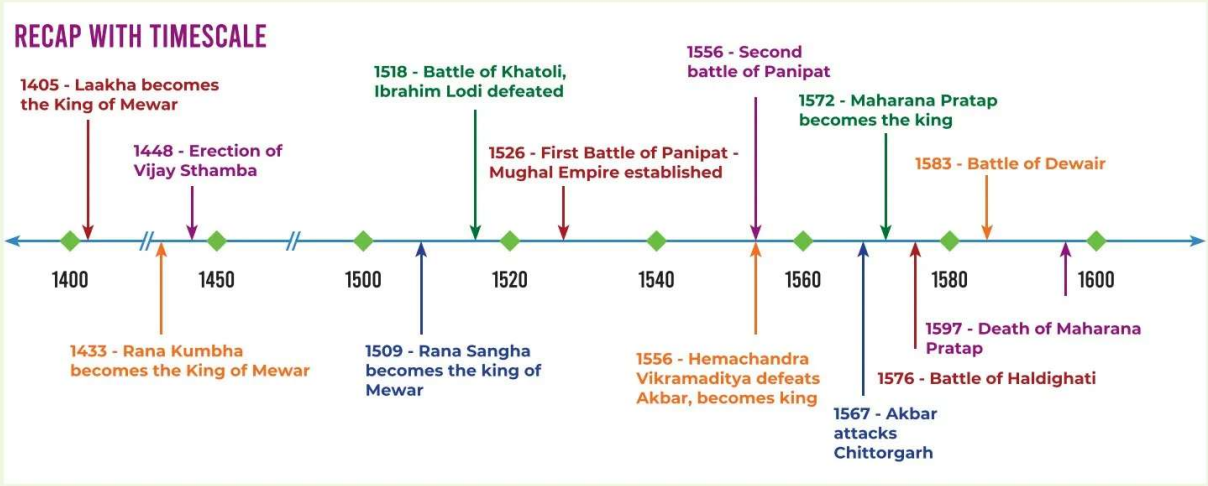
KEYWORDS

- Mewar, Marwar
- Rana Sangha
- Rana Kumba
- Raja Hemu
- Sisodias
- Vijay Sthamba
- Battle of Nagaur
- Kumbhalgarh fort
- Mahmud Khalji
- Ibrahim Lodi
- Babur
- First Battle of Panipat
- Khanwa
- Chittorgarh
- Jauhar
- Rani Durgavati
- Rana Pratap, Chetak
- Haldighati
- Dewair

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Many Rajputs of the 14th century trace their origins back to the following dynasties.
   a) Pratiharas b) Chandelas c) Paramaras d) All of the above
2. Traders constructed an artificial lake near Udaipur called the _____ lake.
   a) Pushkar b) Pichhola c) Man Sagar d) Dhebar
3. True or False
   Statement A: Raja Lakshasimha married Hamsabai of the Marwar dynasty.
   Statement B: Raja Lakshasimha actively supported HIndu pilgrims who were troubled by the Jaunpur rulers.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
4. Rana Kumbha erected the _____, a 37 meter tall monument at Chittorgarh in 1448 CE.
   a) Kirthi sthamba b) Soch sthamba c) Vijay sthamba d) Nirman sthamba
5. The kings of Mewar ruled as representatives of _____.
   a) Rajputs b) Sisodias c) Eklingji d) Paramaras
6. Maharana Pratap vowed to shun all luxuries and comfort until _____ was reclaimed.
   a) Bhilwara b) Jhalawar c) Pratapgarh d) Chittorgarh
7. The Kumbhalgarh fort's citadel located in the Western _____ hills has the second longest wall after the Great wall of China.
   a) Aravalli b) Nilgiri c) Vindhya d) Satpura

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. a) Rana Sangha becomes ruler of Mewar b) Battle of Khanwa
   c) Battle of Nagaur d) Fall of Delhi sultanate
2. a) Ibrahim Lodi attacks Mewar b) Rayamalla becomes ruler of Mewar
   c) Death of Qutbuddin d) Battle of Dewair

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. What were Rana Kumbha's contributions to art, literature and religion?
2. Discuss briefly about Rana Sangha's role as a diplomat.

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3. Describe about one ruler of the Gonds.
4. What was the contribution of Jhala Maan to Mewar?
5. Gogunda in Udaipur is known for an important historic event in Mewar's history. What is the event?
6. Under what conditions was Mahmud Khalji released by Rana Sanga?
7. Write a short note about the first battle of Panipat.
8. What was the role of Ranamalla in the life of Rana Kumbha?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. What were the reasons that helped Babur win over the Mewar rulers? Discuss.
2. How did Raja Hemachandra become the ruler of Delhi? Why was he known to be a wise ruler and administrator?
3. Why was the battle of Chittorgarh an act of fanatic aggression?
4. What was the impact of the abolition of agricultural activity in Mewar by Maharana Pratap?
5. The battle of Dewair was very significant in the fight between the Rajputs and Mughals. Why?
6. A lack of unity leads to external aggressions. Explain this statement in the context of Mewar and Mrwar.

CASE STUDY

"The descendants of the great Rana Kumbha and Rana Sangha will now have to struggle not only against the Mughals but also against the Rajputs to restore the honour of Mewar. In the words of Akbar's courtier Badauni - "a Hindu would wield the sword of Islam". It is under these circumstances that another prodigal son of Mewar, Pratap Singh started his journey."

1. What are the reasons for the struggle of Rana Kumbha's descendants?
2. Discuss the major event that led to a state of disunity among the Rajputs.

MAP ACTIVITY:

Mark the places on an outline map of Bharat:

• Udaipur • Sirohi • Gujarat • Marwar • Mewar • Chittorgarh

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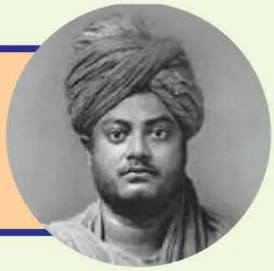
Chapter 7

THE MIGHTY MARATHAS

As forest-fire is to the forest trees, a leopard to the deer-herds and a lion to the stately elephants; as the sun is to the darkness of the night, as Krishna was to Kansa, so was king Shivaji, a lion, towards the hordes of Mlechchas.

- Swami Vivekananda



LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Explain the context in which the Marathas rose to become a significant power in Bharat
- Assess the political, governance and security systems of the Marathas
- Indicate the impact of great saints on the Maratha empire
- Discuss the charisma and acumen of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj - one of the greatest rulers of Bharat

INTRODUCTION

The early part of the history of the Marathas can be traced to the Bhonsales starting with Maloji, Shahaji and the most popular Shivaji. The Bhonsales descended from the Sisodia Ranas of Chittor and Udaipur. The Marathas were simple, straightforward, courageous and self-reliant people. They fought against the oppressive Mughal and Deccan rulers. Skilled in guerilla warfare, and great possessing love for their motherland made the Marathas scale great heights.

The Marathas were inspired by religious and social leaders like Eknathji, Guru Samartha Ramdas and Sant Tukaram. The torch bearer of the Marathas was the brave and brilliant Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, one of the greatest leaders that Bharat has seen. Born during peak of Mughal aggression he fought against them and established Hindavi Swarajya, an independent and self-ruled mighty Maratha empire. When the name of Shivaji is uttered, it evokes courage and honour in the people of Bharat even today.

SCENARIO IN BHARAT

In 1627 CE most parts of Bharat were invaded by the Mughals. As the invaders brought in new rules to suit them, tens of thousands of natives were displaced from their ancestral homes, religious conversions were forced on people, temples and monuments of faith were looted and disfigured.

Shah Jahan took over as the emperor of the Mughal empire post Jahangir. He ruled the Deccan region through Sultan Adil Shah at Bijapur and Sultan Qutb Shah at Golconda. The Mughals preferred their officers to be Muslims. However sending such officers to the Deccan provinces was a challenge. The land routes were filled with their enemies and the sea routes were controlled by the Portuguese.The Mughals were forced to choose some trusted Hindu officers for their army.

Maloji Bhonsale was a Maratha Sardar who served as a horseman under the Ahmednagar Sultanate and rose to become a general. He had two sons Shahaji and Sharifji. **Shahaji Raje Bhonsale** became a top commander in Adil Shah's troops and Jagirdar (chieftain) of Pune & Supa. He married **Jijabai**, another Hindu general's daughter. Jijabai carried in her a bright flame of Hindu independence. Moving with her husband from one battle to another, Jijabai developed a fighting and resilient spirit. On 19 February 1630 at the fort of Shivneri, Pune they were blessed with a son, Shivaji.

EARLY YEARS OF SHIVAJI MAHARAJ

One of the greatest influencers in the life of Shivaji was his mother Jijabai, a pious and religious woman. She inspired him with stories from the Ramayana, Mahabharata, Puranas and tales of heroic kings. She instilled in him all the values required for a great leader.

JIJABAI FINDS THE WARRIOR IN HER SON

When he was a toddler, Jijabai left Shivaji in a room filled with various toys. Any other kid of his age would have picked up an attractive toy, but Shivaji was no ordinary child. He chose a wooden sword. The surprised Jijabai again experimented by re-arranging the sword amongst other toys the next day. Again, the child amazed his mother by searching and picking the sword. When Jijabai removed the sword from the room, the little child refused to choose anything else. Jijabai spotted the spirit of the warrior in Shivaji very early in life.

Shivaji spent his early life at the Shivneri Fort under the tutelage of his uncle **Dadoji Kondadeo**, who managed the province in the absence of his father. He was a strict disciplinarian and role model to Shivaji. Dadoji taught the young Shivaji about techniques of warfare and theories of good administration.

Jijabai and Shivaji

Although Shahaji spent his military life serving the Deccan Sultanates, Shivaji broke away from his father's path with the vision of **Hindavi Swarajya** - self rule of Bharat by Bharatiyas.

OATH OF INDEPENDENCE

Shivaji did not have brothers and sisters for company. From a very early age, he learnt to be independent. He grew up with friends who came from the hilly regions and were hardy and strong. Once the teenager Shivaji trekked up to the Raireshwar temple with his friends. It was a challenging one but they made it to the top.

With a sense of accomplishment, the young Shivaji declared:

> "Friends, now our path is clear. We shall all strive to attain our aim and work for it until it is achieved. We will have our own rule, our own kingdom. It will be yours, mine and everybody's kingdom. We refuse to live as slaves anymore. Let us take this oath with Lord Raireshwar as witness as we give ourselves completely to the great task of establishing our own Raj. God thinks that this kingdom should take shape as 'Hindavi Swarajya'. We shall ensure that God's wish is fulfilled."

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Memorize the oath of independence taken by Shivaji. Form teams, randomly pick a few people from the team and ask them to recite the oath.

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THE BUDDING LEADER

Shivaji had been trained in martial arts and civil administration. He gathered around him a band of officers who were loyal. In 1646, he strategically found a place that was away from the imperial* power centers and established his Rajya (kingdom) with the local peasants 'Mavlis' as his subjects. It was just a start.

Shivaji had extensive knowledge about the area where he was to fight battles. He knew every mountain, hillock, river, rivulet, fort and valley in the Deccan area like the back of his hand. His soldiers had detailed maps of the terrain. Shivaji understood the important role forts played in establishing an empire. Forts are a show of strength and protection. But how can he build forts from scratch? Shivaji snatched the Torna, Chakan and Kondan forts from Adilshah's commanders. He fought and won over Thane, Kalyan and Bhiwandi Forts with the help of **Abhaji Sondev**.

ADIL SHAH'S ANXIETY

No one had dared to challenge the sultans before. Now Adil Shah felt threatened. To stop this fearless teenager, Adil Shah arrested his own general Shahaji Bhonsale, Shivaji's father. Adil Shah was able to avert* attacks from Shivaji for the next 7 years. While the Mughals thought their problems were over, but Shivaji was gathering support from other patriots and strengthening his army without getting noticed. He steadily built a powerful army commanded by **Nethaji Palkar** and an infantry unit led by **Nethaji Kank**. He attacked and captured over 40 forts.

The warriors that Shivaji led were older and more experienced than him. Yet they followed him with faith and delivered their best. He was able to communicate his noble vision and infuse dynamism in these veterans. Imagine what a leader Shivaji must have been!

SHIVAJI'S UNIQUE MILITARY TACTICS

COMPETENT SPY NETWORK

Shivaji had a very competent spy network to gather information. Some of his loyal and brilliant spies were **Vishvasrao Nanaji Dige**, **Bahirji Naik**, **Sunderji Prabhuji**. Bahirji's information on the massive wealth and riches stored in Surat prompted Shivaji to attack the city and humiliate the Mughals. In fact, Bahirji had mapped out the entire city of Surat to help Shivaji's troops plunder the Mughal city in 1664.

GUERILLA WARFARE

Shivaji's army was adept in guerilla warfare. The army used unusual and out of the box ways to fight the enemy in treacherous* terrain. Shivaji understood that most of his foes had large armies. While he didn't have as many number of people in his army, he used unique tactics to ensure his smaller army was able to effectively win over the enemy.

Imperial : Royal/regal **Avert :** Avoid/fend off **Treacherous :** dangerous/ tough

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

What are the traits of a good spy? How should the king interact with his spies?

EXPANSION OF THE MARATHA EMPIRE

Shivaji established Hindavi Swaraj by conquering Adil Shah's Bijapur. Adil Shah failed in many attempts to subdue Shivaji and take back the kingdom. Finally, he sent his best and most powerful Afghani general, Afzal Khan, to kill Shivaji.

SHIVAJI VS AFZAL KHAN

Afzal Khan commanded a large force. This included 20,000 Adilshahi cavalry, 15,000 infantries, 10,000 of Afzal Khan's personal cavalry, 5,000 of personal infantry and 1,500 musketeers. The army also included close to 100 cannons, 90 elephants and over 1,000 camels. To provoke Shivaji to reveal himself, Afzal Khan looted and destroyed many temples including Tuljapur and Pandharpur temples and harmed innocent people. Tuljapur Bhavani was the ancestral deity of Shivaji. Shivaji understood Afzal Khan's intentions. He refused to fall for the trap. He knew that the opponents were mightier in numbers and he would lose if he fought in the plains. He wanted to play to his strengths. Shivaji sent a messenger to Afzal Khan, calling for a peace treaty.

AGREEMENT FOR THE MEETING

They will meet at Pratapgadh - a hill fort built on a spur* in the middle of thick jungles, valleys, rivers, at a height of 3,540 ft above sea level. Both parties will meet unarmed. They will come with only 10 guards. 1 guard would wait outside the tent where the meeting was to take place. 9 guards would be within arrow-shot distance.

Afzal Khan agreed to the meeting, thinking that this would be the right opportunity for him to kill Shivaji. But the clever Shivaji foresaw that the cunning Afzal Khan would double-cross him. Shivaji not only planned to kill Afzal Khan, but also defeat his entire army. Shivaji spoke to his people explaining the large risk of the plan unfolding before them. He instructed various parts of his army and administrators to be prepared for any eventuality so that the fight for Swarajya can continue.

Shivaji instructed all his soldiers to hide in the forests and wait for the sound of the canon and only then attack Afzal Khan's army. So, the Maratha soldiers went into the forests in small batches over many days and lived on the wild berries and fruits available there.

On 10 November 1659, the two met in a tent outside the Pratapgadh fort. Shivaji wore an armour, concealing a dagger and his famous **Wagnak** (Tiger-Claw) beneath it. As the two men entered the tent, the 6'7'' tall Afzal Khan tried to strangle Shivaji in an embrace and pierced his dagger into Shivaji's back. The armour under Shivaji's clothes saved him. He quickly thrust his tiger-claws into Afzal Khan's stomach and tore it apart, killing him instantly.

Pratapgadh fort

Shivaji escaped through the back, found his way to the top of the fort and he then sounded the canon. The

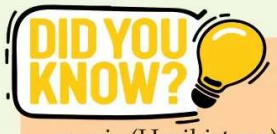
Spur : Piece of land that stick out between valleys

soldiers descended on Afzal Khan's army like a swarm and caught them by surprise. Adil Shah faced his worst defeat – he lost his artillery, 65 elephants, 4,000 horses, 1,000 camels, jewels worth Rs.3,00,000 and money worth Rs.10,00,000, heaps of precious clothes, and tents to the Marathas. He also lost the money and grain stored for feeding his army. 5,000 of Adil Shah's soldiers were killed. Almost as many were wounded. 3,000 soldiers were imprisoned. The remainder were allowed to go home in defeat. The Marathas lost only 1,734 soldiers, while 420 soldiers were wounded. Within 15 days of the battle of Pratapgadh, Shivaji had doubled his territory.

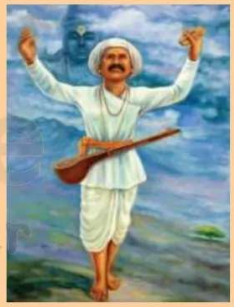
Shivaji's vision was Hindavi Swaraj or self-rule. His fight was against foreign invaders. This vision enabled his troops and citizens to work together more effectively. His vision led him to capture and build 360 forts. Shivaji once said, "Even if the foreign enemy takes a year to acquire one fort, it would take them 360 years to win over us."

Shivaji was a constant thorn in the flesh of the sultans of Bijapur and the Adilshahis. His dynamism and bravery not only terrified the enemy, but also ignited the spirit of sacrifice in his followers.

BATTLE OF PRATAPGADH	
When?	November 1659 CE
Where?	Satara, Maharashtra
Who were the combatants?	
Marathas	Bijapur Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Shivaji	Afzal Khan
Outcome : Shivaji killed Afzal Khan, Mughal resources and wealth gained by the Marathas, Shivaji doubled his territory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Marathas became a formidable force in Deccan.	



Shivaji's bravery and love for Bharat is known to many. But did you know that Shivaji was very fond of devotional music (Harikirtana). Being very passionate about Sanatana Dharma he attended many pravachans* given by great saints like Santh Tukaram.



Sant Tukaram was a great devotee of Lord Vitthala and a significant part of the Varkari tradition. He followed the path popularized by Jnaneshwarji. Deeply immersed in the teachings of Santh Tukaram, Shivaji expressed his desire to become Tukaram's disciple. Tukaram understood the prevailing situation in Bharat and the need for rulers like Shivaji. He provided a strong spiritual message to Shivaji and directed the king towards a guru like Samartha Ramdas. He reminded Shivaji about his vision for Bharat and encouraged him to serve his people by leading them as a king.

BATTLE OF PAWANKIND

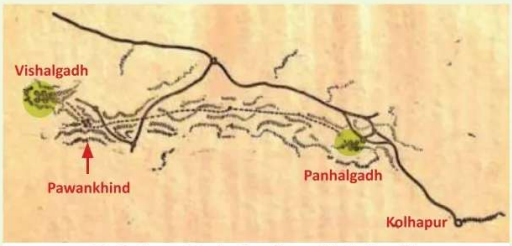
On hearing about Shivaji's presence inside Panhala fort (Panhalgadh), Adil Shah II despatched a large army, of more than 40,000 soldiers and cannons, to capture Shivaji (Panhalgadh is close to present day Kolhapur). His uncle Siddhi Jauhar led the army. Huge stores of grains inside the fort's granaries kept Shivaji and his people well fed for over 5 months. But the risk of Shivaji's capture was very high. With all supplies to the fort cut off by the Adilshahi army, something had to be done.

Shivaji along with his commander-in-chief **Baji Prabhu Deshpande**, intelligence chief **Bahirji Naik**, and his personal barber **Shiva Kashid** devised a plan to escape from Panhalgadh to another fort, Vishalgadh, 70kms away. It was monsoon time and Shivaji wanted to use the rains that masked sound and movement. Bahirji Naik mapped a lesser-known route and Baji Prabhu Deshpande hand-picked 600 soldiers to accompany Shivaji to Vishalgadh. What was Shivaji's personal barber Shiva Kashid going to do? Shiva Kashid very closely resembled Shivaji. It was decided by Baji Prabhu and Bahirji that Shiva Kashid would disguise himself

Pravachans : Spiritual lectures

as Shivaji and travel in a palanquin with a small group of soldiers on the route frequented by the enemy so as to distract them, while Shivaji's team escaped via the route proposed by Bahirji. Shivaji was not keen as he didn't want to put Shiva Kashid's life at risk. However Shiva Kashid was enthusiastic to serve his king and convinced Shivaji of the plan.

The two groups slipped out of the fort and raced towards Vishalgadh. Siddhi Jauhar's soldiers spotted a palanquin with a small group of soldiers and captured the group. The captured Shiva Kashid was paraded before Siddhi Jauhar and other captured Maratha soldiers to confirm his identity. But Siddhi Jauhar was still doubtful. In a few hours, Siddhi received news that a large contingent of more than 500 soldiers were headed towards Vishalgadh. Siddhi Jauhar understood that he was tricked and ordered Shiva Kashid to be beheaded and sent a large contingent of his army to pursue Shivaji. The large force of almost 10,000 quickly caught up with Shivaji's small force of around 600 soldiers. Baji Prabhu Deshpande decided that a smaller contingent of 300 soldiers will stay back to control the oncoming hordes while Shivaji will proceed with the rest to Vishalgadh. It was important for Shivaji to reach safety so that the fight for Swarajya can carry on.



Path from Panhalgadh to Vishalgadh

Baji Prabhu Deshpande

Baji Prabhu Deshpande with his determined troop of 300 brave warriors chose the narrow pass in the mountains called **Ghod Khind** (Horse Pass) to encounter the raiding hordes of Adil Shah. Ghod Khind was a very strategic choice as only a few people could cross it at a time. The 300 strong Marathas clashed against the thousands of the Adilshahi army and held them back. The fleets of enemy units kept trying to push past Baji Prabhu and his soldiers but they fought aggressively and pushed them back.

The Marathas were badly wounded, but did not give up before inflicting severe casualities on the enemy. They were waiting to hear the canon boom from Vishalgadh signalling Shivaji's safety. Baji Prabhu Deshpande, severely wounded, died fighting at Ghod Khind resting easy in the knowledge that Shivaji was safe. In memory of Baji Prabhu Deshpande and his brave soldiers, Ghod Khind was renamed **Pawankind** (Sacred Pass). Baji Prabhu Deshpande was paid rich tributes by Shivaji. Even today there are people who trek from Panhalgadh to Vishalgadh remembering the brave few and their contribution to Swarajya.

THINK!!!

What would have happened if not for Shiva Kashid, Bhaji Prabu Deshpande and other Marathas, who bravely sacrificed themselves for their king?
Why did they choose to do so?

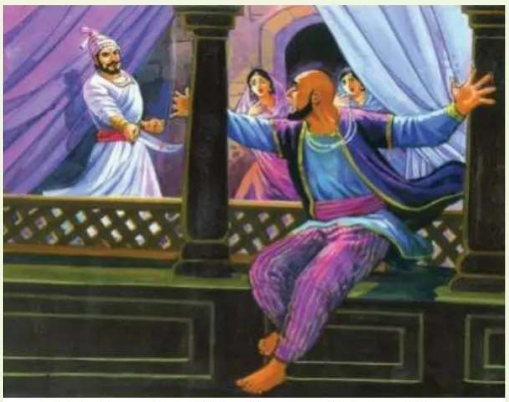
SHIVAJI VS SHAISTA KHAN

After the dramatic death of Afzal Khan, and back to back blows, Aurangzeb appointed his uncle Shaista Khan as the new viceroy of the Deccan Sultanate. In January 1660, with an enormous army of 1,50,000 soldiers, elephants, camels and horses, Shaista Khan paraded

BATTLE OF PAWANKHIND	
When? July 1660 CE	
Where? Kolhapur, Maharashtra	
Who were the combatants?	
Marathas	Bijapur Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Baji Prabhu Deshpande	Siddhi Jauhar
Outcome : 1000s of Adil Shahi soldiers killed, Baji Prabhu Deshpande & few Maratha soldiers martyred	
SIGNIFICANCE : Shivaji escaped capture and continued fight against the Mughals	

into Aurangabad and quickly captured Pune, Shivaji's capital. He seized the Maratha territory and established his residence at Shivaji's palace - Lal Mahal, when Shivaji was away. No Hindu soldier or civilian could leave or enter Pune without applying for permission. Shivaji decided to retaliate by attacking Shaista Khan right in the middle of his own camp. Shaista Khan stayed at Lal Mahal, a big mistake considering Shivaji knew every nook and corner of the palace and its surroundings.

In April 1663, Shivaji infiltrated Pune with a troop of around 200 soldiers, in the guise of a wedding procession. Disguised as people who came to attend the wedding, Shivaji and his soldiers silently entered the Lal Mahal and found their way to Shaista Khan's bedroom. Shaista Khan was alerted in the nick of time by his servants and he jumped through the window to escape. Yet he got 3 of his fingers chopped off by Shivaji. Shaista Khan's son, and his guards were killed. By now Shivaji realized that his enemy was alert and he escaped with his soldiers to Sinhagadh. This covert operation was so well executed that the Mughals started fearing that Shivaji possessed some kind of magical powers. The word spread far and wide and Shivaji came to regarded as a superhero. It was a huge humiliation for the Mughals.


Shivaji cutting off the fingers of Shaista Khan

Shivaji didn't stop with that – he immediately ransacked the rich Mughal trading city of Surat. He plundered the city and captured its wealth. He attacked the Mughals when they were least prepared. Shivaji captured various Mughal ports in Maharashtra following the richest one in Surat. Were Shivaji's attacks always successful? Was he ever captured? Let us read about how Shivaji used even his defeat to his advantage.

Did Shivaji adopt the same solution for all challenges? He was able to think on his feet and develop innovative solutions, outwitting the enemy each time. Imagine the training given to Shivaji's army, such that they were able to adapt to different strategies!

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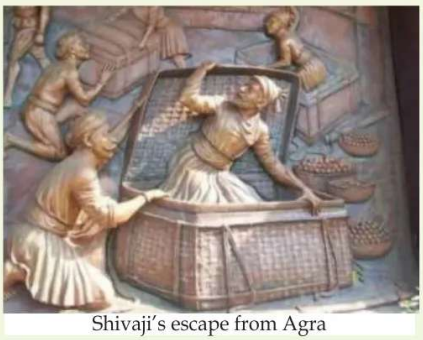
CAPTURE AND ESCAPE

The Mughals had many kings of Bharat as their allies and cunningly used them to fight the loyal Bharatiya forces. Enraged by the loss of face for the Mughals, Aurangzeb sent Mirja Raja Jai Singh with a huge army to defeat Shivaji. In 1665, Jai Singh with 1,50,000 soldiers attacked and captured many Maratha forts. This forced Shivaji to sign the **Purandar treaty** on 11 June 1665 where he gave up 23 forts and 4,00,000 Hunas compensation. Even though Shivaji did not want to, his love and responsibility towards his soldiers prompted his surrender.

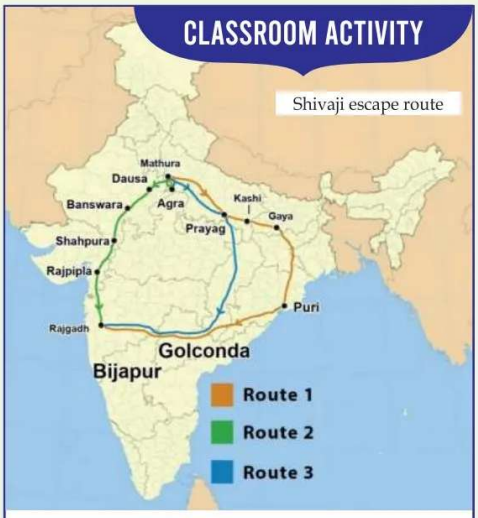
Under Aurangzeb's command, Raja Jai Singh invited Shivaji and his son Sambhaji to Agra. On reaching the Mughal court in Agra, Aurangzeb made Shivaji stand behind the military commanders of his army intentionally disrespecting him. When Shivaji took this as an offence and stormed out of the court, he was then confined under house arrest by Aurangzeb.


Shivaji's escape from Agra

Now Shivaji was far from his home ground, with hardly anyone on his side. He had to escape from the enemy's den, without any resource. Despite the tough circumstance, it didn't take too long for Shivaji to think through an escape plan. This time he appealed to the enemy's ego. He knew that Aurangzeb wanted to break Shivaji's spirit. Shivaji faked severe illness and requested Aurangzeb's permission to send back his followers to Deccan. Aurangzeb fell for the trap and agreed.

Shivaji acted as though he was in his last days and appealed to Aurangzeb for his consent to send daily offerings of fruits and sweets to various sages and fakirs of Agra. This massaged Aurangzeb's ego making him feel that Shivaji was at his mercy. This continued for several weeks. The guards initially checked every shipment moving out of the palace. After many weeks they got slack and stopped checking them. Shivaji took advantage of this slack. One day, Shivaji and Sambhaji hid in two of such shipments and escaped Badshah's palace. Instead of taking the most obvious route back to Pune, Shivaji travelled northwards to Mathura, eastwards to Allahabad, and finally south-westward through Bundelkhand, Gondwana and Golconda and finally to Rajgarh in Pune. The entire journey took him 25 days. Aurangzeb felt embarrassed and crushed on hearing about Shivaji's escape. He regretted this till his death. He kept lamenting to his sons that this negligence would cost them incalculable harm.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY



These are three possible routes Shivaji Maharaj could have taken to reach Pune, according to popular sources. Calculate the approximate distances he would have covered under each route.

Route 1_____

Route 2_____

Route 3_____

FORTS - THE BEDROCK OF SWARAJYA

Shivaji Maharaj firmly believed - "Swarajyache Saar te durg" meaning forts are the bedrock of Swarajya. Shivaji wielded the forts as one giant weapon. He recognised that power in Maharashtra meant control of the forts. Certain traits of the forts, some predating Shivaji, many devised by him, enabled a strong kingdom to rise.

Some of the key features of the Maratha forts are as follows:

- The Marathas built huge water tanks on the forts, enough to serve hundreds of soldiers. Even today, after centuries of neglect, these tanks remain the primary source of water. The tank atop the Alang fort is so extensive, it is difficult to believe human hands built them.
- Shivaji ensured every fort had multiple entry and exit points. While one would be the main entrance, there were other smaller 'chor darwajas' which served like backdoors for making an escape effective. Moreover, for the main entrance, a 'Gau Mukh' arrangement was followed when building the door and its bastions. From a distance, the ramparts of the fort would seem to overlap and thus, conceal the entrance. Inside the forts, the steps were intentionally made of uneven height. In the event of enemies entering the fort, the uneven steps made it difficult for soldiers on horses and those on foot to move swiftly.
- Shivaji also adopted unique means of defence, such as scraping the hill sides to make the hill side nearly vertical and make full use of the natural defences of the fort. This can be seen on various forts, including Rajgadh. Some structures were unique to particular forts. The double wall of Rajgadh, for example. It acted as a double defensive wall and could even trap soldiers in the narrow gap between the walls.

Water tank atop Alang fort

Escape route/Chor Darwaja

Double wall Rajgadh fort

- Of the physical changes, the last but not the least, was the building or maintaining of forts in pairs - Rajgadh and Torna, Purandar and Vajragadh, Lohagadh and Visapur. This served a dual purpose. It provided a readily accessible safe area to a besieged fort and one fort could provide the other with provisions and supplies. For example: The case of the fort of Trimbak, provided back-up resources to Ramsej in northern Maharashtra during the great war with the Mughals. The small fort of Ramsej held on for six years.
- Shivaji realised the importance of having a strong naval force, and therefore he strategically established a navy and forts at the coastline to defend the Konkan side of Maharashtra. Jaigadh, Vijayadurg, Sindhudurg and other such forts still stand to testify his efforts and ideas. These forts also helped as the frontline for sea-trade.

  The Marathas prevailed, primarily, because of the forts. The administration of the forts was dealt with an iron hand with utmost respect for the rules.

Sindhudurg water fort

WINNING BACK SINHAGADH

Tanhaji explaining the plan to reclaim Kondhana fort

The treaty of Purandar in the year 1665 had forced Shivaji to surrender 23 forts including Kondhana. This treaty hurt the pride of the Marathas. Jijabai expressed to Shivaji her wish to recapture the forts from the Mughals. Shivaji thought there was nobody else more capable for this task than his trusted general **Tanhaji Malusare**, a man of iron will who accompanied Shivaji on all his historic battles. The mission to recapture Kondhana fort was very tough and could prove fatal to the soldiers. The fort was under the care of Uday Bhan, an ally of Aurangzeb. Jijabai and Shivaji discussed this with Tanhaji. He was undaunted by the plan and vowed to accomplish the task or die in the battle-field.

In February 1670 CE, Tanhaji set out at night from Konkan and marched towards the fort, accompanied by his army. It was a cold, clear and moonless night. Tanhaji had taken his pet Yashwanti, a ghorpad or monitor lizard, to help him scale the wall of the fort. Monitor lizards are adept in choosing the best route to scale a wall. Tanhaji with a small band of soldiers managed to scale the fort walls. However, their entry into the fort was detected by the Mughals. A fierce fight raged. The 700 soldiers who had accompanied Tanhaji were hoping to enter the fort through the main and side doors. Tanhaji and his brave bunch had to deal with the enemies inside the fort and quickly open the gates of the fort. Uday Bhan's forces were fierce and hampering Tanhaji's progress towards the gates. In a tough fight with Uday Bhan, Tanhaji lost his life. But by then the Maratha soldiers gained entry, killed Uday Bhan and claimed the fort.

The news of the victory was sent to Shivaji, who came quickly to congratulate his friend Tanhaji. When he came to know of Tanhaji's supreme sacrifice. Shivaji broke down and said "We gained the fort but lost the Lion." The fort was renamed as Sinhagadh in honour of Tanhaji. This fort still stands today, as a monument to the friendship of Shivaji and Tanhaji.

THE DAWN OF CHHATRAPATI SHIVAJI MAHARAJ

In 1674 after a long time, Shivaji finally returned to Pune. In June 1674, a grand coronation for Shivaji was held in Raigad earning him the title of Chhatrapati, an independent king. Rajamata Jijabai's dream of Hindavi Swarajya and Guru Samartha Ramdas's vision for Dharma to be upheld, got realized on this day.

SHIVAJI'S PILLAR OF SUPPORT - SAMARTHA RAMDAS

Samartha Ramdas guiding Shivaji Maharaj

Here, it is important to recount a couple of incidents that convey the impact of Samartha Ramdas on Shivaji's life. When invited for the coronation by Shivaji, Samartha Ramdas expressed his inability to attend it. The Guru explained to Shivaji that the attention of people should be on the Chhatrapati on that day, and they should not be distracted by the presence of ascetics like him. The Guru always kept the king rooted through the prosperous and tough times. Once when Shivaji was walking along with Samartha Ramdas, Shivaji remarked that he had provided well for his people. Samartha Ramdas immediately lifted a stone under which there was a frog. He asked Shivaji if he has provided for that frog. Shivaji realised that there was a greater power taking care of all. Presence of a strong spiritual mentor ensured that Shivaji did not rest on his laurels after his coronation. Chhatrapati Shivaji strengthened his power through appointments of trusted ministers and planned an expansion to the south to free the area from the rule of the Qutbshahi and other nizams. Guru Samartha Ramdas truly kept Shivaji grounded in the scriptures through the thick and thin. He established many Hanuman temples and Akhadas or gyms alongside them, to emphasize the need for physical fitness to fight the Islamic forces. Samarth Ramdas created such a fighting force that supplemented Shivaji Maharaj's army.

Coronation of Chhatrapati Shivaji

THINK!!!

Can you guess his age when Shivaji officially became Emperor?

He was 44 years old. He accomplished all the glorious acts without an official title. He had no obligation as a king to his people but his vision was mighty. Shivaji Maharaj's story reminds us that we do not need a title to be an inspiring and effective leader

EXPANDING MARATHA TERRITORIES TO THE SOUTH

Moving through Hyderabad, Srisailam, Gingee, Vellore, and Trichy Shivaji reached Kollidam. He won over the Nayak of Madura and reached Thanjavur. All along the way Shivaji fought his way through to capture the region and their forts or the local ruler surrendered to him. At Thanjavur, he met Venkoji who was ruling the place and demanded his share of the taxes of the region. They were unable to come to an agreement on the splitting of the wealth by which time Venkoji fled the camp. Shivaji appointed administrators to govern the southern region that he had won over. The English, French and Dutch in the region were eager to please Shivaji and sent over many gifts and tributes to him. Having established his ministers in place, Shivaji headed back to Maharashtra. Enroute the regions of Kolar, Sira and Hoskote were taken over by him and he reached Panhala in 1678. By 1679, Shivaji had groomed his sons Sambhaji and Rajaram to govern over different regions of the Maratha empire. By the end of 1679 Chhatrapati Shivaji fell sick and in March 1680 Chhatrapati Shivaji breathed his last. Bharat had lost one of its bravest.

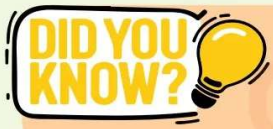
The great spiritual guru Samartha Ramdas wrote:

"Remember Shivaji's image, his daring exploits, his perseverance on this earth
How he spoke, how he behaved, how he endeared himself
Sacrificing all his pleasures, he could gain his ambition , the pain to establish a kingdom, see how it was done
Only when one does more than this, should one be called a man, more than this, what can I write?"

ADMINISTRATION UNDER SHIVAJI, THE LEADER

As a king Shivaji brought in exceptional policies and systems so that Dharma was maintained. Salient features of Maratha administration are :

- Shivaji Maharaj employed members of all castes to maintain balance in the society. He assigned separate responsibilities to each minister. No one held hereditary office positions.
- The Ryotwari system of revenue was followed where farmers became landowners. Previously, the Vatandars (Independent officers) used to collect taxes from the peasants and agricultural workers of the various regions. This led to the peasants being exploited. Shivaji paid the Vatandars directly from the treasury and ensured that the farmers were not charged exorbitant taxes.
- Shivaji abolished rights over the forts that were held by local chieftains. Vatandars were not allowed to raise armies. The army was paid directly from the central treasury. The officers were also sent to different forts on a rotational basis. This was to avoid them being in just one fort for too long and gaining too much power within that fort and region. This avoided creating local power centers and allowed for the officers to move from one region to another instead of being stuck to a fort.
- Ashta Pradhaan-Council of 8 ministers was formed with a Prantpati (head of province). The Kingdom was divided into 4 provinces-each under a Viceroy. Head of each village was called Deshpande or Patel. The Panchayat system was followed. Women were respected and the soldiers were not allowed to capture women from defeated armies.
- Shivaji never discriminated his men on religious basis, he even employed Muslim officers as bodyguards. He treated his loyal set of spies as brothers. In fact, the state took care of the families of the deceased warriors. The 6 divisions of army were-(1) Cavalry-2 types of horsemen (Bargis and Silhadars) (2) Infantry (3) Camel battalions (4) Elephant battalions (5) Artillery (6) Navy



Salt, an important commodity, was manufactured in both Sangameshwar (in the Konkan region) and in Goa (which was ruled by the Portuguese). Goan salt was sold at a cheaper rate. Shivaji Maharaj imposed an import duty on the salt from Goa to bring the price on par with the salt from Sangameshwar.

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CONCLUSION

Chhatrapati Shivaji had planned and executed his plan for Bharat. The foundation for Hindavi Swarajya had been laid that will be built on, in the years to come. The changes made to the administrative and military systems greatly benefited the citizens of the Maratha empire. Not granting land in lieu of military service but rather paying them from the central treasury enabled greater control over the military personnel. Shivaji's legacy survived for more than a hundred years after him. The historian Jadunath Sarkar sums up: "Shivaji called the Maratha race to a new life. He raised them into self-reliant people conscious of their oneness and high destiny and his precious legacy was the spirit that he breathed into the race".

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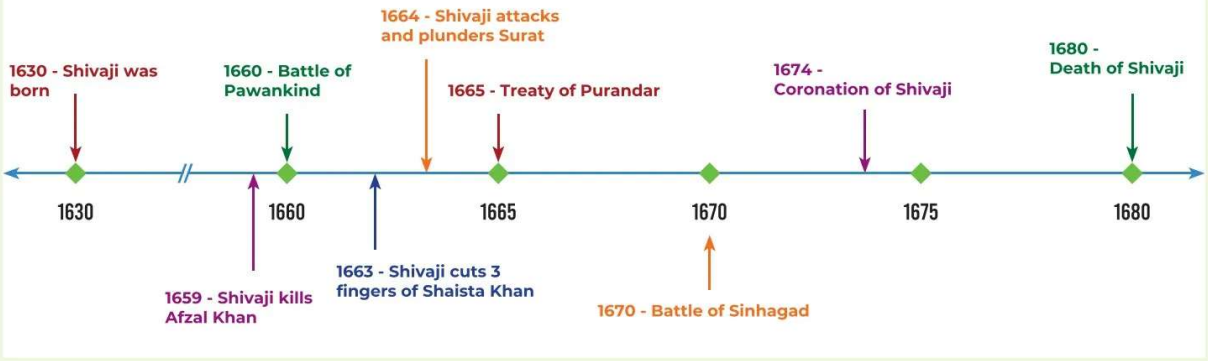
KEYWORDS

- Jijabai, Shivaji
- Hindavi Swarajya
- Adil Shah
- Spy network
- Guerilla warfare
- Afzal Khan
- Pratapgadh
- Wagnak
- Sant Tukaram
- Pawankind
- Baji Prabhu Deshpande
- Shaista Khan
- Raja Jai Singh
- Purandar treaty
- Aurangazeb
- Sambaji, Rajaram
- Forts
- Tanhaji
- Guru Samarth Ramdas

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The Bhonsales descended from the _____.
   a) Rathores b) Sisodias c) Jalores d) Shahs
2. Shahaji Raje Bhonsale was a key official in the _____
   a) Bijapur sultanate b) Marathas c) Ahmadnagar sultanate d) Berar sultanate
3. True or False:
   Statement A: Dadaji Kondadeo was an early teacher who was a role model for a young Shivaji.
   Statement B: Jijabai inspired Shivaji with the incidents from epics like the Ramayana and Mahabharata.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
4. The Treaty of Purandar was signed in the year _____
   a) 1663 b) 1665 c) 1667 d) 1669
5. Shaista Khan was appointed as the new viceroy of Deccan Sultanate by _____
   a) Akbar b) Shahjahan c) Aurangzeb d) Adi Shah
6. To meet Afzal Khan, Shivaji hid a dagger and _____ under his armour that he used to kill Afzal Khan.
   a) Gun b) Wagnak c) Khanjar d) Talwar
7. _____ established many Hanuman temples and akhadas that created a fighting force for Shivaji.
   a) Tanhaji Malusare b) Bahirji Naik c) Samartha Ramdas d) Baji Prabhu
8. Shivaji was crowned as Chhatrapati in _____.
   a) April 1675 b) June 1674 c) March 1673 d) November 1676
9. Shivaji and _____ outwitted Aurangazeb and escaped from Agra where they were placed on house arrest.
   a) Venkoji b) Abhaji Sondev c) Nethaji Palkar d) Sambaji

MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Hindavi Swarajya	Ashta Pradhaan
Council of 8 ministers	Deshpande
Cavalry	Chordarwajas
Backdoors	Bharatiya Self-rule
Head of the village	Bargis and Silhadars

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ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. How did the Mughals in Delhi govern far away regions like Bijapur and Golconda?
2. What was the role of the Raireshwar temple in Shivaji's life?
3. As a young leader how did Shivaji establish his kingdom and network of forts? Who helped him in this regard?
4. Why did Adil Shah feel threatened by Shivaji and how did he react?
5. Who were the loyal spies of Shivaji?
6. What was the agreement for the meeting of Shivaji and Afzal Khan?
7. Who was Shiva Kashid and his role in Maratha history?
8. What was the impact of the Treaty of Purandar?
9. What was the use of maintaining forts in pairs? Give examples.
10. Describe the role of Samartha Ramdas in Shivaji's life.

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Discuss the role of Jijabai in Shivaji's life.
2. Write a note on the Battle of Pawankind.
3. What was the outcome of the battle of Pratapgadh?
4. Explain the role of Sant Tukaram in Shivaji's life.
5. How did Shivaji enter the Lal Mahal in Pune and humiliate the Mughals?
6. Write a detailed note on the forts established by Shivaji and their importance in establishing the Maratha empire.
7. Who was Tanhaji Malusare? Explain his role in winning back Sinhagad.
8. What were the salient features of the Maratha administration under Shivaji?
9. Explain the expansion of the Maratha empire under Shivaji in the southern regions of Bharat.

CASE STUDY

"Under Aurangzeb's command, Raja Jai Singh invited Shivaji and his son Sambhaji to Agra. On reaching the Mughal court in Agra, Aurangzeb made Shivaji stand behind the military commanders of his army intentionally disrespecting him. When Shivaji took this as an offence and stormed out of the court, he was then confined under house arrest by Aurangzeb."

1. What qualities were exhibited by Shivaji through the above incident?
2. Who was Raja Jai Singh?
3. Explain in detail what followed the house arrest of Shivaji.

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. a) Shivaji is coronated and earns the title of Chhatrapati
   b) Battle of Pawankind
   c) Shivaji is placed under house arrest by Aurangazeb
   d) Shivaji kills Afzal Khan

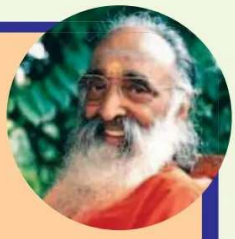
MAP ACTIVITY

Mark the following places in the map of Bharat.

• Thane • Bijapur • Tuljapur • Pratapgadh • Agra • Sindhudurg • Sinhagad • Sangameshwar • Goa

Chapter 8

LIONS OF PUNJAB



"We serve as an army, courageous and disciplined, ever ready to fight against all low tendencies and false values, within and without us. We live honestly the noble life of sacrifice and service, producing more than what we consume and giving more than what we take. We believe that the service of our country is the service of the Lord of Lords, and devotion to the people is devotion to the supreme Self."

- Swami Chinmayananda

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss about Sri Guru Nanak, his life and teachings
- Examine the significant role played by the successors of Guru Nanak and how the gurus in safe-guarded Bharat
- Describe how Guru Gobind Singh and his successors challenged the Mughals
- Illustrate the formation of the Sikh empire under Maharaja Ranjit Singh

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INTRODUCTION

Being geographically located as a gateway to Bharat, Punjab bore the maximum brunt of the invasions. It should be remembered that Punjab which is mentioned here is not the current Indian state of Punjab, but the land situated in current day Pakistan.

It was under these circumstances that Sri Nanak (popularly known as Guru Nanak) was born at Rāi Bhoi Kī Talvandi village (present-day Nankana Sahib, Punjab, Pakistan). This chapter deals with how Sri Guru Nanak through his simple, loving and compassionate ways founded Sikhism. In this lesson we will learn about his successors and how they helped subdue the onslaught of the oppressive religious policies of the Mughals.

Map showing Punjab region

SRI GURU NANAK

Sri Guru Nanak was born on 15 April 1469, in a Hindu Kshatriya family. Nanak's childhood was marked with many events that demonstrated that he was blessed with divine grace. He was married to Sulakhani and had 2 sons, Sri Chand and Laxmi Chand. Guru Nanak later travelled all around the country spreading the message of universal love, service to mankind and social justice, which later developed into Sikhism. Guru Nanak, and his followers emphasized Bhakti (devotion) and described living an active, creative, and practical life of truthfulness, fidelity, self-control and purity.

TEACHINGS OF SRI GURU NANAK

The three guidelines for life professed by Sri Guru Nanak are:

- Vand Shako (share & consume) : Share with others, help those who are in need
- Kirat Karo (work honestly) : Earn an honest living, without exploitation or fraud
- Naam Japo (recite His name) : Recite and meditate on God's name

Sri Guru Nanak called his way as Gurumat or Guru's wisdom. His disciples called themselves Sikhs, which is derived from the Sanskrit word 'shisya' meaning 'the learner'. Sri Guru Nanak or his disciples did not attempt to create a new path or a new religion but were in alignment to Sanatana Dharma. Sri Guru Nanak tried to establish an amity that transcended religion, caste and gender by undertaking journeys called Udasis. In order to bring social inclusivity and equality, Sri Guru Nanak established community kitchens called **Langars**, where food was served to people of all sections of society for free. His message of equality, fraternal love, goodness, and virtue along with the verses of other Sikh Gurus and saints like Kabir, Surdas, Ramdas etc are collectively known as **Guru Granth Sahib**, the holy book of the Sikhs.

EARLY SIKH GURUS

After the death of **Sri Guru Nanak, Guru Angad** became the Guru who began the process of collecting the hymns of Sri Nanak and also contributed about 62 of his own to Guru Granth Sahib. Guru Angad was succeeded by **Guru Amar Das** and **Guru Ram Das**. Guru Ram Das created the city of Amritsar, popularised it by inviting artisans and merchants to settle there and commenced the building of a gurudwara called Harmandir Sahib. **Guru Arjan Dev** completed the construction of Harmandir Sahib (Golden temple).

Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple), Amritsar

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Guru Nanak 1st Guru | Guru Angad 2nd Guru | Guru Amar Das 3rd Guru | Guru Ram Das 4th Guru | Guru Arjan Dev 5th Guru

Guru Hargobind 6th Guru | Guru Har Rai 7th Guru | Guru Har Krishan 8th Guru | Guru Tegh Bahadur 9th Guru | Guru Gobind Singh 10th Guru

MILITARIZING AND POLITICALLY ORGANIZING THE SIKHS

THE MARTYRDOM OF GURU ARJAN DEV

Delhi, Punjab and much of northern Bharat was under the Mughal king Jahangir. Jahangir's son Kusrau rebelled against his father, for which he sought the blessings of Guru Arjan Dev. Jahangir captured the Guru and executed him on 30 May 1606 as the masses were quick to take up Sikhism as their new faith. Guru Arjan Dev was the first martyr* of the Sikh lineage and had a profound impact on the future of the Sikhs.

THE SOLDIER SAINT - GURU HARGOBIND

Arjan Dev's son Hargobind was only 11 years old when he took over. Upon his father's last injunction*, **Guru Hargobind** held two swords by his side, (Miri and Piri, representing spiritual and secular domains). He vowed to militarize the Sikhs to protect the nation and Hindu Dharma, of which Sikhism was a part. He, trained 52 armed body guards, a stable of 700 war horses, 300 horsemen and 60 gunners. He built a steel fort at Amritsar called Lohgarh and administered the place, sitting in a throne like a king, thus marking the political order of the Sikhs.

Between 1621 CE and 1635 CE, Guru Hargobind faced off the Mughals under Shah Jahan in the battles of Rohilla, Sangrana, Lahira and Kartarpur. In all the battles, the Guru himself led the Sikh army, successfully, despite the number of soldiers and resources of the Sikh army being way lower than that of the Mughal army. The Guru ordered his army not to kill the fleeing Mughal soldiers and also offered medical assistance to the wounded Mughal soldiers. After the battle of Lahira, Guru Hargobind cremated the deceased Sikh soldiers with his own hands and built Guru Sar at the site of the battle to commemorate the great victory. With every battle the Sikhs won, Mughal emperor Shah Jahan's treasury was getting emptied.

The Guru was trying to change the age long mentality of Hindus of meekly submitting to the oppressors. After centuries of bondage, he was awakening the masses to a realization that irrespective of the consequence, people should rise against tyranny, bigotry and intolerance. He became a living example to show that spirituality must inspire a person to resist the evil with courage and boldness.

AKAL TAKHT - THE TIMELESS THRONE

In 1609 Guru Hargobind established Akal Takht, opposite to the Harmandir Sahib, connected by a pathway. While the Harmandir Sahib represents Sikh spiritual guidance, the Akal Takht symbolizes the establishment of justice. It was like a combination of a parliament and a court, where the Guru would decide on military strategy and political policy as well as dispense justice. The original structure of Akal Takht was built by Guru Hargobind, Bhai Gurdas and Baba Buddha with their own hands. No other person or artist was employed to build the platform. It was built a fraction lower than the Harmandir Sahib, implying that the search for spiritual grace was always higher.

LATER GURUS

Guru Hargobind also supported the cause of Dara Shikoh, the eldest son of Shah Jahan. He had learnt the Sanskrit language and was inspired by the Upanishadic philosophy, that he had translated into Persian. He was poisoned by his brother Aurangzeb who wanted the throne. Guru Hargobind who passed away in the year 1644, was succeeded by his son **Guru Har Rai**. He popularized the Guru Granth Sahib by public singing and started discourse style recital of the scriptures. Guru Har Rai was succeeded by **Guru Har Kishan**, who died as a 7 year old kid on account of small pox and thereafter **Guru Tegh Bahadur** became the 9th Sikh Guru in the year 1664.

Martyr : A person who sacrifices his/her life for a greater reason
Injunction : Instruction/commandment

GURU TEGH BAHADUR

Tyag Mal joined his father Guru Hargobind in the war against Painde Khan at the Battle of Kartarpur. After the battle was won, the victorious Sikhs honored their hero with a new warrior's name. Tyag Mal was renamed Tegh Bahadur, meaning the brave wielder of sword.

IMPENDING PERIL

In 1658 CE Aurangzeb took over the Mughal Empire. Many Gurudwaras and temples were demolished, Hindus and Sikhs were forcibly converted and brutally killed. Guru Tegh Bahadur came out of his meditative life and set out to travel across many parts of Bharat - Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam and Bengal in 1665. His visits infused confidence and enthusiasm in people when they felt desperate. He gave them spiritual strength and deepened their understanding of the mission to protect our Dharma and culture. During 1674-75, a group of Kashmiri Pandits led by Pandit Kripa Ram Dutt approached the Guru, informing him of the ruthless 'convert or die' scheme by Aurangazeb. The Guru threw a challenge to Aurangzeb to first attempt to convert him to Islam. If he was successful, all others embrace Islam, at least the needless violence could be avoided.

Appeal to Guru Tegh Bahadur

MARTYRDOM OF GURU TEGH BAGHADUR

When Guru Tegh Bahadur was summoned by Aurangazeb he reached Delhi with five of his disciples. When threatened to embrace islam the Guru smilingly replied "I will never, even if my body is cut into a thousand pieces". Despite numerous physical tortures, Guru Tegh Bahadur did not budge. Aurangazeb killed his three disciples, **Bhai Mati Das, Bhai Sati Das** and **Bhai Dayala Das**, in a gruesome way in front of his eyes. Yet, the Guru did not breakdown. The Guru who witnessed the killing of his disciples with unperturbed calmness was then beheaded on 11 November 1675.

THINK!!!

The Guru and his disciples need not have undergone all the torture if he had embraced Islam. Why did they regard their Dharma greater than their lives?

GURU GOBIND SINGH : A GREAT SAGA

After the death of Guru Tegh Bahadur, the responsibility of protecting the Sikhs fell on the shoulders of his son **Gobind Singh**, who became the 10th Guru on 29 March 1676. Brutal execution of his father and great grandfather at the hands of the Mughal kings drove his determination to fight against the tyrannical regime. Gobind Singh had studied the Puranas and knew that Avatars (saviours) are born at crucial times to save the virtuous and re-establish Dharma. He firmly believed this to be his purpose of life. He thus decided to turn the Sikh movement into a political and military regime.

Guru Gobind Singh

THINK!!!

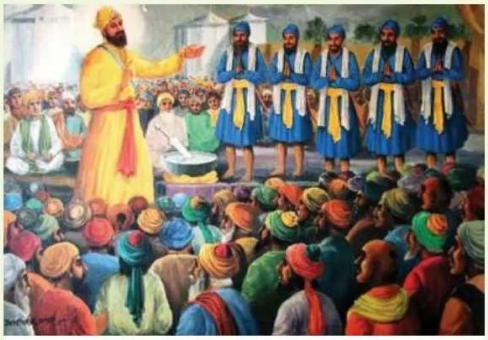
Gobind Singh was born in the year 1666 and became the 10th Guru in the year 1676. He was just a 10 year old boy. What does it take for a 10 year old to lead such a dynamic group of Sikhs and stand up to tyrants?

Guru Gobind Singh got educated in reading & writing as well as in martial arts, horse riding etc. In 1684, when he was just 18 years old, he wrote Chandi Di Var, based on Markandeya Purana. Describing the war between the good and the evil where the good stands up against injustice and tyranny.

In 1688 Guru Gobind Singh fought his first major battle, at Bhangani. He was 22 years old then.

When the Mughals lost in the battle at Nandaun, they started fearing Guru Gobind. In fact, it was Guru Gobind's first major battle.

FORMATION OF KHALSA


Selection of the Panch Pyare

On 30 March 1699, after deep meditation and contemplation, Guru Gobind delivered the most stirring speech on saving the religion, which was in great peril at the hands of the aggressors. The Guru addressed the large congregation of Sikhs urging them not to look for guardians to protect their Dharmic rights, but to become guardians themselves.

Guru Gobind roared:

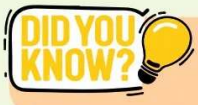
> "What is needed is not just condemnation of evil but also destruction of evil-doers. Love of a neighbor must accompany the punishment of a trespasser. Service of saints implies annihilation of tyrants. Helping friends means harming enemies too. God, Guru and Sword form the trinity in place of Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva. The age of moksha after death has passed. Moksha is to be obtained in this very life, here and now"

Finally, he asked if anyone was ready to offer his head in service of God, truth and religion. This question sent shock waves among the people and no one responded. One man named Dayaram rose up and offered his head. Guru Gobind took Dayaram inside a tent and returned alone to the congregation with his sword drenched in blood. The Guru sought another head and this time a man named Dharam Das rose up and walked to the tent with the Guru. Again Guru Gobind came out with the same bloody sword. Next Himmat Rai, Mohkam Chand, and Sahib Chand followed one afters another. The public was dumbstruck and eager to find out what was running in their Guru's mind. After a short while Guru Gobind returned with the five men who were willing to sacrifice themselves. This was a test to select the best five, for the protection of the good and annihilation of the wicked. The Guru called these five men as beloved ones and called them **Pancha Pyare**. Thus was born the **Khalsa**.

With the creation of Khalsa started a journey of extraordinary valour, breath-taking heroism, fearlessness, unparalleled sufferings and inflexible determination.

RIVER OF WARS

Since the creation of Khalsa, war after war was fought by the Guru for the next 10 years against the Mughals. Significant among them were the battle of Guler (1696), first battle of Anandpur (1700), second battle of Anandpur (1701), battle of Niromgarh (1702), battle of Basoli (1702). In all these battles, the Sikh forces decisively defeated the Mughal army despite the army strength of defending Sikh force was significantly low than the aggressing Mughal army.

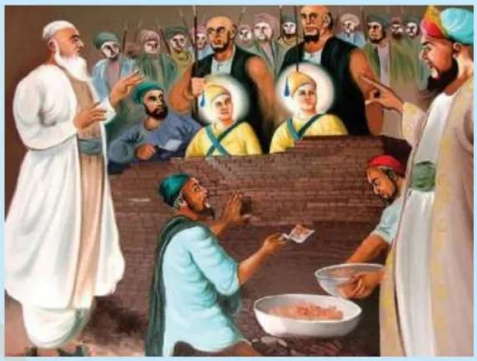


In the first battle of Anandpur, a 1,000 member Sikh army defeated a 10,000 member Mughal Army.

LION CUBS AMIDST THE HYENAS

Once, the Mughal army attacked Guru Gobind Singh his family and followers, when they were travelling from Anandpur to Chamkaur. During this attack, Guru Gobind's mother **Mata Gujri** and two sons, **Zorawar Singh** and **Fateh Singh**, got separated from the larger group and were captured by the Mughals.

The two children, Zorawar Singh aged 9 and Fateh Singh aged 8 were produced before Vazir Khan, the Mughal Governor of Sirhind. He subjected the princes to a trial in his court which lasted for two days. On the first day the princes were cajoled* to embrace Islam and were offered immense riches. The princes rejected the offer and roared thus: "We are the Guru's lions. Why should we fear death? It is best that we should give our lives for the sake of our religion". Vazir Khan declared the two innocent boys to be enemies of the Mughal empire and ordered them to be bricked alive. The two boys, stood calm and composed and were martyred. Upon hearing about the death of her grandchildren, mother of Guru Gobind breathed her last. This event happened on 26 December 1704. Indian Government has declared 26 December as **Veer Bal Diwas** to remember and celebrate the courage and fortitude exhibited by the young princes of the Sikh community.



ZAFARNAMA

In 1705, Guru Gobind was at Dina. When he received a letter from Aurangzeb demanding that should appear in Aurangzeb's court in the Deccan, Guru wrote back a spirited reply to Aurangzeb in Persian language, which is known as Zafarnama, meaning an 'epistle* of victory'. The Guru pricked Aurangazeb's conscience by pointing out how the Mughal army broke the oath taken on their holy book Quran. He recalled how the Mughal army of over 1 lakh soldiers could not succeed in capturing or killing him and that it was a moral victory for him. He warned Aurangzeb of the resolve of the Khalsa to not rest till the evil empire is destroyed. He also showed unflinching faith on the almighty in spite of losing his 4 beloved sons and his mother, along with his many of his fellow Sikh soldiers to the tyranny of Aurangzeb. The Guru rebuked Aurangzeb for his weaknesses as a human being and for the sins he committed as a king.

The Zafarnama is compiled along with Guru Gobind's masterpiece Dasama Granth (a collection of hymns). The Adi Granth was thus completed by the 10th Sikh Guru and it was declared as the guiding force for the Sikhs going forward-Guru Granth Sahib.

One of the popular verses of Zafarnama :

> Chun kar az hameh heelate dar guzasht, Halal ast burdan bi-shamsheer dast
>
> *Meaning : When all has been tried, yet justice is not in sight, it is then right to pick up the sword, it is then right to fight.*

Guru was hoping that he would meet Aurangzeb and would get Vazir Khan punished for his atrocities but received the news of Aurangzeb's death on 3 March 1707.

Cajole : Tempt/flatter **Epistle :** Letter

FINAL DAYS

After a year of journey, Guru reached a monastery of an ascetic named Madho Das Bairagi at Nanded, Maharashatra and decided to spend the rest of his life there, organising the Sikh forces. Guru accepted Madho Das into the Sikh fold and named him as Banda Singh Bahadur and gave him five arrows as a blessing for his future battles. Banda Singh reached Punjab to Punjab to continue the fight against tyranny of Vazir Khan, in August 1708, Vazir Khan hired two boys belonging to Pashtun tribe of Afghanistan to assassinate the Guru. The two secretly followed the Sikh camp, gained access inside the Guru's tent while he was alone and stabbed the Guru fatally. Although Guru was treated for the stab injury, his health deteriorated during October 1708. Realising that his end was nearing, Guru called upon his disciples and gave them the last instructions. He expressed satisfaction at the fulfilment of his mission. He entrusted the responsibility of the Khalsa to the Akal Purkh (God). He asserted that God had destined the Khalsa to be the future rulers of the country and for the realisation of this objective they must continue the struggle unabated. Thus ended a saga of sagacity, sacrifice and valour only to re-emerge in a different name and form.

Distance and Places traveled by the Guru, mapped on current day Google maps

ROAD TO SUPREMACY

MUSCLES OF IRON AND NERVES OF STEEL

Banda Singh Bahadur took over the mantle from Guru Gobind. He waged non-stop war against the Mughals starting from the Battle of Sonipat in the year 1709. Banda conquered the province of Samana (Patiala district of Punjab). He ordered his people to mint coins and brought financial stability. Samana was followed by areas along the Sutluj river. The Battle of Chappar Chiri fought on 12 May 1710 was one of the most important in the Sikh history. The Sikhs defeated the Mughals. Vazir Khan, responsible for the death of the entire family of Guru Gobind Singh was beheaded and the Sikhs established their first Raj (rule) in Punjab. Banda Singh established his capital at Lohgarh at Haryana. With this victory the entire stretch of land between river Sutlej and Delhi laid under the Khalsa, led by Banda Singh. Following this, Banda sent his Sikh army to Uttar Pradesh and brought places like Saharanpur, Jalalabad, Muzaffarnagar under his control. Banda also captured Sadaura in the state of Haryana and killed Nawab Usman Khan, a fanatic who imposed huge Jizya tax on Hindus.

Banda Singh Bahadur

BATTLE OF CHAPPAR CHIRI	
When? 12 May 1710	
Where? Near Sirhind	
Who were the combatants?	
Sikhs	Mughals
Who were the commanders?	
Banda Singh Bahadur	Vazir Khan
Outcome : Revenge extracted for martyrdom of Fateh and Zorawar Singh	
SIGNIFICANCE : Region between Sutlej and Delhi comes under Khalsa	

Banda was not only just a great military general and a conqueror but was also an able administrator. While ruling from Lohgarh, Banda Singh halted the zamindari System and brought an end to the corrupt and inefficient local administration that was prevalent until then. Banda Singh Bahadur met his end in June 1716.

TAKING THE MANTLE FORWARD

Many brave leaders emerged among the Sikhs who have left their mark on Bharat and its culture. Let us briefly understand the contributions of some of them.

Nawab Kapur Singh

NAWAB KAPUR SINGH

He is credited to have brought the Mughals to the negotiation table. By then, the Khalsa had disintegrated, but he reorganized the Khalsa into five groups (Misl). This enabled better governance. Later the five Misls increased to twelve.

JASSA SINGH AHLUWALIA

He formed alliances with other rulers of Bharat, like the Marathas, and mounted effective campaigns against the Durrani* kings. In the battle of Harnaulgarh, he defeated the Afghani forces led by the Durranis.

Delhi captured

In 1783, Sikhs under Jassa Singh and the leaders of two other Misls, namely **Baghel Singh** and **Jassa Singh** Ramgarhia attacked Delhi. They defeated the Mughal army at the Battle of Delhi, pulled down the Mughal flag from the Red Fort and hoisted the Nishan Sahib, the Sikh flag on it. They also detached the throne of Mughal emperor Aurangzeb, on which he ordered the death of Guru Tegh Bahadur, and kept it at the Golden Temple, Amritsar. Even today it is present at the Golden Temple known as Ramgarhia Bunga.

The veteran war leader Jassa Singh spent his last days renovating the city of Amritsar and reforming the Harmandir Sahib gurudwara.

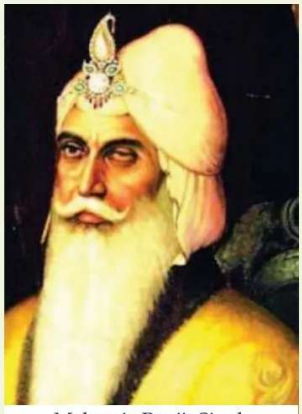
Jassa Singh Ahluwalia

PINNACLE OF GLORY - MAHARAJA RANJIT SINGH

Sukherchakia Misl, one of the 12 misls, was under the control of Maha Singh who died in 1792, leaving the responsibility of leading the Misl to his 12 year old son Ranjit Singh. After the death of Jassa Singh, the 12 Misls developed internal rivalry. However these Misls united in the event of external aggression by the Durranis of Afghanistan.

EARLY CONQUESTS AND PATH TO FAME

In 1797, Durrani king Zaman Shah tried to invade the Sikh territory under Ranjit Singh, who successfully defended the invasion. In 1798, the Afghan ruler sent in another army, which Ranjit Singh did not resist. He let them enter Lahore, then encircled them with his army, blocking off all food and supplies. Ranjit Singh burnt all crops and food sources that could have supported the Afghan army. Much of the Afghan army retreated to Afghanistan. In 1799 Ranjit Singh captured Lahore and Jammu and established his authority among the Sikh misls. He was proclaimed the Maharaja of Punjab in 1801. From thereon it was ceaseless expansion and glory for the next four decades.


Maharaja Ranjit Singh

Durrani : The Pashtun tribe (also known as Abdali) from Afghanistan

EXPANSION OF THE SIKH EMPIRE

Maharaja Ranjit Singh's Empire at its peak, 1839

Soon after becoming the Maharaja, Ranjit Singh paid homage to the holy Harmandir Sahib and vowed to renovate and rebuild it with marble and gold. He then embarked on an expansion spree, ably assisted by his commander **Hari Singh Nalwa**. Ranjit Singh first attacked and annexed Kasur that had been controlled by the Afghans. He then annexed Attock, Multan, Peshawar, Kashmir and other provinces of present day Pakistan and Afghanistan. More than fifteen major battles were waged and won by the Sikh army. In 1837, the Afghans under Dost Muhammad Khan made a final attempt at the battle of Jamrud, to recapture Peshawar. Hari Singh Nalwa led the battle and died a hero. By the end of the battle, the Afghans retreated to Kabul and Sikhs emerged victorious, By this time, the Sikh empire had expanded to the borders of Afghanistan in the north-west to the banks of river Sutlej in the south-east.

Meanwhile, the British had won over the Marathas after the third Anglo Maratha war of 1818. The British were wary of entering Punjab when Ranjit Singh was at the peak of his glory. At the same time, Ranjit Singh also considered it prudent to not engage in a war with the British. Hence the British and Ranjit Singh entered into an agreement through the **Treaty of Amritsar** in 1806. Through this agreement, Sutlej River was marked as the boundary and neither of them would cross the river to intrude into the other's territory.

DID YOU KNOW?

Hari Singh Nalwa ordered that after his death, his dead body was to be positioned outside the fort in view of the Afghan army so that the enemy army would think, Nalwa was still alive and witnessing the war. Mere sight of Nalwa would strike terror in the minds of the Afghan army men.

Orange House
Your knowledge Partner

SOCIAL CONDITIONS

Ranjit Singh's reign brought peace, order and security to the people living in his kingdom. He built several gurudwaras, temples and even mosques. He ensured that the public living in the conquered territories were not harmed and the places of worship were not damaged or attacked. As promised he laid a golden covering over the Harmandir Sahib. People of all faiths and caste lived in peace under Ranjit Singh's rule.

GOVERNANCE AND REFORMS

People from all religions and races were allowed to serve in Maharaj Ranjit Singh's army including some Europeans. He reorganised the army and equipped it with modern weaponry. He paid the members of the standing army from the treasury, instead of the Mughal method of paying an army out of the levies collected from local feudal chiefs. He also invested heavily on arms and weapons establishing manufacturing facilities for making cannons, gun powder, mining etc. The prosperity of the empire grew merely by improvement in the security situation, reduction in violence, reopened trade routes and greater freedom to conduct commerce.

DID YOU KNOW?

The Kohinoor diamond, went to the hands of the Durranis from the Mughals. After defeating the Durranis, Maharaja Ranjit Singh reclaimed the diamond and offered it to the Jagannatha Temple at Puri.

DID YOU KNOW?

In 1800, Ranjit Singh had installed a huge gate made out of sandalwood, carved with ivory and gold at the Amritsar Harmandir Sahib. This gate was seized from Afghanistan after his victory against them. Many historians believe that this gate was the one looted by Muhammad Ghazni from Somanth temple. After reclaiming the gate, Ranjit Singh offered it back to Somanth, but it could not be used as Somnath itself was in ruins. Ranjit Singh then decided to install the gate at the Harmandir Sahib.

DEATH AND DECLINE

After having established and expanded the Sikh empire to glory, Ranjit Singh died in his sleep on 27 June 1839. The vast and prosperous empire left by Ranjit Singh was not sustained or protected by his successors. His son Kharak Singh was an able and a generous person. However, his council of ministers who corrupt. Poisoned him to death in 1840. After Kharak Singh, the Sikh empire was mired by internal rivalry. The British saw this as an opportune moment to annexe the empire. Two wars called the Anglo-Sikh wars were fought between the British and the disintegrating Sikh empire. Eventually, the Sikhs lost to the British in 1849 and the empire was annexed to British India.

CONCLUSION

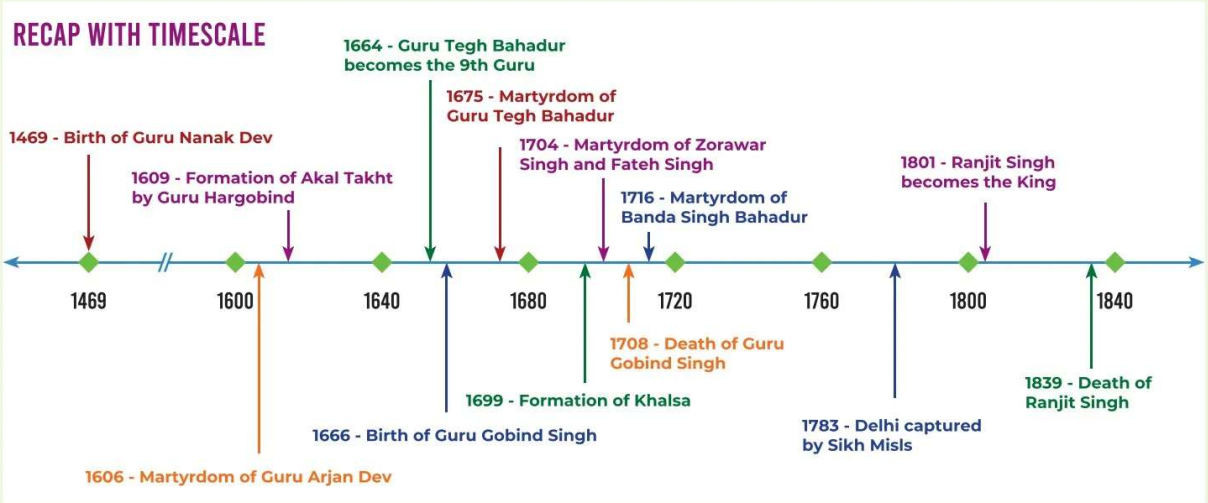
The lives and deeds of the ten Sikh gurus and their followers leave an indelible impression of valour and sacrifice in the pages of history. The philosophical foundation laid by Guru Nanak Dev and steadfast commitment of his successors to the cause of Dharma putting up with the physical torture and loss of lives of the family members make us wonder as to where they derive their strength from. What would have happened to the cultural and civilizational fabric of Bharat, had there been no wall of the Sikh khalsas to withstand the Mughal and the Durrani onslaught of religious persecutions and conversions? This certainly needs to be contemplated.

****

KEYWORDS

- Sri Guru Nanak
- Langar
- Harmandir Sahib
- Amritsar
- Guru Ram Das
- Guru Arjan Dev
- Akal Takht
- Bhai Mati Das
- Soldier Saint
- Guru Gobind Singh
- Khalsa, Martyr
- Veer Bal Diwas
- Fateh & Zorawar Singh
- Delhi captured
- Ranjit Singh

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Sri Nanak was born in Rai Bhoi ki Talvandi village situated in present day _____
   a) Bharat b) Iran c) Pakistan d) Bangladesh
2. The word 'Sikh' is derived from the Sanskrit word 'sishya' that means _____.
   a) the blessed b) the learner c) the dutiful d) the dancer
3. Guru Ram Das created the city of _____.
   a) Jalandhar b) Amritsar c) Patiala d) Ludhiana
4. _____ completed construction of the Harmandir Sahib.
   a) Guru Arjan Dev b) Guru Angad c) Guru Nanak d) Guru Ram Das
5. Guru Hargovind established the _____ opposite to the Harmandir Sahib
   a) Guru Sar b) Akal Takht c) Khalsa d) Langar
6. _____ was the 9th Sikh guru.
   a) Guru Har Rai b) Guru Har Kishan c) Guru Tegh Bahadur d) Guru Hargovind
7. _____, king of the Sikh empire, was responsible for the significant expansion of the empire in the late 18th and early 19th century.
   a) Baghel Singh b) Zorawar Singh c) Gobind Singh d) Ranjit Singh

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. What are the three guidelines for life professed by Sri Guru Nanak?
2. What is the holy book of the Sikhs? Explain.
3. Why was Guru Arjan Dev martyred?
4. Where and why was Guru Sar built?
5. How did Guru Har Rai popularize the Guru Granth Sahib?
6. Who were the Panch Pyare?
7. What were the last instructions of Guru Gobind Singh?

Orange House
Your knowledge Partner

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Explain in detail the reasons for Guru Hargobind to be called a 'soldier saint'.
2. What is Khalsa? How was it formed?
3. When is Veer Bal Diwas celebrated and what does it signify?
4. What is Zafarnama? Explain.
5. Discuss the contributions of Jassa Singh Ahluwalia.
6. Elaborate on the governance and reforms instituted by Maharaja Ranjit Singh.

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

a) Vazir Khan beheaded b) Nawab Kapur Singh reorganizes Khalsa into five groups
c) Formation of Khalsa d) Pandit Kripa Ram Das approaches the Guru
e) Ranjit Singh captures Lahore

CASE STUDY

"Aurangazeb killed his three disciples, Bhai Mati Das, Bhai Sati Das and Bhai Dayala Das, in a gruesome way in front of his eyes. Yet the Guru did not breakdown. The Guru who witnessed the killing of his disciples with unperturbed calmness was then beheaded on 11 November 1675."

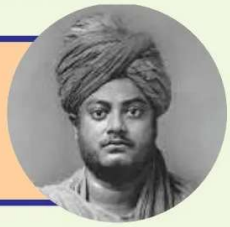
1. Who is the Guru we are talking about?
2. Why were the disciples killed?

Chapter 9

THE EASTERN KINGDOMS

I discard the idea that India was ever passive .

- Swami Vivekananda



LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Describe about the Eastern Ganga kingdoms and their contributions in the field of architecture.
- Appreciate the bravery of the Ahoms and their contributions to Bharat.
- List out a few marvels of north-eastern Bharat.

INTRODUCTION

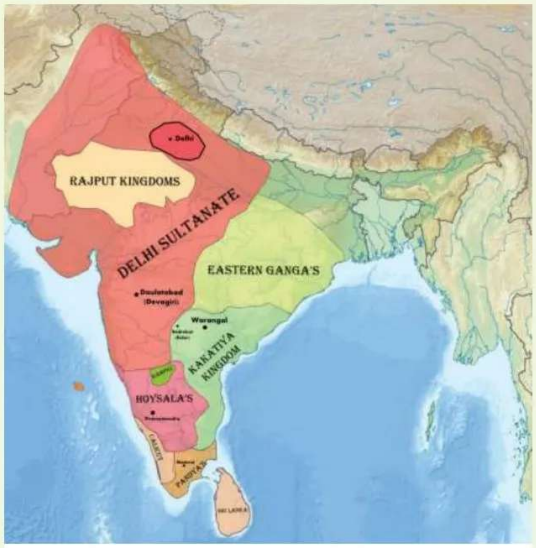
The northern parts of Bharat had come under the rule of the Mamluks by the 12th century and the Delhi Sultanate had been established. While there were many kingdoms that were taken over, kingdoms like the Eastern Ganga valiantly resisted these invasions. The Eastern Ganga kingdom consisted of today's Odisha, portions of southern Bengal and northern Andhra Pradesh. Cuttack served as the capital of the Eastern Ganga kingdom.

THE EASTERN GANGA RULERS AND BEYOND

In 1238 CE, Narasimhadeva I took over the throne of Odisha. His reign till 1264 CE was filled with glory for Odisha. His administration of the kingdom and military policy are considered an extraordinary period in Odisha's history.

The Eastern Ganga kingdom attained great heights in strength and respect. Narasimhadeva I was also world renowned for building the Sun temple in Konark that had Suryadeva (Sun God) as the presiding deity.

The temple is made of stone and in the form of a huge chariot drawn by horses. There are 24 wheels that are carved in the temple complex. These wheels are actually sun dials. Each wheel has 8 major spokes that divides the 24 hours in a day. Hence, the time span between two major spokes is 3 hours. There are 8 minor spokes that run in the middle of two major spokes. Thus the time span between a major spoke and a minor spoke is 90 minutes.



Bharat in 1325 CE

At the edge of the wheel there are many beads and there are exactly 30 beads between a major spoke and a minor spoke. Thus, each bead is equivalent to 3 minutes. Each bead is large enough for our eye to see if the shadow is falling at the centre of the bead or at its ends.

Thus we can calculate time accurately to one minute. If you were to place a pen at the tail of the animal in the axle, the shadow will fall on the edge of the wheel. Note the bead where the shadow falls and calculate the time!

Sun Temple, Konark

Wheel of time-Sun Temple, Konark

Sun Temple, Konark

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Each wheel in the Konark Sun temple are sun dials. Did you understand how people were able to tell time using the sun dial? Now, create a sun dial and attempt to tell the time to an accuracy of 1 minute.

GROWTH OF THE EMPIRE UNDER NARASIMHADEVA I

In 1234 CE, Narasimhadeva attacked northern Radha (current day Bengal) which was under the Delhi Sultanate. Tugril Khan was the governor of the state. Terrified by the advance of Narasimhadeva I, Tugril Khan launched a counter-offensive on Narasimhadeva's forces. They were forced to retreat to their frontier fort of Katasin. This was a well calculated move by Narasimhadeva I. The fort was well built and surrounded by dense forests. Narasimhadeva I further fortified the place by digging trenches that slowed down the advancing armies of Tugril Khan. Tugril Khan chased down Narasimhadeva's forces to Katasin. Thinking that he had the upper hand he was resting in the forest areas around Katasin, when Narasimhadeva's forces launched guerilla attacks on the Islamic forces and routed them. The Radha province of Bengal was captured.

Tugril Khan sought help from Delhi, Awadh and other regions to counter Narasimhadeva. They all responded by coming to Odisha and laying siege to Rajmahal hills. Narasimhadeva I launched a fierce attack on the joint forces in Lakhnauti and drove the enemies out of the region. The provinces of Rarh and Varendra were taken over by Narasimhadeva I. Narasimhadeva I ensured that he drove the enemy forces out from Rajmahal hills. Thus, Bengal was no longer a threat to Odisha. Narasimhadeva I's aggressive and successful campaigns against the invading forces greatly saved northern Bharat.

Lakhnauti Fort

AFTER NARASIMHADEVA I

By 1264 CE, the great rule of Narasimhadeva I came to an end. It was from the time of Narasimhadeva I that the Ganga rulers adopted the title of Gajapati probably due to the large regiment of elephants that they had in their army. After Narasimhadeva, Bhanudeva I took over the throne followed by Narasimha II. Narasimha II's reign was relatively peaceful and he was able to expand the trade and commerce of his kingdom leading to a period of prosperity till 1306 CE. Narasimha II was succeeded by his son Bhanudeva II. The Ganga empire shrunk during his times. Iliyas Shah, the sultan of Bengal invaded Odisha and slaughtered people. He ransacked the famous Puri Jagannath temple and carried away a great amount of wealth including 44 elephants. Successive rulers of the dynasty could not take on the Sultans of Delhi and Bengal and the royal family was in shambles.

Jagannath Temple, Puri

44 elephants in today's money value is about Rs. 220 lakhs

DID YOU KNOW?

BEGINNING OF GAJAPATI KINGDOM

The last ruler of the Eastern Ganga empire was king Bhanudeva IV. He was in constant battle with the neighboring kingdoms of Reddis and Vijayanagara. This made Bhanudeva to go south to combat against the Vijayanagara forces. His long absence in Cuttack led his ministers to raise a new ruler – Kapilendra – and installed him on the throne in 1434 CE. This marked the beginning of the Gajapatis of Odisha.

RAJA KAPILENDRA

Gajapati Kapilendradeva, Kapileshwar Temple Bhubaneshwar

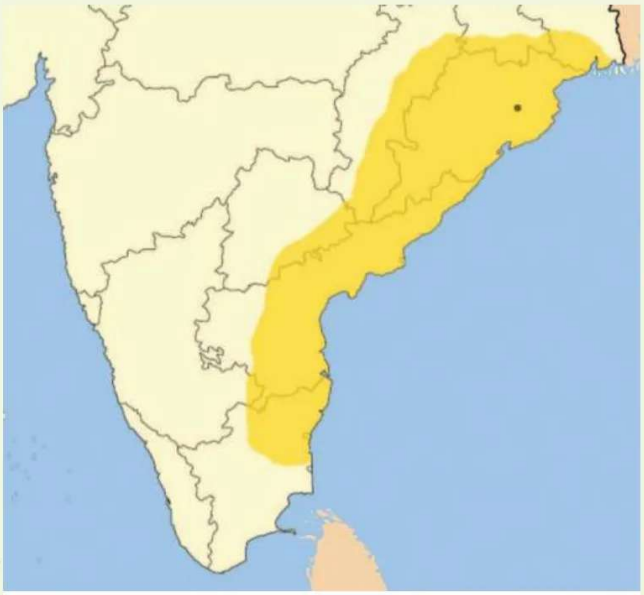
Kapilendra immediately set out on consolidating and expanding the influence of his kingdom. By 1443 CE, he captured Vishakapatnam district, Godavari delta and Kondavidu. Kapilendra was also able to capture territories in Bengal including the Mandaran fort in Hooghly.

Odisha saw its common folks massacred and temples destroyed by Mahmud Shah, ruler of Jaunpur, around 1445 CE. The Bahmani ruler also kept fighting over the Telangana border regions that greatly troubled Kapilendra.

Southern Bharat 1400 CE

FURTHER EXPANSION OF THE KINGDOM

The Bahmani forces attacked Devarakonda, the stronghold of the Velamas. The Velamas appealed to Kapilendra who sent his eldest son Hamvira to assist the Velamas. Hamvira and his army descended upon the Bahmani army and thoroughly defeated them. They were pursued by the brave Hamvira into the desert regions. The Bahmani army resources, elephants and horses were taken over by Hamvira. In 1461 CE, Humayun Shah died and was succeeded by his son Nizam shah who was just 8 years old. Kapilendra seized this opportunity and advanced into the Bahmani kingdom and reached within ten miles of their capital.



Gajapati kingdom under Kapilendradeva

Hamvira set out and conquered Udayagiri and then Chandragiri. He then moved towards the south to reach Kanchi and the Cauvery delta in 1464 CE.

Kapilendra was able to reach till Vijayawada and around 1467 CE passed away. Under Kapilendra, Odisha stretched from the lower Ganga in the north to Kaveri in the south. Before his death, Kapilendra had nominated his younger son, Purushottama, to succeed him.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Map the growth of the kingdom under Kapilendra by following the sequence of regions captured by him.

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DECLINE OF EASTERN GANGA EMPIRE

The Bahmani sultan Muhammad III invaded Odisha after 1471 CE. The attack was swift and Purushottama was forced to purchase peace through tributes and wealth. Muhammad also advanced against Hamvira at Kondavidu. Hamvira was forced to surrender. Muhammad III died in 1482. This helped Purushottama to reconquer Udayagiri and maintain the peace till his death in 1497 CE.

Shrewd and effective in military matters, Kapilendra may have missed the need to develop alliances with the Vijayanagara rulers to combat the rulers of Bengal and the Deccan. Infact the hostilities with Vijayanagara and the Bengal and Bahmani sultans proved to be the reason for the kingdom's decline.

AHOMS

THE GEOGRAPHY

In 13th century Assam, the Kamarupa kingdom continued under different rulers and names. The Karatoya river in Bengal formed its western boundary. The eastern boundary changed from time to time. The frontiers of Assam was very fragmented and under many independent chiefs called **Baro Bhuyas**.

The eastern part of Assam was getting consolidated by the Shan tribe who were known as the **Ahoms**. They were growing by assimilating into the local population and growing into a large community. There were also many small princely states, especially the **Cacharis** and **Chutiyas**.

The Chutiya kingdom extended between the Subarnasri river and Disang river. The Ahoms were keen to integrate the Chutiya kingdom into their fold and were successful after a few battles Southwest of the Chutiya kingdom lay the Cachari kingdom which extended from the Brahmaputra river till the Dhansiri river.

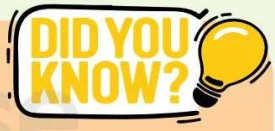
The Kamata kingdom in the west (sometimes referred to as Kamarupa by Muslim chroniclers) and the Ahom kingdom in the east were the primary kingdoms that were sizeable and powerful.

CONSOLIDATION OF KAMATA AND AHOM

Under the Kamata king **Durlabh Narayan**, the kingdom is recorded to have flourished in the late 13th century. However there were constant battles with the Ahoms. To get over the fighting, an alliance between the two kingdoms was cemented by the marriage of the Kamata princess Bhajani with the Ahom king Sukhangpha.

There were some regions in the southern part of Kamarupa including Mymensingh and Sylhet that were under the rule of **Dharina Narayan**, a cousin of Durlabh Narayan. The regions under his control were attacked by the Bengal sultan and Sylhet was captured in 1303 CE. Using Sylhet as a base a few other regions like Chittagong and Tippera (Tripura) were annexed.

Despite these invasions, by the early 15th century Kamata regained its glory under the Khens who were native to the region. **Nilambara** was one of the most powerful rulers of Kamata. He is credited with having constructed a highway between his capital city of Kamatapur and Ghoraghat (Rangpur district). Under his leadership the kingdom was extensive and included the geographical areas mentioned in the introduction including Goalpiara, Kamarupa, Sylhet and Mymensingh.



This great king Nilambara had fought two powerful sultans of Bengal, Ruknuddin Barbak Shah and Alauddin Husain Shah and successfully defended the kingdom.

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THE EARLY AHOM RULERS AND THEIR GROWTH

Between 1215 CE and 1293 CE, the Ahoms were ruled by **Sukapha** followed by **Suteupha** and then **Subinpha**. They were able to establish the Ahom kingdom and govern a consolidated region in Assam.

In the late 13th century, Sukhangpha married tha Kamata princess and the kingdoms became strong allies. After the death of Sukhangpha, his three sons ruled the kingdom between 1332 and 1389. Besides a worsening relationship with the Chutiyas, this period was relatively uneventful.

AHOMS AND KAMATA UNITE AGAINST INVADERS

In 1397 CE, Sudangpha started his reign and established his capital at Charguya near the Dihing river. During this time there were some hostilities with the Kamata king. The sultan of Bengal Ghiyasudin Azam Shah wanted to use the rift between the Ahoms and Kamata and tried to invade Kamata. Ahom and Kamata set aside their differences and joined hands and drove Ghiyasudin and his armies beyond the Karatoya borders.

AHOM KINGDOM EXPANDS ITS BORDERS

The Ahom kingdom had many rulers till 1497 CE when Suhungmung took over the leadership. Sunhungmung assumed the name of Svarga Narayan. Key changes in the Ahom region effected during Svarga Narayan's rule include:

- The capital was shifted from Charguya to Bakata.
- The Aitonia Naga kingdom was defeated and they paid tributes to the Ahoms.
- Between 1513 and 1523, there was prolonged fight with the Chutiya kingdom at the end of which the Ahoms won over the Chutiyas.

Ahom kingdom 16th century CE

- In 1526 CE, Svarga Narayan led an army against the Cachari kingdom. He reached deep into the Cachari kingdom. By 1531 CE Svarga Narayan reached Dimapur, the capital city of the Cacharis. The Ahoms established complete control over the Cacharis.

AHOMS VS THE SULTAN OF BENGAL

In 1527 CE, the sultan of Bengal Nusrat Shah advanced towards the Ahom territory. The Ahoms fought bravely and defeated them. The Ahoms drove out their enemies past the Burai river capturing many weapons, artillery and resources.

In 1532 CE, Turbak Khan led a large force to the Ahom kingdom and took control over some of the key forts of the Ahoms. The Ahoms reinvented their war strategy. Turbak Khan was getting his supply of soldiers, weapons, food and other resources from Gauda kingdom (Bengal) in a way that cut off the supply of these resources.

BATTLE OF LAKHNAUTI	
When?	1533 CE
Where?	Duimunsila, Kaliabar, Assam
Who were the combatants?	
Ahoms	Bengal and Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Suhungmung, Tonkham	Turbak Khan
Outcome : Turbak Khan loses	
SIGNIFICANCE : For the first time, Ahoms use modern firearms. Mughals and Bengal Sultanate never return to the region for a long period.	

Turbak Khan knew that his supply lines were compromised but pushed forward into Ahom territory. The Ahoms starved the supply lines of Turbak's army and then conducted guerilla attacks. These guerilla attacks kept reducing the number of soldiers in Turbak's army. Now that the Ahoms had further weakened Turbak's army, the battle of Lakhnauti took place in Duimunsila. The Ahom naval power actively targeted Turbak's army and naval fleet, resulting in Turbak Khan's forces losing 22 ships, numerous weapons, and thousands of soldiers in the confrontation.

Weapons, a large quantity of gold and silver, guns, elephants and horses were captured by the Ahoms.

Svarga Narayan (Suhungmung) was one of the greatest Ahom rulers who successfully resisted the invaders while also expanding his kingdom. Unfamiliar with the firearms of the invaders, the Ahoms compensated for this military gap by employing traditional weapons like swords, spears, bows, and local armaments. Upon acquiring firearms, they swiftly learned their use, bolstering their defensive capabilities.

MULA GABHARU

In 1533 CE, when the Ahoms were fighting against the forces of Turbak Khan, there was an Ahom commander called **Phrasengmung Borgohain**. Borgohain is a title given by the Ahom king and it signifies that he was second in rank in the council of ministers. During the battle with Turbak Khan Phrasengmung was killed by Turbak using treachery. This demoralized the Ahom forces. Sensing this, Mula Gabharu, Phrasengmung's wife, stepped into the battlefield and started striking terror in the ranks of Turbak's army. The Ahom army fought again with renewed energy as Mula Gabharu went around the battlefield fighting valorously. Over the next couple of days Mula Gabharu killed some of Turbak's key lieutenants. Mula Gabharu laid down her life in the battlefield fighting for Bharat's freedom from invaders.

People of Assam celebrate **Mulagabhoru Day** every year on the 29th of May.

The great historian R.C.Majumdar notes, "He (Suhungmung) extended the power of the Ahoms in all directions, and his valiant resistance to the Muslims gave immunity to Assam from further Muslim aggression for 130 years."

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

The Ahoms under Svarga Narayan adopted a process of assimilation whenever they conquered new territories. When the Chutiya kingdom was taken over, many families from the Ahom kingdom were resettled in some regions of the other kingdom. Similarly many families from the Chutiya kingdom were settled in the Ahom regions.

Why do you think this was done? Discuss.

BATTLE OF SARAIGHAT

MUGHALS EYE ASSAM

The Ahom kingdom flourished. After Svarga Narayan's victory over invaders, Assam was quite peaceful. There were regular attempts by the Mughals and their vassals in Bengal to invade Assam but were driven away. The Koch kingdom lay between the Ahoms and the Mughals and when Koch got into an alliance with the Mughals, the Ahoms were attacked again. After 1658 CE, Aurangzeb took over the Mughal throne and wanted to occupy the whole of Assam. Frequent conflicts culminated in a major showdown between the Ahoms and the Mughals at Saraighat in 1671 CE.

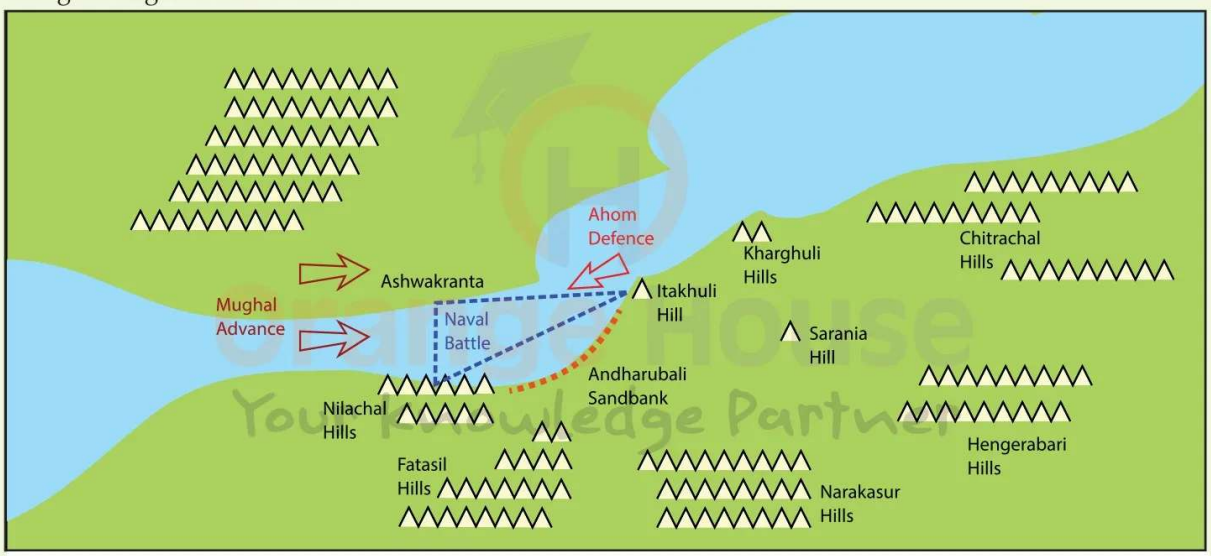
Lachit Borpukhan

SARAIGHAT - THE BATTLEGROUND

The Mughals ordered Ram Singh to head their very large army of more than 40,000 infantry and 20,000 cavalry. The Ahoms ruled by Raja Chakradwaj Singha appointed Lachit Borpukhan as the commander in chief of the Ahoms army. This battle was very unique because besides being fought on land, it was primarily fought in the Brahmaputra river.

PLANNING AND PREPARATION

The Mughal forces greatly outnumbered the small Ahom army. Lachit was very familiar with the topography of his homeland. The rains and slushy mountain slopes near Guwahati worked well for Lachit's guerilla style warfare. He attacked the Mughals when they least expected and quickly retreated into the mountains. The Mughals had a large navy made up of large boats filled with warriors. The Ahoms and Lachit knew the river systems very well and constructed many forts and posts at key places along the river, especially at the points where the river was narrow. The Ahoms ensured that these forts provided a significant defence against the invading Mughals. Lachit made mud embankments so that the Mughal navy couldn't traverse some of the shallow portions of the river. A ring of defence posts were constructed around the hills to protect Guwahati. Near present day Guwahati, the Brahmaputra is at its narrowest. Lachit used this point to cutoff and guard against the invaders.



Battle of Saraighat

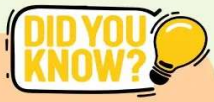
SMOOTH EXECUTION

Lachit knew the flow, depth and narrowness of the river and had different tactics to take on the Mughal navy at the different places. The Mughal navy had 40 large war boats with more than 15 guns in each boat manned by Mughal and European sailors. The Ahom navy was designed with small, nimble boats on which small guns/canons were fixed. While this meant that the Ahom boats had to be in close range of the Mughal boats to fire, their boats could easily navigate through the narrow parts of the river. Lachit had converted the entire river system into a large arena for the battle. With the guerilla attacks in the mountains and sharp attacks in the river using the nimble canon mounted Ahom navy, they made the Mughals suffer.

BATTLE OF SARAIGHAT	
When?	March 1671 CE
Where?	Brahmaputra river, Saraighat, Assam
Who were the combatants?	
Ahoms	Mughals
Who were the commanders?	
Chakradwaj Singha, Lachit Borpukhan	Ram Singh
Outcome : Ahom victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Ahoms reestablish their power around Guwahati	

UNEXPECTED CHALLENGE

At a crucial juncture, Lachit fell sick. The Mughals tried to use this to their advantage, but Lachit immediately entered the battle and lifted the morale of the Ahoms. His effective navigation through the river and orders to his skilled sailors trumped the Mughal navy. The Ahoms drove the Mughals out and pursued them past the Manas river. Completely routed and having suffered great losses of men and resources the Mughals met their match at the hands of the Ahoms under the leadership of Lachit Borpukhan.



It is said that Lachit Borphukan had ordered his uncle to complete a key fortification task to protect Guwahati by the next morning. When Lachit inspected it in the morning and found it unfinished, he ordered his uncle to be beheaded for not having done his duty to protect Guwahati. This place is called Momai Kota Garh.

Aurangzeb could never see Assam under Mughal rule. The Ahoms had successfully thwarted Mughal invasions till the very end.

FROM THE LAND OF TWIPRA (TRIPURA)

The history of the land of Tripura dates to a very early age. Originating in the confluence of the Brahmaputra, Meghna and Surma rivers (in present-day Bangladesh), Tripura has produced some great rulers who have co-existed with the Ahoms. The ancient rulers of Tripura carried the title "pha" that means "father". A 15th century chronicle called the "Rajmala" traces the entire line of rulers of Tripura.

In the 14th century, the kings adopted the title of "Manikya" and this continues till today. In this lineage came one of the greatest kings of the Manikya dynasty, **Vijaya Manikya II**. In 1532, Vijaya Manikya was placed on the throne by the powerful army general Daityanarayana. Daityanarayana intended to rule Tripura using Vijaya Manikya as a puppet. Vijaya Manikya II had Daityanarayana killed and regained power. For the next 26 years he expanded the kingdom. The Cacharis, Jaintiyas that were the neighbouring kingdoms paid tributes to Vijaya Manikya. On seeing his growing power, the sultan of Bengal attacked Tripura. Adopting guerilla style warfare, the large armies of the Bengal sultan were defeated. On his victory, Vijaya Manikya II paid his respects to the family deity of the Manikya kings called the temple of the Fourteen Gods (Chaturdasha Devata). This temple is situated in Udaipur in Tripura

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UNAKOTI - A MYSTERIOUS MARVEL

The famous bas relief structures of Unakoti are located close to Kailashahar, Tripura. Unakoti means "one less than a crore". Legends say that there are 99,99,999 rock cut images of gods and goddesses in the hills of this region of Tripura.

Archaeologists date some of these bas relief structure to be between the 7th and 13th century although there exists many undiscovered sculptures in the hills of the region.

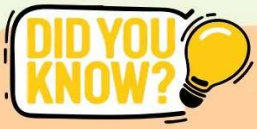
Shiva's sculpture, Unakoti Tripura

Sculpture of Ganesha, Unakoti Tripura

MANIPUR - AHOM'S NEIGHBOUR

THE WORLD'S LARGEST ALL WOMEN MARKET

Further away from the Ahom kingdom was the region of Manipur. A unique symbol of Manipur's history is the Ima Keithel. Ima Keithel translates to "mother's market". What is so special about this market? This is the world's largest all-women market where more than 5,000 traders have their stalls. This was not a market started now. This market dates to the 16th century.



Sagol Kangei originated in Manipur. Sagol means "pony" and Kangei means "game of sticks". King Kangba invented the game before the Common Era. The first polo match was organized by King Nongda Pakhangba in 33 CE. This game is deeply entrenched in the culture of Manipur. It is played during the Manipuri Meitei festival of Lai Haraoba. The Marjing temple is dedicated to the God of Horses, Iboudou Marjing. Marjing is not just God of horses and war but also of polo!

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CONCLUSION

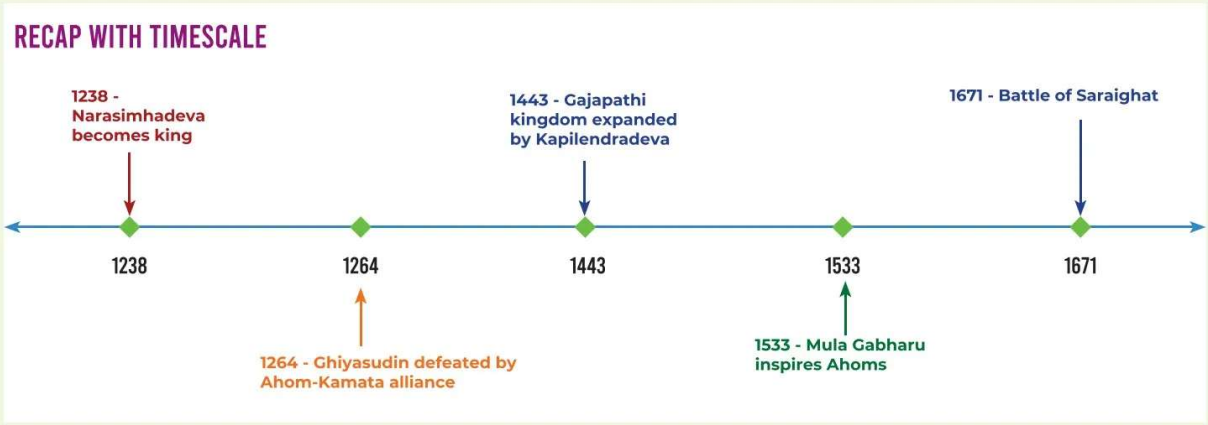
The eastern and north-eastern empires of Bharat had great and brave rulers who protected the nation from external aggressors. The Eastern Ganga rulers rendered stupendous service to the nation giving Bharat great architectural marvels. The Ahoms were able to stave away the invaders for more than 500 years. The resilience of the people of these regions have helped in a thriving culture that has survived time. The mighty Brahmaputra that flows in the region has seen some of the fiercest battles including the battle of Saraighat that revealed a hero - Lachit Borpukhan. Western powers were to gain strength in the coming years and eastern Bharat was to experience new challenges.

****

KEYWORDS

- Eastern Ganga
- Narasimhadeva I
- Konark
- Tugril Khan
- Gajapati
- Musunuri Nayaks
- Puri Jagannath Temple
- Iliyas Shah
- Reddis
- Raja Kapilendra
- Vishakapatnam
- Hamvira
- Udayagiri. Ahoms
- Manikya
- Kamata
- Tripura,Sukapha
- Suhungmung
- Mula Gabharu
- Ima Keithel
- Battle of Saraighat
- Ram Singh
- Lachit Borpukhan
- Brahmaputra

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. _____ served as the capital of the Eastern Ganga kingdom.
   a) Amer b) Cuttack c) Sambalpur d) Balasore
2. In 1238 CE, _____ became the ruler of the Eastern Ganga kingdom.
   a) Bhanudeva I b) Narasimhadeva I c) Kumaradeva I d) Naradeva
3. From the time of Narasimhadeva I, the rulers of the Eastern Ganga kingdom adopted the title of:
   a) Raja b) Maharaja c) Gajapati d) Rashtrapati
4. Narasimha II was assisted by _____ when he was a young prince.
   a) Narahari Tirtha b) Raja Tirtha c) Sumaka d) Iliyas Shah
5. The Puri Jagannath temple was ransacked by _____ during the time of Narasimhadeva III.
   a) Ibrahim Lodi b) Iliyas Shah c) Sikandar Shah d) Jorhat Shah
6. Bhanudeva was freed from the hold of the Malwa sultan _____.
   a) Hushang b) Boryang c) Nepri d) Floyung
7. True or False:
   Statement A: Turbak Khan lost against the Ahom forces in the battle of Lakhnauti
   Statement B: Ahoms used fire-arms to win over Turbak Khan in the battle of Lakhnauti
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
8. Which Ahom king assumed the title Svarga Narayan
   a) Sudangpha b) Suhungmung c) Sukapha d) Suteupha
9. Sangol Kangei means _____
   a) A dish cooked with sticks b) A song played with sticks
   c) Game of sticks played on a pony d) War tactics using sticks seated on a pony

NAME THE DYNASTY OF THE FOLLOWING PEOPLE

- Vijaya Manikya II
- Raja Chakradwaj Sinha
- Ram Singh
- Bhajani
- Mula Gabharu
- Svarg Narayan
- Durlabh Narayan

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ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who was the governor of Bengal during the time of Narasimhadeva II?
2. What led to the beginning of the Gajapati rule in Odisha?
3. Who is Nilambara and what are his achievements?
4. How did Mula Gabharu inspire the Ahom army?
5. Why was the Sultan of Bengal Ghiyasudin Azam Shah not able to take over Kamata kingdom?
6. What is special about the Ima Keithal?
7. Why did the Tripura kings add 'pha' to their titles?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Explain the method of finding time using the wheel in the Konark sun temple.
2. How did Narasimhadeva I expand his kingdom?
3. What led to the shattering of the power and prestige of the Eastern Ganga royal family?
4. Who contributed to the expansion of the Gajapati kingdom? Cite examples and explain
5. How did the Ahoms defeat the large army and naval force of Turbak Khan? What was the outcome of this battle?
6. What happened at the battle of Saraighat? What tactics did Lachit Borpukan use to drive away the mighty Mughals?

CASE STUDY

The Mughals and Ahoms faced off at Saraighat. The Mughal navy had 40 large war boats with more than 15 guns in each boat manned by Mughal and European sailors.The Ahom navy was designed with small, nimble boats on which small guns/canons. The Mughals ordered Ram Singh to head their very large army of more than 40,000 infantry and 20,000 cavalry. The Mughal forces greatly outnumbered the small Ahom army. But, the Ahoms were heavily reliant on guerilla warfare.

1. Were the large battleships of the Mughals helpful in the battle? How did the nimble boats add to the Ahoms' advantage?
2. How did the small army of the Ahoms match up to the massive army led by Ram Singh?
3. Did the geography of Saraighat influence the battle?

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Chapter 10

FROM RESILIENCE TO RESURGENCE

"Hindu Marathas or Musalmans behave as per the traditions of their caste or community, do not discriminate against them. The kingdom should not discriminate on the basis of each person's faith or his deity."

- Nanasaheb Peshwa in 1761

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Describe the importance of Maharana Raj Singh in Bharat's fight against the Mughals
- Describe the Mughal-Rajput war and Mughal-Maratha war and their consequences
- Explain the expansion of Marathas under Peshawas
- Examine the causes and consequences of the Third Battle of Panipat

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INTRODUCTION

Seventeenth century Bharat suffered unprecedented religious persecutions and tyranny at the hands of the Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb. Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj challenged Aurangzeb and successfully established the Maratha Empire in 1674. During the same time, Maharana Raj Singh of Sisodia dynasty, the fourth generation successor of Maharana Pratap of Mewar was on a campaign against the Mughals in Rajputana. Raj Singh's successful missions and Shivaji's vision brought about the end of Mughals in the next few decades.

RAJPUTS - RESISTANCE CONTINUES

SISODIAS AFTER RANA PRATAP

After the death of Maharana Pratap during a hunting expedition, his son Amar Singh became the ruler of Mewar in 1597. He was a valorous king and a worthy successor of Maharana Pratap. After Akbar, his son Jahangir made several attempts to conquer Mewar. But Amar Singh remained undefeated. Mughals were forced to make a treaty with Mewar in 1615. After decades of warfare, peace and order got restored in Mewar under **Amar Singh**. Amar Singh's successors Karan Singh and Jagat Singh made several administrative reforms and strengthened the defense. Mewar prospered. Jagat Singh's son **Maharana Raj Singh** ascended the throne in 1652. In 1658, Aurangzeb arrested his father, killed his brothers and occupied the Mughal throne.

Maharana Amar Singh

Maharana Raj Singh

RAJ SINGH'S ONSLAUGHT ON MUGHALS

Destruction of temples, imposition of Jizya and mass conversion of Hindu men and enslavement of Hindu women by Aurangzeb irked Raj Singh. He decided to take the Mughals head-on. He ravaged the Mughal posts and took them under his control. He defied Aurangzeb by not paying Jizya. Raj Singh attacked and conquered states that were under Mughal authority. He then moved out of Rajputana and raided the regions in Gujarat and Malwa.

THINK!!!

When Aurangzeb demanded Jizya from Shivaji Maharaj, he challenged the Badshah to first attempt collecting Jizya from Maharana Raj Singh. If the Rana paid, he was willing to oblige. Imagine how audacious Raj Singh must have been that a tyrant like Aurangzeb feared him.

RAJ SINGH RESCUES CHARUMATI

Kishangarh was a small village near Mewar ruled by Roop Singh. He had an extremely beautifiul daughter named Charumati. When the fame of her beauty reached the ears of Aurangzeb, he ordered Charumati's family members to get her married to him. Fearing Aurangzeb, Roop Singh accepted. But Charumati firmly rejected the proposal. Since she did not receive any help from her family, she wrote to Rana Raj Singh and sought to marry him. Upon knowing this, Raj Singh decided to rescue the girl. He commanded one of his generals Ratan Singh to intercept the Mughal army that was approaching Kishangarh to take away Charumati. Raj Singh rescued Charumati and married her.

HADI RANI

While on his mission to rescue Charumati, Ratan Singh did not focus on the war since he was always thinking of his newly married wife Hadi Rani. He sent emissaries to his wife and asked her to send some gift as a token of her love and memory. On two occasions the Rani gave her ring and her fragrant handkerchief. When the third emissary came, she realised that her husband was engrossed in thinking about her and was not focused on the war. She knew that it was a crucial war, and Rana Raj Singh's safety rested in defending the invaders. She decided to change Ratan's attitude. She instructed her attendants to take her severed head as a gift in a plate covered by a red cloth and beheaded herself. The plate was delivered to Ratan Singh. He opened it he was shocked to see Hadi Rani's severed head. He understood the message and got ready for the final assault. Free from all bondage, Ratan went on a rampage and decimated the army before laying down his life. The resistance he posed, offered the time needed for Raj Singh to rescue Charumati.

RAJ SINGH RESCUES SHRINATHJI

Aurangzeb issued an order to the priests of the famous Srinathji temple at Mathura - that they should demonstrate a miracle of the Lord to prove the Lord's divinity. He threatened to destroy the temple and break the Lord's murthi if they failed. The priests decided to shift the murthi away from Mathura and requested Rana Raj Singh's support in offering shelter. Inspite of knowing that it would invite Aurangzeb's wrath, Raj Singh readily accepted to offer state protection to the Lord. On hearing this, Aurangzeb got furious and wrote to Raj Singh, forbidding him from giving protection to the Lord and the priests. He warned of dire consequences. Raj Singh completely ignored the threat and offered a village near Udaipur to the priests

Lord Shrinathji

to reinstall Srinathji. He mobilized a huge army to defend the new temple and also sought the support of neighboring kings. Aurangzeb didn't dare to engage in a war with Mewar.

RAJ SINGH RESCUES AJIT SINGH

Marwar was the neighbouring kingdom of Mewar. The kings of Marwar remained loyal to the Mughals since the times of Akbar. When Raj Singh was the ruler of Mewar, Marwar was under Jaswant Singh. At the time of his death in 1678, Jaswant Singh had no living heirs, but soon, his wife gave birth to a son posthumously*. Marwar was without a ruler. Aurangzeb exploited the situation and moved Jaswant Singh's family to Delhi. He wanted to convert them to Islam and acquire the kingdom of Marwar. **Veer Durgadas Rathore**, a noble in the kingdom of Marwar, rose up to the occasion and decided to rescue the infant, Ajit Singh. In a series of guerilla wars, covert operations and death-defying encounters with the Mughals, Durgadas managed to handover the infant to Raj Singh and sought his protection. Raj Singh readily accepted to shelter Ajit Singh and swore to protect him, leaving Aurangzeb fuming.

DEFEAT OF AURANGZEB

Raj Singh's rescue of Charumati, Shrinathji and Ajit Singh infuriated Aurangzeb. He mobilized a huge army and attacked Mewar in 1679. Raj Singh appealed to all Rajputs kings to support him in his mission of defending Mewar. He was joined by Vanavasi groups like Bhils and Pulindas. Raj Singh escorted the people of Udaipur to a safe hilly zone and adopted scorched-earth policy. The Mughal army was starved and was further surprised by guerilla warfare used by the Rana. Aurangzeb after a failed campaign left Mewar and retracted to Ajmer. A frustrated Aurangzeb decided for an all-out offensive. He sent 3 separate armies, under his sons Akbar, Azam and Muazzam and led one himself. They penetrated the Aravalli hills from different directions. However, the unfamiliar hilly terrains made the Mughal artillery ineffective. The Mughal forces were dragged into the hills and ravaged by the defending Mewar army. The Mughals suffered serious setbacks and depleted their treasury in a year-long unsuccessful campaign. The combined army of Mewar and Marwar totally decimated Aurangzeb. Maharana Raj Singh had also fulfilled the promise of protecting Ajit Singh

BATTLE OF UDAIPUR AND ARAVALLI	
When? 1679 – 1680	
Where? Udaipur, Mewar (Rajasthan)	
Who were the combatants?	
Mughals	Kingdom of Mewar
Who were the commanders?	
Aurangzeb & his sons	Raj Singh & his sons, Durgadas Rathore
Outcome : Mewar Victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Depletion of Mughal treasure and continuing sovereignty of Mewar	

Udaipuri, wife of Aurangzeb, accompanied him during the war. In the chaos of war, she was captured by Mewar soldiers. She was taken to the Rana who received her with honor and dignity and sent her back to Aurangzeb safely. Invaders dishonored women captured in war and made them slaves. While Hindu kings treated women with honor.

NATIONAL LOSS AND AN EPIC RESISTANCE

Misfortune struck Bharat in 1680. Unable to subdue Raj Singh through wars, Aurangzeb resorted to wile*. He bribed a few people inside the Mewar court to poison Raj Singh. Raj Singh fell to the treachery and died in 1680. In the same year, Shivaji Maharaj passed away leaving behind his 28 year old son **Sambhaji** as the next Chhatrapati. Death of the two great kings in the same year left a deep void in Bharat's resistance against the tyrannical regime of Aurangzeb. However, they had created enough spirit and conviction in the minds of their successors. For the next 3 decades, the successors of Shivaji and Raj Singh waged relentless wars against the Mughals.

Posthumous : After the death of someone **Wile :** Cunning strategy

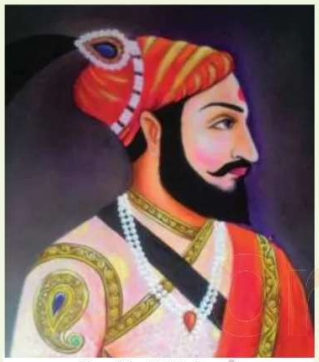
MUGHAL - RAJPUT WARS

After the death of Raj Singh, Aurangzeb managed to make peace with Mewar. But Marwar continued to battle under the leadership of Durgadas Rathore from 1680. He won many key battles forcing Mughals to retreat. In 1686 Mughals governor of Gujarat and Jodhpur led a campaign against Marwar but was defeated. Political situation reversed in Marwar as Mughals were forced to pay tribute to Marwar. Durgadas continued his resistance until Aurangzeb's death in 1707. After 1707, Durgadas launched another campaign to completely evict the Mughals from Marwar. **Ajit Singh** became the Maharaja of Jodhpur in 1710 and rebuilt all the temples that had been desecrated by the occupying Muslims. At the end of 3 decades of war, the Mughals gained nothing. They lost thousands of lives and enormous sums of money and the Mughal empire collapsed.

MUGHAL – RAJPUT WARS	
When? 1679 - 1707	
Where? Rajputana	
Who were the combatants?	
Mughals	Kingdom of Marwar & Mewar
Who were the commanders?	
Aurangzeb & his sons	Ajit Singh, Durgadas Rathore & many
Outcome : Rajput Victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : **Collapse of Mughal Empire**	

MUGHAL – MARATHA WARS

SAMBHAJI'S VALOUR


Sambhaji Maharaj

After the death of Shivaji Maharaj in 1680, his 28 year son Sambhaji became the next Chhatrapati. Aurangzeb decided to use all his might to crush the Marathas. In 1681, Aurangzeb camped at Aurangabad with 5,00,000 strong army to capture the Maratha Empire. It was a disproportionate war in all senses. However Sambhaji faced the opponent with valor. The Mughal forces laid siege to Fort Ramsej, Nashik. But the Marathas did not succumb to the onslaught. They resisted the attack for seven years, much to the annoyance of Aurangzeb. Between 1681 and 1688 the Marathas under Sambhaji fought more than 60 battles successfully. Unfortunately Chhatrapati Sambhaji was captured and arrested in February 1689 and taken before Aurangzeb. Aurangzeb offered to let Sambhaji free if he agreed to convert to Islam. However, Sambhaji refused to do so. He was cruelly tortured for 14 days and then beheaded. To Aurangzeb, it seemed to be the end of Marathas. But the brutal killing of Sambhaji kindled the spirit of the Marathas.

WAR CONTINUES

Sambhaji's son was just 7 years old and hence Chhatrapati Shivaji's second son Rajaram took over the throne in 1689. In 1690 Aurangzeb laid siege to Raigad fort. Marathas resisted the siege exasperating* the Mughal forces. However, Aurangzeb managed to capture the fort by bribing the caretaker of the fort. **Yesubai** (Sambhaji's wife) and her son **Shahu** were captured. Anticipating the fall of Raigad, **Raja Rajaram** along with the Maratha minister **Ramchandra Pant Amatya** moved to Panhala. From Panhala Rajaram reached Jinji, Tamilnadu in 1691. Rajaram's escape from Panhala to Tamilnadu was an ambitious plan since most of the places en-route were under the Mughal control.

Aurangzeb was highly annoyed that Rajaram had escaped right under the nose of Mughal forces. So he despatched an army of 25,000 soldiers to lay siege to Jinji. Marathas expected this move and appointed Ramchandra Pant and Shankaraji Pant Sachiv to defend from south. The defense from the north was planned by two of the able Maratha commanders **Santaji Ghorpade** and **Dhanaji Jadhav**. The two commanders launched several flash raids on Mughal tents causing havoc to the Mughal army. After a 7 year siege, Jinji was finally captured by the Mughals. But it had significantly depleted Mughal resources in the region, from the

Exasperate : Intensely irritate

treasury to material. Also, the capture of Jinji proved futile as Rajaram had already escaped to Vishalgadh in 1699. Aurangzeb realised that the war he had started was much more serious than he had originally thought. Not heeding to the advice of many Mughal ministers to abandon the mission of conquering the Marathas, Aurangzeb remained adamant.

TARABAI LEADS THE MARATHAS

In 1700 Rajaram died. Rajaram's wife **Rani Tarabai** through her astuteness* installed her son **Shivaji II** on the throne and became the queen regent to govern the Marathas. The period between 1700 and 1707 was navigated by Tarabai with sound military and civil strategy. Tarabai had been trained in defence and government matters and quickly established her mark.

Rani Tarabai

Although she was short handed in terms of her armies, she made quick attacks on the regions under Mughal control. Fearless, Tarabai stretched the borders of the Maratha empire by attacking Guna (in Madhya Pradesh) and Berar and Telangana. Even cities in Gujarat and Khandesh were not left alone. Revenue collectors were put in place to ensure that the Maratha treasury was funded by these conquests.

DID YOU KNOW?

Khafi Khan, a Mughal chronicler, wrote about Tarabai, "She was a clever, intelligent woman, and had obtained a reputation during her husband's lifetime for her knowledge of civil and military matters."

END OF AURANGZEB AND COLLAPSE OF MUGHALS

Around 1705, without losing any major territory in the Deccan the Marathas had managed to defeat the Mughals. The guerilla warfare tactics of the Marathas, their persistent spirit to rid Bharat of the invaders were effective and brought down the large armies of Aurangzeb. Aurangzeb made his way back to Ahmadnagar (about 120 km from Pune) where he reached his "journey's end". More than 25 years of his life was consumed in the Deccan campaign. The Mughal empire was in shambles, its treasury depleted and power structures and influence destroyed. Chhatrapati Shivaji and the Marathas had brought down Aurangzeb and the Mughals.

Aurangzeb died in February 1707.

MUGHAL - MARATHA WARS	
When? 1680 - 1707	
Where? Present-day Maharashtra, Gujarat, Madhyapradesh, Karnataka & Tamilnadu	
Who were the combatants?	
Mughal Empire	Maratha Empire
Who were the commanders?	
Aurangzeb, his sons, Zulfiqar Khan	Sambhaji, Rajaram, Tarabai and many
Outcome : Maratha Victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Collapse of Mughal Empire	

DID YOU KNOW?

Manucci, a European, spent long years during this time in Bharat and chronicled the events of the period. He writes:

"Aurangzeb withdrew to Ahmadnagar, leaving behind him the fields of these provinces devoid of trees and bare of crops, their places being taken by the bones of men and beasts. Instead of greenery all is black and barren. The country is so desolated that neither fire nor light can be found in the course of three or four days' journey. There have died in his armies over a hundred thousand souls yearly, and of animals, pack-oxen, camels, elephants, etc., over three hundred thousand. In the Deccan provinces from 1702 to 1704 plague (and famine) prevailed. In these two years there expired over two millions of souls"

Astuteness : Intelligence to assess situations and people

RANI YESUBAI SAVES SHAHU

A succession war started between Aurangzeb's sons Azam Shah, Shah Alam and Kam Buksh after Aurangzeb's death. Azam Shah had possession of the Maratha royals Yesubai and Shahu with whom he was keen to travel back to Delhi. While they were in Bhopal Yesubai didn't want Shahu to spend his time in a remote Delhi jail. She negotiated with Azam Shah and got Shahu released. Yesubai with a few other royals were taken to Delhi and their custody changed hands to Shah Alam as Azam Shah was defeated by Shah Alam.

RISE OF THE PESHWAS

POWER WAR

Raja Shahu started assuming power and most ministers and generals sided with him taking over the throne. There however existed a power centre around Tarabai as well. The power of these two royals were centered around Satara and Kolhapur. Battles were fought within the Marathas and Tarabai lost a few of them along with some of her loyal generals. Between 1701 and 1713, Shahu was faced with challenges from Tarabai and the Mughals. However, by 1713 most power rested with Shahu and Tarabai was deposed.

PESHWA BALAJI VISHWANATH CREATES ALLIANCES

Shah Alam was trying to make use of the internal rivalries among the Marathas. However, Shahu had an able administrator in **Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath** who brought together a loyal and effective team to ensure that Shah Alam didn't exploit the situation. In just 7 years the Peshwa was able to stitch many alliances that cemented Maratha power. The Maratha kingdom was made up of many regions under different Maratha commanders. Balaji stabilized the entire kingdom by signing treaties with the various commanders in return for supporting Shahu with armies and taxes. The people who didn't cooperate were removed.

In the Deccan, the Peshwa entered into an agreement with the Mughal viceroy Husain Ali. The Marathas required artillery and Husain Ali wanted to overthrow Farukh Siyar who had taken the throne in Delhi.

Husain Ali along with Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath and the Maratha forces marched towards Delhi. They owerpowered Faruksiyar, imprisoned him and freed Rani Yesubai and other members of Maratha family in 1718. They also installed Rafi-ud-Darjat as a puppet ruler and signed a treaty with him.

TREATY BETWEEN MUGHALS AND MARATHAS

- Release of all Maratha prisoners including the Maratha royal family
- Recognition of the independent Swarajya founded by Chhatrapati Shivaji
- Right for Marathas to collect Chauthai (25% of total revenue) and Sardeshmukhi (10% of total revenue) in all 6 Deccan provinces.

The Marathas in return agreed to :

- Recognize the nominal authority of the Mughal emperor
- Maintain an army in Deccan to keep the peace
- Maintain 15,000 troops to protect the Mughal throne

Historian G. S. Sardesai notes that when a sovereign (Mughal) seeks protection from a vassal (Marathas), it means that in actual practice the comparative strength of the two parties is reversed. That is, the Marathas had now become protectors of the Mughals.

Queen Yesubai, Raja Shahu's mother, and the Maratha royals were released and brought by the Peshwa and the Maratha army to Satara. Raja Shahu personally received his mother who had spent more than 30 years in

captivity. Rani Yesubai had earned the respect and admiration of her people. She had protected the heir to the Maratha throne, endured and navigated her way in captivity and advised her child and the other royals to lead a life of Dharma.

PESHWA BAJI RAO I EXPANDS THE MARATHA EMPIRE

Peshwa Baji Rao

In April 1720, Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath passed away. In about 15 days, Raja Shahu was looking for his next Peshwa and he didn't have to look far. There were many contenders for the post of Peshwa but 19-year-old **Baji Rao**, son of Balaji Vishwanath, staked his claim to the position. While the other contenders and ministers didn't think Baji Rao will even stand a chance, Shahu made Baji Rao the next Peshwa.

BAJI RAO OVERCOMES CHALLENGES

Soon after becoming the Peshwa, Baji Rao I faced multiple threats, both internal and external. Senior ministers who were unhappy about Baji Rao's appointment as the Peshwa, refused to cooperate with him. There was also a threat of Maratha Empire being taken over by Sambhaji II. Maratha Kingdom also had external threats from Nizam of Hyderabad, Portuguese in Goa, Siddhis of Janjira. Baji Rao recognized these threats. He adopted military and diplomatic strategies and overcame them.

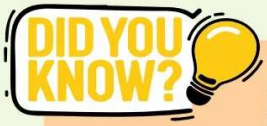
Having resolved the internal and external threats, Baji Rao now embarked on this next agenda.

BAJI RAO EYES DELHI

Peshwa Baji Rao was keen to free Bharat from the foreign forces and prevent future foreign invasions. He understood the importance of establishing bases in the northern parts of Bharat. He planned to expand northwards. He led successful campaigns to Bhopal, Gujarat, Malwa. He also extended support to Maharaja Chatrasal of Bhundelkhand who as a young boy was inspired by Shivaji Maharaj. With Bhundelkhand under Baji Rao's control he set his eyes on Delhi. In 1737, Baji Rao undertook a mission to Delhi and defeated the Mughals decisively. Humiliated by the loss, the Mughal emperor sought the support of their vassals-Nizams of Hyderabad, Bhopal and Awadh. The combined army challenged Baji Rao at Bhopal which Baji Rao decimated.

From Delhi to Karnataka and from Gujarat to Berar were now under the Marathas.

Extant of Maratha empire during Baji Rao I



After Baji Rao had left Delhi and defeated the Nizam, he had to engage his army in Vasai. Seeing the Mughal's weakness, Nadir Shah of Iran invaded Delhi in 1739. He burnt down Delhi, looted the treasures, reinstalled Muhammad Shah as the emperor and left with an untold amount of wealth.

PASSING AWAY OF BAJI RAO

In April 1740, while on a campaign with his soldiers, Baji Rao passed away in Raverkhedi by the banks of the river Narmada after a brief illness. He was just a few months less than forty years. In the words of Sir

Richard Temple, "He died as he lived, in camp under canvas among his men, and he is remembered to this day among the Marathas as the fighting Peshwa and the incarnation of Hindu energy."

DID YOU KNOW?

Peshwa Baji Rao fought over 41 battles and never lost one!

MARATHAS AFTER BAJI RAO

Peshwa Baji Rao's sudden demise led to confusion regarding his successor. **Balaji Baji Rao** also known as **Nana Saheb** was the eldest son of Baji Rao and had been groomed to govern and administer by his uncle Chimaji Appa, mother and grandmother. Chhatrapati Shahu made Nana Saheb the next Peshwa in June 1740. This was not liked by people like Raghuji Bhosle, the Raja of Nagpur.

Nana Saheb had spent most of his time in diplomatic missions, difficult negotiations and governance more than fighting battles. Since taking over as Peshwa, Nana Saheb effectively started consolidating Maratha power across Bharat. Malwa was taken over from Sawai Jai Singh. The next few years till 1747 were spent in Bundelkhand and Bengal ensuring the regions were paying their tributes and Maratha power was consolidated.

NANA SAHEB, ARCHITECT OF PUNE CITY

Nana Saheb was a pioneer in developing the city of Pune. He started with a high wall around the core of the city for its protection that is seen even today. He encouraged artisans, traders and others to make the city their home. For this he expanded the living area (called 'peths') of the city.

Water scarcity was a major problem in Pune. The streams dried up in summer and people living away from the streams didn't have easy access to water. Dams were constructed on the Ambhil stream. Nana Saheb constructed a lake 13 miles away from Pune at Katraj which was in hilly terrain. This served as a catchment area for the water. Water then flowed down to another lake for more storage. Stone pipelines took water from these lakes to the city. This provided more than 26 lakh litres of water to the city.

MARATHA RESISTANCE OF DURRANIS

ATTROCITIES OF DURRANI

In 1752, Wazir Safdarjung in Delhi and the Nawab of Awadh requested the Marathas to help them drive out the Afghani Rohillas. The Marathas accepted the plea and drove away the Rohilla Pathans successfully. The responsibility of protecting the Mughal ruler in Delhi from internal and external enemies fell into the hands of the Marathas. In return, the right to collect tribute from all the major Mughal territories were given to the Marathas. The Rohillas wanting to take revenge on the Marathas invited Ahmad Shah Durrani (Abdali) of Afghanistan to defeat the Marathas. In October 1756, Ahmad Shah Durrani (Abdali) entered Bharat capturing Lahore on the way and reached Delhi. Ahmad destroyed Delhi completely and looted its entire wealth. From Delhi, he headed to the Hindu pilgrim sites of Mathura and Vrindavan. In Vrindavan, Ahmad slaughtered the innocent pilgrims, and the water of the Yamuna ran red. Every head brought by an Afghan soldier was given ₹ 5 as bounty. After this massacre Ahmad moved back to Afghanistan leaving Najib Khan to take care of Delhi.

CAPTURE OF DELHI

The Mughal emperor requested the Marathas to help them get rid of Abdali's agent Najib Khan. Peshwa Balaji Baji Rao sent his brother Raghunath Rao along with many other commanders and a large army towards Delhi. They were accompanied by Malhar Rao Holkar of Malwa. After two weeks of intense warfare, the Najib surrenderd and was arrested. The Marathas became the de-facto* rulers of Delhi.

MARATHA POWER AT ITS ZENITH

After the capture of Delhi, the Mughal general at Punjab, Adina Beg Khan, requested the Marathas to protect them from the menace of Afghan-Rohilla forces. Raghunath Rao accepted and joined hands with Adina Beg and Sikh misls which were already in revolt against Ahmad Shah Abdali. Marathas defeated the Afghans and captured Attock, Peshawar and Multan in 1759. The Maratha Empire was now at its largest-from Attock to Cuttack and from the Cauvery to the base of the Himalayas!

Abdali raided Bharat again wanting to overthrow Marathas and re-captured Attock. However, the Maratha and Sikh armies mobilized a huge army at Lahore in 1759. In a fierce battle that ensued the Afghans were defeated by the combined forces of the Marathas and the Sikh misl.

Map showing extant of Maratha empire at its zenith in 1759 CE

THIRD BATTLE OF PANIPAT

PRELUDE TO THE WAR

Unable to come in terms with the defeat at Lahore, Abdali marched towards Delhi with a massive army of more than 75,000 soldiers. On the way, Durrani attacked and captured the provinces captured earlier by the Marathas–Attock, Peshawar, Lahore and others and reached Delhi and took over Delhi from the Marathas. On receiving news about Ahmad's taking over of Delhi, Nana Saheb wrote to the other rulers, including the Rajputs and Jats, that Durrani shouldn't be allowed to grow roots in Bharat. The atrocities committed by Durrani including the massacres at Vrindavan and Mathura were widely known. By November 1760 the Maratha forces on one side and the forces of Ahmad Shah camped near Panipat. There were negotiations and talks between the two sides. But everything failed.

THE BATTLE

On 14 January 1761, the two sides clashed. **Sadashiv Rao Bhau** and **Vishwas Rao** (Nana Saheb's son) led the charge on the Maratha side. The first half of the day was in favour of the Marathas as the Rohillas and the Afghans suffered major losses. However, by afternoon the tides turned. Vishwas Rao was hit by a stray bullet and he died. This led to a huge loss of morale for the Marathas. Before the war, about 2000 Afghan soldiers had surrendered to the Marathas. These Afghans were employed to work on the Marathas side. However, this entire unit switched their loyalty and started killing the Marathas. All this added to the confusion among the Maratha ranks that started splintering. Ahmad Shah Durrani ordered his men to go on a rampage slaughtering all the people in the vicinity of Panipat. Thousands of men were beheaded and their skulls heaped outside their tents. Many thousands of women were taken captive. Sadashiv Rao Bhau, Jankoji Scindia and the other major warriors were killed. The huge loss of Maratha lives ensured a break in the chain of attacks from the northwest.

De-facto : In reality

THINK!!!

What is the distance between Pune and Panipat? 1600 km

How much time will it take to cover this distance by foot? 12 days non stop.

Imagine an army of 1 Lakh soldiers marching from Pune to Panipat just so that enemy can be prevented from entering mainland Bharat. This was the patriotic fervor of the Marathas.

OUTCOME

Although Abdali won the battle, the ground situation remained the same as he lost tens of thousands of soldiers. Having seen the spirit of resilience in the Marathas, he was not confident that he could establish his empire in Bharat. He decided to retreat back to Afghanistan. Abdali made peace with the Marathas and blamed Najib and others for a catastrophic war at Panipat.

BATTLE OF PANIPAT - III	
When? 1761	
Where? Panipat, near Delhi	
Who were the combatants?	
Marathas	Durranis
Who were the commanders?	
Balaji Bajirao, Sadashivarao Bhau	Ahmad Shah Durrani
Outcome : Pyrrhic victory of Durrani.	
SIGNIFICANCE : Marathas lose their hold over north of Sutlej. Durrani retreats to Afghan	

MARATHAS BOUNCE BACK

In spite of the loss at Panipat, the Marathas recovered quickly. After Balaji Bajirao, **Sawai Madhavrao I** became the Peshwa. He led the Marathas back to glory by unifying the different factions of the Marathas. He recognized the contributions of the leaders of these factions and involved them to expand the Maratha territories. He sent generals such as Bhonsle, Scindia and Holkar to the north, where they re-established Maratha authority by the early 1770s.

CONCLUSION

Bharat saw a thousand years of invasion from Arab, Turkey, Iran and Afghanistan. These ruthless and barbaric invaders slaughtered masses, destroyed and plundered our temples, enslaved women and children. They brought about great peril to Bharat. Any society that underwent such a devastation by foreign nations would have lost its native culture and civilization. But great kings and queens of this land fearlessly took on the invaders. They fought with them till their last breath and ensured that Bharat retained its cultural and civilizational identity. The resilient spirit of Maharana Pratap, the vision of Shivaji Maharaj, the tenacity of Guru Gobind Singh ensured that their successors carried on with their mission of resisting the invaders and purging them from Bharat. The non-stop warfare for over 25 years waged by the Marathas and the Rajputs brought the downfall of the Mughal empire and ensured the establishment of Hindavi Swaraj envisioned by Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj.

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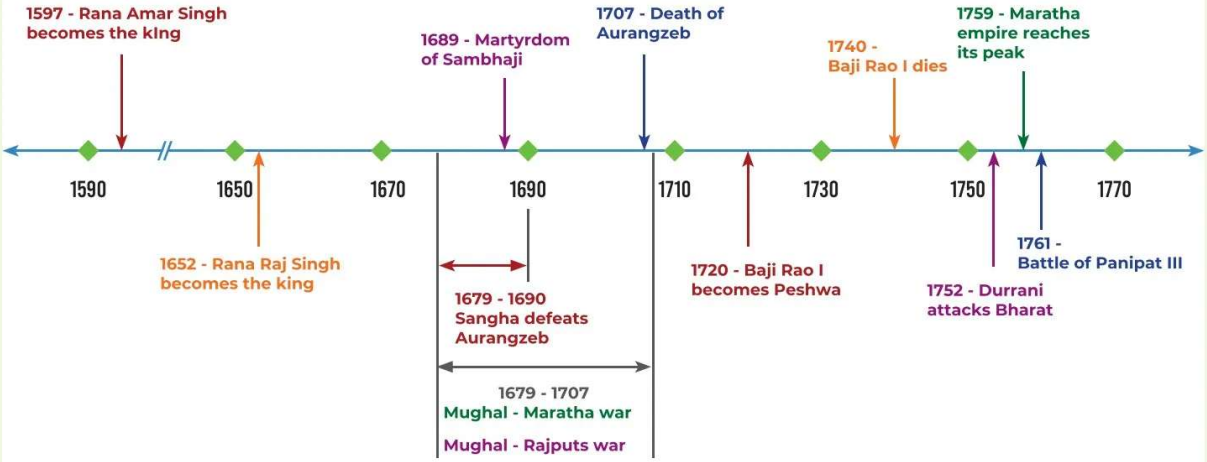
KEYWORDS

- Rana Amar Singh
- Rana Raj Singh
- Durgadas Rathore
- Hadi Rani
- Jizya
- Mughal - Maratha war
- Mughal - Rajput war
- Sambhaji
- Rajaram
- Tara Bai
- Peshwa Balaji Viswanath
- Peshwa Baji Rao
- Peshwa Balaji Bajirao
- Ahmad Shah Durrani
- Battle of Panipat

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. _____ succeeded Maharana Pratap to the Mewar throne.
   a) Amar Singh b) Prith Singh c) Raj Singh d) Roop Singh
2. In 1658, _____ ascended the Mughal throne.
   a) Akbar b) Jahangir c) Raj Singh d) Aurangazeb
3. True or False
   Statement A: Rana Raj Singh paid jizya when ordered by Aurangazeb.
   Statement B: Rana Raj Singh succeeded Karan Singh to the throne of Mewar.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
4. Raj Singh was joined by Vanavasi groups like _____ and _____
   a) Munda and Baduga b) Chenchu and Kodaba c) Bhils and Pulindas d) Khasi and Gharo
5. In 1680, _____ succeeded Shivaji to the Maratha empire.
   a) Rajaram b) Sambhaji c) Tukoji d) Tanhaji
6. _____ was installed as a puppet ruler in Delhi by Peshwa Balaji VIshwanath.
   a) Rafi-ud-Darjat b) Rafi-ud-Daulat c) Husain Ali d) Hyder Ali
7. Baji Rao I was _____ years old when he became the Peshwa of Raja Shahu.
   a) 24 b) 17 c) 29 d) 19
8. _____ invaded Delhi in 1739 and reinstalled Muhammad Shah as the emperor.
   a) Peshwa Baji Rao b) Manucci c) Nadir Shah d) Alam Shah

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. Who was Hadi Rani?
2. For how long did the siege of Jinji last?
3. Write about the fearless Rani Tarabai.
4. What were the challenges faced by Peshwa Baji Rao I.

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5. Describe the last days of Peshwa Baji Rao I.
6. Who was Ahmad Shah Durrani?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. How was Veer Durgadas Rathore helped by Raj Singh?
2. Elaborate on the battle of Udaipur and Aravalli and its final outcome.
3. How did Sambhaji meet his end?
4. Describe the events that led to the siege of Jinji.
5. Explain the role of Rani Yesubai in helping the Marathas consolidate power.
6. Describe the third battle of Panipat.
7. Why was Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath considered an able administrator? Explain with examples..
8. Explain the conditions of the treaty between the Marathas and Mughals after 1718 CE.
9. Peshwa Nana Saheb - a visionary. Explain.
10. Why did the Afghani Rohillas want to take revenge on the Marathas?

CASE STUDY

He sent 3 separate armies, under his sons Akbar, Azam and Muazzam and led one himself. They penetrated the Aravalli hills from different directions. However, the unfamiliar hilly terrains made the Mughal artillery ineffective.

1. With whom were the Mughals fighting against?
2. What happened to the Mughal armies?

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. a) Tarabai leads the Marathas
   b) Aurangazeb dies
   c) Sambhaji is captured
   d) Raj Singh ascends the throne
2. a) Rajaram ascends the throne
   b) Ahmad Shah Durrani attacks Bharat
   c) Nana Saheb becomes Peshwa
   d) Battle of Udaipur and Aravalli

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MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Siddis	European
Chhatrapati Shivaji	Allies of Aurangzeb
Maucci	Maratha's royals
Yesubai Shahu	Father of Sambhaji

MAP WORK

1. Mark the following places : Guna, Bhopal, Malwa, Attock.
2. Mark the places travelled by Raja Rajaram during his escape from Raigad
3. Mark the extent of the Maratha empire at the end of Peshwa Baji Rao I's time.
4. Mark the extent of the Maratha empire in 1759.

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IMPORTANT DAYS

JANUARY	
17	**Krishnadevaraya -** Birthday

FEBRUARY	
19	**Chhatrapati Shivaji -** Birthday

MARCH	
11	**Sambhaji -** Martyrdom

APRIL	
15	**Guru Nanak Jayanti**

MAY	
9	**Maha Rana Pratap -** Birthday
29	**Mula Gabharu Day**
31	**Ahilyabhai Holkar-** Birthday

JUNE	
6	**Chhatrapati Shivaji -** Coronation

JULY	
26	**Kargil Vijay Diwas**

AUGUST	
18	**Baji Rao I -** Birthday

SEPTEMBER	
24	**Raj Singh -** Birthday

OCTOBER	
7	**Raja Hemu -** Captured Delhi

NOVEMBER	
13	**Maharaja Ranjit Singh -** Birthday
24	**Guru Tegh Bahadur -** Martyrdom

DECEMBER	
22	**Guru Gobind -** Birthday
26	**Veer Bala Diwas**

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